

SCHEMES ON TRACK:
GOVT GOES METRO **P3**



BJP REJIGS STATE MACHINERY, SMRITI
IRANI GETS HARYANA, CHHATTISGARH **P10**

OF STARS, STORIES AND
NATIONAL HONOURS **P17**



EC DISSENT ROW

‘Impeach, arrest CEC’: Oppn amplifies clamour for Gyanesh Kumar’s ouster

VINAY KUMAR
New Delhi, September 23

The Opposition on Wednesday launched a sharp attack on Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, demanding his impeachment and arrest and alleging that the poll panel under him was functioning as a “one-man autocracy”.

A political storm erupted after a report in The Indian Express claimed that two Election Commissioners had raised objections 14 times over 10 months to decisions affecting the electoral process.

Two Election Commissioners, Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi, flagged issues relating to the deletion and addition of names to electoral rolls under the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) and raised objections to the decision-making process at least 14 times over the past 10 months, according to the report.

Opposition parties, which have been critical of the EC over the SIR of electoral rolls, seized on the report to demand immediate impeachment proceed-



A protestor holds a poster of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar during a protest by IYC members against the CEC, in New Delhi

PTI



» **BJP says differing views among ECs reflect “pure democracy”**



» **Differences normal, decisions were unanimous, says EC**

ings against CEC Kumar in Parliament.

The Congress dubbed the row “Gyaneshgate”, while the Trinamool Congress led by Mamata Banerjee demanded CEC Kumar’s impeachment and fresh assembly elec-

tions in West Bengal using the voter list that existed before the Special Intensive Revision (SIR).

Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi reiterated his “vote chori” charge against the EC, terming it an act of

treason and a crime against the people of India.

“The BJP, RSS and EC who organised it have committed an act of treason. Justice will be served,” Gandhi said.

“It has now been proven that the BJP and the

KEY POINTS

- » **Rahul Gandhi repeats “vote chori” charge against EC**
- » **Kharge recalls April notice by 73 Opposition Rajya Sabha MPs**
- » **Mamata demands CEC’s arrest, fresh Bengal polls with pre-SIR voter list**
- » **Uddhav Thackeray seeks CEC’s removal, arrest and fresh polls**
- » **Akhilesh Yadav calls governments formed under EC “unconstitutional”**
- » **Singhvi alleges CEC “hijacked” the Election Commission**
- » **CPI(M) questions EC’s integrity after reported internal objections**
- » **Kejriwal demands cancellation of SIR and Kumar’s arrest**

EC looted the West Bengal assembly polls,” former West Bengal chief minister Mamata Banerjee alleged in a Facebook live. “Re-election must be held in West Bengal with the old voter list,” she added.

CONTINUED ON P4

From Form 6 to ECINet: 14 dissents in 10 months expose rift within ECI

The Indian Express report flags voter database integrity, Form 6 changes, poll panel actions and conduct

RECORDED OBJECTIONS



MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 23

The two Election Commissioners – Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi – objected to various aspects of the electoral process, including new voter registration, deletion and restoration of names from the rolls, and the filing of appeals against orders restoring voters during the SIR process. The two ECs objected on record to steps taken by the poll panel 14 times over 10 months, The

Indian Express reported on Wednesday.

The SIR exercise to weed out ineligible and deceased voters, which began in June last year with Bihar, has so far led to more than 13 crore names being deleted from draft rolls across 30 states and Union Territories. The maximum deletions have been recorded in the draft rolls of Delhi and Maharashtra.

Perhaps the most controversial development has been ECINet, launched on

January 22. Described as the technological backbone for nearly a billion voters, it brought more than 40 apps and portals under one roof, according to Seema Khanna, Director General (IT) in the ECI.

Within months, however, ECINet, which had been described as lawful and trustworthy, shut out state-level officers legally responsible for adding or deleting names and updating electoral records. Their access was restricted by Khanna’s

CONTINUED ON P4

Briefs

Iran says country will fight ‘until last breath’

UNITED NATIONS: Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian told the UN General Assembly on Wednesday that Iran had been the victim of US and Israeli “terrorism”, vowing not to yield to pressure. He said Tehran remained open to diplomacy without accepting force. Pezeshkian also displayed photographs of Ali Khamenei and Iranian children killed in the war, while denying attacks on civilians.

SEE P14

Banks to remain open on Sept 27

NEW DELHI: Banks, including Regional Rural Banks (RRBs), will remain open on Sunday, September 27, to help customers access essential services ahead of a proposed three-day nationwide strike, the finance ministry said on Wednesday.

The United Forum of Bank Unions (UFBU), which represents about 90 per cent of bank employees, has called the strike from September 28 to 30, seeking a five-day banking week among other demands. Its demands also include pension improvements, a uniform dearness allowance formula for pensioners and an option for NPS-covered employees to shift to the old pension scheme.

CONTINUED ON P4

Jaishankar shares India’s concerns on ‘Russia Sanctions Act’ with Rubio

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New York/New Delhi, September 23

India and the US on Wednesday discussed bilateral ties, regional developments and New Delhi’s concerns over proposed sanctions targeting countries that buy Russian energy, as External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar met US Secretary of State Marco Rubio in New York.

The meeting took place on the sidelines of the 81st UN General Assembly session, where Jaishankar is leading the Indian delegation. After the meeting, Jaishankar said India’s interests and concerns regarding the Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act (SRIA) were discussed, along with the situations in the Gulf and Ukraine.

US President Donald Trump signed

CONTINUED ON P4

Indian national killed in attack on a vessel

DUBAI: An Indian national was killed in an attack on merchant vessel MV Cape Dao while it was transiting towards India, the Indian Embassy in Oman said on Wednesday. The embassy said it was closely monitoring the attack and was in coordination with Omani authorities regarding the safety of all crew members on board, including 19 Indian nationals.

“We are deeply saddened by the loss of one Indian national in this attack.

CONTINUED ON P4

SC SPLIT OVER NEUTRALITY OF CEC SELECTION PANEL PM-nominated minister unlikely to defy him, says Justice Datta

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 23

The Supreme Court on Wednesday questioned the neutrality of the mechanism for appointing the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) and Election Commissioners (ECs), with Justice Dipankar Datta observing that a Union Cabinet Minister nominated by the Prime Minister cannot reasonably be expected to oppose the Prime Minister who heads the selection panel. Justice Datta said the minister’s position as a member of the Council of Ministers, coupled with the constitutional principle of collective responsibility, could prevent him from acting as an independent counterweight to the Prime Minister, potentially leaving



THE MATTER WILL NOW GO BEFORE CJI SURYA KANT FOR CONSIDERATION OF AN APPROPRIATE CONSTITUTION BENCH

the Leader of Opposition with a largely ornamental role in the process. The observation came as the two-judge bench gave split opinions on whether challenges to the 2023 appointment law should be referred to a larger Constitution Bench. The

bench of Justices Dipankar Datta and Satish Chandra Sharma had heard the petitions for five days. With the judges differing on the need for a larger bench, the matter was directed to be placed before Chief Justice of India Surya Kant for consideration of a bench of appropriate strength. The judges also requested the CJI to explore the possibility of establishing a permanent five-judge Constitution Bench for deciding important constitutional questions.

The petitions challenge the constitutional validity of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023, particularly Section 7.

CONTINUED ON P4

Top Court flags delay on disqualification pleas against rebel TMC MPs

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Kolkata, September 23

The Supreme Court on Wednesday flagged the three-month delay in deciding disqualification petitions against 20 rebel Trinamool Congress MPs, but stopped short of imposing a deadline on Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla.

A Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana was hearing TMC MP Abhishek Banerjee’s plea seeking expeditious disposal of the petitions filed against the MPs.

Justice Bagchi said the passage of three months was a “red flag”, particularly as the outcome could have a bearing on other proceedings and the democratic process.

HIGHLIGHTS

- » **Justice Bagchi described the three-month delay as a “red flag”, citing its potential impact on other proceedings and the democratic process**
- » **The 20 MPs left the TMC in June and announced that they had joined the Nationalist Citizens Party of India**
- » **The MPs also sought recognition as a separate group in the Lok Sabha**

The 20 MPs broke away from the TMC in June and announced that they had joined the Nationalist Citizens Party of India (NCP), while seeking recognition as a separate group in the Lok Sabha. Banerjee filed individual disqualification petitions

CONTINUED ON P4

Delhi sees shortest monsoon spell in 14 years

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 23

The Southwest Monsoon withdrew from Delhi on Wednesday after an 83-day stay, its shortest spell over the capital in 14 years, even as the city recorded 16 per cent more rainfall than normal, the India Meteorological Department said.

The monsoon remained over the capital from July 2 to September 23, two days ahead of its normal withdrawal date of September 25. It arrived five days later than the normal onset date of June 27, marking Delhi’s first July onset since 2021.

The spell was shorter than in recent years, lasting 87 days in 2025, 96 days in 2024 and 97 days in 2023.

CONTINUED ON P4

Ayushman Bharat turns 8 with over 60 cr beneficiaries

Record savings on medical expenses under Ayushman Bharat, says PM Modi

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 23

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Wednesday said more than 60 crore people now have access to annual health cover of up to Rs 5 lakh under Ayushman Bharat, as the flagship healthcare programme marked eight years since its launch.

In a post on X, Modi said the programme was launched with the aim of ensuring that every Indian could access quality and affordable health-

care. He said the scheme had resulted in significant savings on medical expenses for poor and middle-class families.

“Ayushman Arogya Mandirs have already recorded over 500 crore visits, strengthening primary healthcare at the grassroots,” Modi said.

Union Health Minister J P Nadra said more than 60 crore people were covered under the Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB-PMJAY), with 48.54 crore Ayushman cards created so far.

CONTINUED ON P4

INDIA WINS 5 MEDALS ON DAY 4

Mirabai ends Asiad jinx with silver

MPOST BUREAU
Nagoya/New Delhi, September 23

Mirabai Chanu finally ended her long wait for an Asian Games medal, winning silver in the women’s 49kg weightlifting event as India enjoyed a mixed day at the continental Games on Wednesday. The shooting contingent added two bronze medals in skeet, while the men’s badminton team also finished third after losing to China in the semifinals.

Chanu, 32, lifted a total of 198kg, including 88kg in snatch and 110kg in clean and jerk, to claim second place. The medal came after she had missed out on an Asiad medal



Mirabai Chanu

PTI

CLOSER LOOK

- » **Jay Meena wins India’s first Asian Games soft tennis medal**
- » **India bags men’s and women’s skeet team bronzes**
- » **Manu Bhaker finishes fifth in women’s 10m air pistol**
- » **India men’s badminton team settles for bronze**
- » **India thrashes Thailand 20-1 in women’s hockey**

in her previous appearances since 2014. It was also India’s first Asian Games weightlifting medal since Karnam Malleswari’s silver in 1998.

CONTINUED ON P4



AUDIT TO COVER LIGHTING, CCTV, PATROLLING

All DDA parks to undergo safety audit within a week

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, September 23

The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) will conduct a comprehensive safety audit of all its parks across Delhi within a week from Thursday, following directions from Lt Governor Sardar Taranjit Singh Sandhu.

The audit will focus on lighting, security, regular patrolling and cleanliness in the parks. The move comes in the backdrop of a recent incident reported at Aastha Kunj near Nehru Place. As an interim measure, the DDA Vice Chairman has directed officials to strengthen safety and security arrangements across all DDA parks. Security personnel and field staff have been asked to maintain heightened vigilance, particularly during evening and night hours.

Parks with multiple entry gates will adopt controlled entry arrangements after sunset, with access restricted to selected gates before the scheduled closing time.

The DDA has also directed that CCTV surveillance be installed or augmented at main entry gates and other vulnerable locations. A time-bound assessment will identify dark spots in parks, following which additional lighting, floodlights and other illumination will be provided wherever required.

Additional security personnel will be deployed at



SAFETY INFORMATION BOARDS DISPLAYING PARK RULES, EMERGENCY CONTACTS, PUBLIC SAFETY GUIDELINES WILL BE INSTALLED IN ALL DDA PARKS WITHIN 7 DAYS

vulnerable entry points and poorly lit locations based on risk assessments. Trained security personnel will also be considered wherever necessary.

Safety information boards displaying park rules, emergency contacts and public safety guidelines will be installed in all DDA parks within seven days. The attendance, patrolling and performance of deployed security guards will also be monitored more rigorously through field inspections.

Visitors will be encour-

aged to use well-lit pathways and illuminated areas during evening hours. The DDA will involve Resident Welfare Associations (RWAs) and local stakeholders in strengthening vigilance and promoting community-based safety.

Coordination with concerned agencies will also be strengthened to facilitate increased bike patrolling around parks during night hours.

The DDA has directed that suspicious activities, including illegal activities in and around parks, be promptly reported to the concerned police authorities for immediate action.

Field officers have been asked to implement the measures on priority and continuously review security arrangements. The DDA will coordinate with Delhi Police, RWAs and other stakeholders to strengthen safety and security in its green spaces.

Police launch intensified park checks & cycle patrols after Aastha Kunj incident

Security tightened around LSR with women personnel, PCR vans...

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 23

Two days after the alleged gangrape of a 17-year-old girl at Aastha Kunj Park, Delhi Police has intensified area-domination and patrolling across vulnerable public spaces, including parks, dark spots and other public spaces across Delhi.

The Central Range conducted coordinated Combining and Search Operations (CASO) on Tuesday and Wednesday, apprehending 379 people under Section 65 of the Delhi Police Act, besides action under the Delhi Excise Act, COTPA, Gambling Act, BNSS and POCSO Act. In Darya Ganj, five parks were checked and 66 people apprehended under Section 65. In Jama Masjid, 45 people faced action under the provision and BNSS. In Kamla Market, teams checked Minto Road Complex Park, Shivaji Park, DBG Park, Nehru Park and Shastri Park, detained 60 people, seized three vehicles and took action under the Excise Act and BNSS. In Patel Nagar, 82 people were apprehended under Section 65, with further action under the Excise Act. In Prasad Nagar, action was taken against 23 people under Section 40(A) of the Excise Act, besides action under the Gambling Act.

The operations followed Monday's alleged gangrape, in which three men allegedly posed as



Lady Shri Ram College (LSR) students hold a solidarity march demanding enhanced safety measures

PTI

policemen and raped the teenager. Police said the exercise seeks to increase visibility and prevent crime.

Teams also audited public spaces for inadequate lighting, dark spots, broken fencing, encroachments, vulnerable entry and exit points and poorly secured subways. Deficiencies will be reported to the PWD, MCD and civic agencies. Eighteen additional women constables were posted to the Women Police Station in North District, while women-led "Jhansi" squads on pink scooters are patrolling vulnerable areas at night. Patrols have also been stepped up around educational institutions and places frequented by women. In North Campus, women personnel have been deployed at pink booths, college gates and adjoining roads. Women personnel are also patrolling Connaught Place, Mukherjee Nagar, Preet

Vihar, Laxmi Nagar and Mehrauli during evenings.

Joint Commissioner of Police, Central Range, Madhur Verma said the exercise was a sustained area-domination programme, with recommendations to civic agencies.

Senior officers, including Joint Commissioner of Police (Southern Range) Vijay Kumar, visited Lady Shri Ram College for Women on Wednesday and met the principal. The college, around two km from the park, shifted classes online on Wednesday; offline classes resume Thursday. Police assured increased presence. Personnel, women police and women PCR vans have been deployed outside the college; a pink booth has been functional since September 17.

Students have raised concerns about inadequate lighting and security near the back gate and routes used by students living as paying guests, as well

TEAMS ALSO AUDITED PUBLIC SPACES FOR INADEQUATE LIGHTING, DARK SPOTS, BROKEN FENCING, ENCROACHMENTS, VULNERABLE ENTRY AND EXIT POINTS...

as stalking and the pink booth's functioning.

Meanwhile, Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar directed district DCPs to identify non-functional street lights and CCTV cameras, broken gates, walls and other deficiencies in parks and isolated areas. He also ordered the resumption of cycle patrolling, with SHOs told to ensure foot and cycle patrols, particularly mornings and evenings. The commissioner also directed beat and ground personnel to maintain contact with park security guards, monitor their presence, regularly check CCTV and security equipment and report malfunctions to concerned agencies. Police are to address deficiencies at bus stands, roads and isolated locations before incidents occur. Three men, including one injured in a brief exchange of fire, were arrested on Tuesday in connection with the alleged rape.

AAP's Bharadwaj questions 'lady CM' after 'gangrape'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 23

AAP Delhi unit president Saurabh Bharadwaj on Wednesday questioned the Delhi government's handling of women's safety after a 17-year-old girl was allegedly raped by three men at Aastha Kunj Park, following which Lady Shri Ram College for Women located nearby shifted its classes online.

Bharadwaj said the incident raised questions about the safety of women and students in the national capital, and asked what Delhi had achieved under the BJP government.

"What did Delhi achieve from BJP's lady CM? A 17-year-old getting gang-raped by three men on her birthday while returning from Kalkaji Temple. Even a prestigious college like LSR is forced to hold online classes," he said in a post on X.

On Monday evening, three men – Asif, Hemant and his brother Manish – allegedly posed as police personnel and took turns to rape the 17-year-old girl inside the Aastha Kunj Park near Kalkaji Mandir, police said.

The incident prompted Lady Shri Ram College to cancel regular classes Tuesday and shift classes online Wednesday, citing student safety. Bharadwaj also raised concerns over crimes against women and alleged cases against opposition leaders. The BJP had no immediate response.

Briefs

Indian univ enters THE World 100



NEW DELHI: Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham has become the first Indian university to join the Times Higher Education World 100 Reputation Network, a global community focused on institutional reputation and impact. The university ranked 37th globally in THE Sustainability Impact Rankings 2026.

Students get Delhi police station tour



NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police organised an event at Subhash Place and Maurya Enclave police stations to familiarise school students with police functioning and encourage interaction with personnel. As part of the initiative, 39 students of Classes 6-8 visited Subhash Place, while 33 Class 2 students visited Maurya Enclave.

Teenager fatally stabbed after accidental collision

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 23

A 17-year-old boy was allegedly stabbed to death following an altercation after he accidentally collided with three teenagers in a lane in central Delhi's Anand Parbat area, with police arresting a 19-year-old man and apprehending two minors, an official said on Wednesday.

The incident took place around 8:30 pm on Tuesday on Than Singh Road, where a PCR call was received regarding the stabbing of a person, they said.

The local police team reached the spot and found the teenager injured. He was rushed to Jeevan Mala Hospital by a constable along with mem-

bers of the public, where doctors declared him dead, police said. During the inquiry, police learnt that the teenager had allegedly been stabbed by three people. An FIR under murder charges was registered.

A dedicated team comprising police personnel from the station analysed CCTV footage, conducted technical surveillance and gathered local information to identify the suspects, officials said.

Three accused, including a 19-year-old and two minors aged 17 and 15, were apprehended. Police said an accidental collision led to an altercation, after which the teenager was stabbed. The knife allegedly used was recovered, and further investigation is underway.

Paid in chips, biscuits: 11 children rescued from illegal employment

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 23

Eleven child labourers, including two who were paid only in chips and biscuits instead of wages, were rescued from various roadside eateries and shops in south Delhi's Tigri, an NGO said on Wednesday.

The children, all boys aged between six and 17 years, were rescued during a joint operation in the area under Tigri police station, following information provided by the Association for Voluntary Action (AVA), a non-governmental organisation (NGO) that partners with government and communities to prevent child exploitation and strengthen child protection systems.



The two youngest children, aged six and 10, were found working at a slipper shop, where the shop owner allegedly gave them chips and biscuits instead of wages, according to the organisation. Five of the 11 children had not been paid any wages, while those who received payment were allegedly given only nominal amounts, it said.

The rescued children hail from Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and Maharashtra and were found working without proper wages and

safeguards and were given chips and biscuits instead of proper payment, according to the AVA.

The operation was carried out by the Deoli tehsildar, Labour Department officials, police personnel, representatives of the Child Development Department, AVA and Bal Vikas Dhara (BVD). Eleven establishments where the children were found working were sealed following the operation, the organisation said. The SDM recorded statements of all the rescued children, while an investigation was launched into the circumstances of their employment. Following the rescue, the children underwent medical examinations and were subsequently sent to a children's home, it added.

RENEWS FOCUS ON CASTE, CAMPUS WELFARE

JNU students protest over IIT student's death

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, September 23



The death of Sahil Wakode, a Dalit student at IIT Bombay, has triggered protests and renewed questions over institutional accountability, student welfare and caste discrimination on campuses.

Students at IIT Bombay have been protesting under the banner "Justice4Sahil", with demands including an independent investigation, accountability of the institute administration and action against Professor Sooryanarayana Doolla. Sahil's mother, Sonali Wakode, has alleged that the profes-

sor made casteist remarks towards her son, while his classmates and friends have also raised allegations of harassment. The allegations are yet to be established through an independent investigation.

The JNUSU, in a statement, described Sahil's death as an "institutional murder" and said IIT Bombay had witnessed four

student deaths in nine months. It has also criticised what it described as the administration's defence of the professor and called for a fair investigation. The IITB Faculty Forum has maintained that Professor Doolla discharged his duties in accordance with the institute's Senate-approved academic policies.

THE JNUSU, IN A STATEMENT, DESCRIBED SAHIL'S DEATH AS AN 'INSTITUTIONAL MURDER' AND SAID IIT BOMBAY HAD WITNESSED FOUR STUDENT DEATHS IN 9 MONTHS

The issue has resonated beyond IIT Bombay. At IIT Delhi, the death of 31-year-old MSc Physics student Rishikesh Kumar on August 22 had similarly raised concerns over student well-being. His mother, Asha Poddar, declined compensation and sought better mental-health support and accommodation for students.

At JNU, the JNUSU has organised a protest gathering at Sabarmati Dhaba on Wednesday at 5 p.m. in solidarity with the protesting IIT Bombay students. Its demands include student representation in academic committees, a task force to address student suicides, mental-health sensitisation for faculty, strengthening of student wellness centres and an anonymous grievance mechanism. For students, the protests are also about whether institutions provide avenues to raise concerns safely and whether those concerns are heard before a crisis becomes irreversible.

915 fines issued for wrong-side driving

Southern Range clears encroachments

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, September 23

The Delhi Traffic Police issued 915 challans for wrong-side driving and registered FIRs during a drive in the New Delhi Range over the week.

The drive focused on intersections, median openings, service roads and market areas to curb shortcuts and improve lane discipline. Across Delhi, 33,005 challans for wrong-side driving have been issued in 2026, with 417 FIRs registered.

Meanwhile, the South-

ern Range conducted anti-encroachment drives on September 19 and 20 with police to ease movement of vehicles and pedestrians.

Teams issued 829 challans for improper parking, including 266 e-challans and 563 notices, removed 98 rehri-patri structures and towed eight vehicles.

The drives targeted unauthorised parking, roadside shops and obstructions causing congestion and forcing pedestrians onto carriageways.

Police said such operations will continue at vulnerable locations.

DURGA e-auto: Women with 3+ children barred

1,300 pink autos for women, transgender persons in 1st phase

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 23

The Delhi Cabinet on Wednesday approved the ‘DURGA’ e-auto scheme, paving the way for women and transgender persons to own and drive electric autos while creating new livelihood opportunities and expanding safe last-mile transport in the Capital. The first phase will see allocation of 1,300 pink electric autos.

The Upliftment and Rozgar for Women/Transgender Green E-Auto scheme was approved at a Cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta. Of the 1,300 autos, 1,170 will be allocated to women and 130 to transgender beneficiaries. A maximum of 90 autos for women and 10 for transgender persons will be allocated in each revenue district.

Applications will be invited through a dedicated online portal, with benefits available to applicants meeting the pre-

CLOSER LOOK

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» Applications will be invited through a dedicated online portal, with benefits available to applicants meeting the prescribed eligibility criteria

» Under the scheme, women applicants must be aged between 20 and 40 years, residents of Delhi and possess a valid voter ID, LMV driving licence and PSV badge

scribed eligibility criteria.

Under the scheme, women applicants must be aged between 20 and 40 years, residents of Delhi and possess a valid voter ID, LMV driving licence and PSV badge. Women with more than three children will not be eligible. The applicant or her family must not own a registered transport vehicle or three-wheeler, while annual family income for 2025-26 must not exceed Rs 5 lakh.

Transgender applicants will also have to meet the age and residency requirements and possess a voter

ID, LMV licence and PSV badge, besides a valid transgender certificate issued by the Delhi District Magistrate.

The e-autos will carry distinct ‘DURGA’ branding and identification features. Vehicles will have a mandatory three-year lock-in period, during which they cannot be sold, transferred or disposed of. Gupta said the scheme was aimed at combining economic empowerment with safer and cleaner transport.

“‘DURGA’ scheme will give women and transgender persons an opportu-

nity to become owners and drivers of electric autos. It will provide them with dignified self-employment while also helping make Delhi’s public transport system more accessible and inclusive,” she said.

The scheme will also be linked with Delhi’s public transport network. The DMRC has made space for EV charging facilities available at 70 Metro stations, according to the government.

The government said the scheme could also generate employment in allied sectors such as repair, servicing, charging and battery recycling. It will simultaneously support electric mobility and last-mile connectivity.

Calling it a step towards a safer, greener and more inclusive Delhi, Gupta said the initiative would seek to bring “safety, employment, inclusion and environment-friendly transport” together while increasing the participation of women and transgender persons in the transport sector.

BTA: ₹1,850 crore civic funds cleared; MCD gets lion’s share

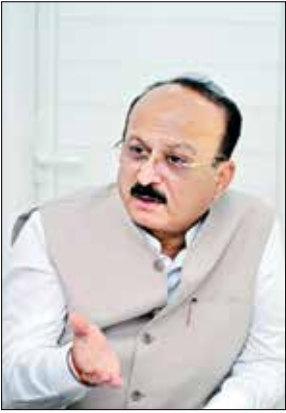
AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 23

In a major funding push for civic services, the Delhi government has sanctioned the second instalment of Rs 1,850.66 crore under the Basic Tax Assignment (BTA) for 2026-27, with the lion’s share going to the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD).

Urban Development Minister Ashish Sood announced the release on Wednesday, saying the funds would help civic bodies maintain essential services and carry out local infrastructure works across the Capital. The concurrence for the release was approved on September 21.

Of the total amount, MCD will receive Rs 1,820.40 crore, while the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) has been allocated Rs 17.95 crore and the Delhi Cantonment Board (DCB) Rs 12.31 crore.

The second instalment forms part of the total BTA allocation of Rs 3,701.32 crore for the financial year. The government had already released the first instalment of Rs 925.33 crore, while the remaining Rs 925.33 crore is scheduled to be released for the



January-March 2027 period.

Under the allocation structure, the second instalment covers the July-December 2026 period.

The government said the funds will support core civic responsibilities, including waste collection and garbage disposal, repair and maintenance of neighbourhood roads, streetlights and parks, as well as the functioning of primary schools and local health dispensaries. Sood said timely fund releases were essential for keeping civic works running. “Our government is committed to transforming Delhi’s urban infrastructure and ensuring financial support for public welfare,” he said.

Taking a swipe at the

previous government, Sood added, “Under the previous government, funds were constantly delayed, stalling essential public works and creating financial distress for local municipal bodies. We have ended that era of policy paralysis. Our administration is ensuring timely fund releases so that development works run without any hurdles.”

The MCD’s allocation accounts for nearly 98 per cent of the second instalment, reflecting its significantly larger share of the BTA pool. Its total BTA allocation for 2026-27 stands at Rs 3,640.80 crore, compared with Rs 35.90 crore for NDMC and Rs 24.61 crore for DCB.

The minister also directed civic bodies to maintain financial discipline while utilising the grants. The funds are to be used strictly for public-interest purposes, with Utilisation Certificates (UCs) required to be submitted within the prescribed timelines.

The government said the sanctioned amounts will be transferred directly to the civic bodies through electronic bank transfers, including RTGS and NEFT.

SIX PROJECTS TO REVAMP AREAS AROUND METRO STATIONS

L-G approves elevated corridor in south Delhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 23

Delhi Lt Governor TS Sandhu on Wednesday approved the construction of a 5.5-km-long elevated corridor on the Maa Anandmayee Marg, paving the way for the project aimed at decongesting the key arterial road in south Delhi.

Sandhu who headed a meeting of Unified Traffic and Transportation Infrastructure (Planning and Engineering) Centre (UTTIPEC) also approved multi-modal integration (MMI) plans for six additional metro stations for improving access to last-mile connectivity.

UTTIPEC, under the Delhi Development Authority (DDA), is the

highest governing body for approval of infrastructure projects.

“The projects approved during the meeting will help improve connectivity to metro stations, make last-mile access more convenient and safer for pedestrians and ease congestion at some of Delhi’s key traffic points,” a DDA official said.

The roadways are expected to facilitate smoother movement for commuters, while the MMI plans will strengthen the connection between public transport and surrounding areas. Together, these measures will contribute to more efficient, safer and better-connected commute for people across Delhi, the official said.



“The flyover on Maa Anandmayee Marg will bypass around 12 intersections on the road and is aimed at easing traffic congestion caused by the mix of traffic generated from the Okhla Phase I and II industrial areas,” the DDA officer said.

A proposed underpass and roundabout at the Crowne Plaza intersection will further help in decongesting vehicular traffic on Okhla Estate Marg.

“With lower traffic volumes at ground level, the project will also facilitate better provisions for pedestrian and non-motorised transport infrastructure along Maa Anandmayee Marg,” he added.

The MMI plans approved during the meeting covered six metro station – GTB Nagar on the Yellow Line, Sarita Vihar on the Violet Line, Akshardham on the Blue Line, Rohini West/Dr Baba Saheb Ambedkar Hospital on the Red Line, Malviya Nagar on the Yellow Line and Shastri Park on the Red Line.

The MMI plans cover an influence zone of approximately 300 metres around a Mass Rapid Transit System station. As per the plan, areas around metro stations will be revamped for construction of dedicated lanes for auto-rickshaw, pedestrians and vehicle pick-and-drop facilities.

The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) had prepared MMI plans for 31 metro stations across Phase I and II metro corridors in Delhi. With the approval of these six plans, all 31 MMI plans have now been approved by UTTIPEC, officials said.

The UTTIPEC also approved a project aimed at decongesting Mukarba Chowk in North West Delhi.

NDMC turns waste into compost and... walls into public art

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, September 23

The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) on Wednesday felicitated seven sanitation workers for producing 13,000 kg of organic compost from wet and horticultural waste over the past year and honoured 15 artists for creating traditional and contemporary Indian murals across the city.

NDMC Chairman Manoj Kumar Dwivedi felicitated the sanitation staff at Palika Kendra and lauded their contribution to decentralised waste processing. The compost was produced at the facility on Madhu Limaye Marg, Chanakya-puri, using biodegradable waste generated within the NDMC area.

Dwivedi said the initiative demonstrated the potential of converting waste into a resource and called for the model at Anupam Colony to be replicated at other locations. The council said decentralised processing could reduce the transpor-

tation of green waste and facilitate its use as organic manure for landscaping and greenery. The initiative is part of NDMC’s “Waste to Wealth” and “Waste to Greenery” approach and its stated goal of achieving zero waste to landfill through source segregation and resource recovery.

Separately, the Chairman felicitated 15 artists who participated in a seven-day workshop held from September 17 to 23 under the Seva Sankalp Abhiyan. Artists from Delhi, Tamil Nadu, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan and Haryana created murals at five locations around Connaught Place and Panchkuian Road.

The murals, covering around 4,200 sq ft, combine traditional Indian artistic forms with contemporary approaches. The project, themed around art, heritage, culture and the vision of Viksit Bharat @2047, aims to beautify public spaces while showcasing India’s cultural heritage and contemporary aspirations.

‘Chandni Chowk’s iconic Town Hall redevelopment to cost Rs 225 crore’

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 23

A major redevelopment proposal for the iconic Town Hall situated in Delhi’s Chandni Chowk has been initiated with an estimate cost of Rs 225 crore, officials said on Wednesday.

An MoU was signed between the Delhi Tourism and Transportation Development Corporation (DTTDC) and the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) in the presence of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta at the Delhi Secretariat on Sunday.

The Delhi government on Wednesday launched a Metro-based awareness campaign to take information about its welfare and public-interest schemes directly to commuters as part of the ‘Seva Sankalp Abhiyan’.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta flagged off a special Delhi Metro train carrying information on various government schemes and citizen services from ITO Metro Station. The campaign will use wrapped Metro trains, digital screens and permanent panels at stations to reach commuters across the city.

The initiative will cover



information on several schemes, including the Ayushman Vay Vandana Yojana, last-mile connectivity initiatives, measures for micro, small and medium enterprises, collateral-free loans of up to Rs 10 crore, tax benefits and subsidies under the Electric Vehicle Policy, the PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana and the Atal Canteen scheme offer-

ing meals at Rs 5.

The campaign will also highlight the Delhi Laxmi Yojana, under which the government provides monthly assistance of Rs 2,500 to women in need, expansion of the Delhi Metro, the Swachh Delhi-Green Delhi campaign, Saheli Pink Smart Card for women, regularisation of 1,511 unauthor-

ised colonies and the Clean Yamuna Mission.

According to the government, the campaign will extend beyond train wrapping. Messages about schemes and services will be displayed on digital screens and video walls across the Metro network for 15 seconds every five minutes. Permanent publicity panels will also be installed at Metro stations.

Gupta said the initiative was aimed at ensuring that eligible beneficiaries received information about schemes in an accessible manner.

“The objective of the ‘Seva Sankalp Abhiyan’ is to bring information about government schemes and services closer to citizens.

Balak Ram Hosp gets MCD Commissioner’s inspection

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, September 23

Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar on Wednesday inspected Balak Ram Hospital in North Delhi and directed officials to improve access to the facility and ensure adequate deployment of staff.

During the inspection, Khirwar reviewed the facilities available at the hospital and directed officials to construct a proper pathway from the main approach road to the hospital entrance to facilitate the movement of patients and visitors.

He also ordered the relocation of a tree within the hospital premises, citing the need to prevent obstruction to patients and ensure smooth delivery of medical services. The Commissioner directed officials to deploy adequate manpower at the hospital and asked staff to work with greater focus on the convenience of citizens.

Timarpur MLA Surya Prakash Khatri, Additional Commissioner Pankaj Naresh Agarwal, North Zone Deputy Commissioner Shweta Nagarkoti, Engineer-in-Chief K.K. Sharma and other senior MCD officials were present during the inspection.

Khirwar later inspected Wazirabad and interacted with residents to take stock of civic issues in the area. He directed officials to undertake desilting and cleaning of drains by removing accumulated silt.

The Commissioner also ordered the removal of ramps that were obstructing access to the drains and hampering cleaning operations. Officials were directed to demolish such ramps to facilitate proper maintenance of the drainage network.

The inspection comes amid the civic body’s ongoing efforts to address local infrastructure and sanitation-related issues, with officials directed to ensure that residents do not face inconvenience due to blocked or poorly maintained drains.

Briefs

Min inspects GB Pant Hosp

NEW DELHI: Delhi Health minister Pankaj Kumar Singh on Wednesday inspected GB Pant Hospital and directed authorities to ensure 100 per cent availabilities of medicines. During the random check across wards and pharmacy, the minister interacted with the patients, attendants and doctors, the Health department said.

Transport dept puts challan changes on hold

NEW DELHI: Amid an ongoing protest by lawyers, the Delhi government has put on hold implementation of notification by the transport department making changes on new challan system in the national capital. Transport Minister Pankaj Singh on Wednesday said the transport department has been asked to examine the matter raised by advocates regarding the changes made to the Central Motor Vehicle Rules (CMVR), 1989.

FOOD DEPARTMENT STEPS UP CHECKS AMID RISING DEMAND FOR SWEETS, MILK PRODUCTS

Festive crackdown: Over 4,100 kg khoya, paneer destroyed

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 23

With the festive season fueling demand for sweets and milk-based products, the Delhi government has intensified its crackdown on suspected food adulteration, with more than 4,100 kg of khoya and paneer destroyed during enforcement drives over the past month. At Mori Gate Khoya Mandi alone, 22 of 30 khoya



samples tested were found unsafe for human consumption, while 12 of 19 paneer and chhena samples

failed to meet prescribed standards.

The action was carried out by the Food Safety

Department on the directions of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, with inspections conducted at major markets and food-selling points, including Okhla Sabzi Mandi, Mori Gate Khoya Mandi, Bagh Diwar, Sanjay Market, Janakpuri, Shahdara, Ghazipur and Jheel. Of the 30 khoya samples collected from Mori Gate, only eight were found to meet the prescribed standards, while 22 were

declared unsafe for human consumption. Similarly, test reports for 19 paneer and chhena samples showed that seven conformed to the standards and 12 did not.

Following the test results, the department has initiated prosecution proceedings against the concerned food business operators under the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006. Enforcement teams also conducted inspec-

tions on Wednesday at Khari Baoli, Okhla Sabzi Mandi, Jheel in East Delhi and Janakpuri Mandi. The department said inspections, sampling and action against suspected or unsafe food products would continue through the festive season. Gupta said the government would not compromise on food safety during the period when consumption of sweets and dairy products increases.

“Festivals are a time for happiness and celebration, and a large number of people purchase sweets and milk-based products during this period. Those who put people’s health at risk through adulteration will face strict action by the Delhi Government. Adulteration will not be tolerated at any cost, and those violating food safety regulations will face stringent action under the law,” she said.

ON DAY 1

Chintan Shivr

discusses governance, reforms, outreach to youth & women

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 23

The first day of ‘Chintan Shivr’ of the entire council of ministers of the Modi government on Wednesday discussed a host of issues, including governance, reforms and outreach to women and youth on welfare and development schemes, sources said.

During the over four-hour meeting, the ministers also discussed how to further improve the delivery mechanism of the government with close coordination among different ministries and departments, the sources aware of the deliberations said.

The ministers were

KEY POINTS

- » ‘During the over four-hour meeting, the ministers also discussed how to further improve the delivery mechanism of the government with close coordination among different ministries and departments’
- » ‘The ministers were divided into eight groups, with Prime Minister Narendra Modi interacting with each of them’
- » Modi is learnt to have taken feedback from the ministers and advised them on how to go about various aspects of the government.

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The ministers dis-

cussed issues related to governance, reforms and outreach to women and youth on welfare and development schemes, the sources said.

The other issues that were deliberated by the ministers included ‘Jan Vishwas Se Jan Aadhaar’,

reforms in all aspects of the government and priorities towards Viksit Bharat@2047.

The two-day brainstorming session has been called for stocktaking, improving coordination, preparing the future agenda, planning, reviewing the work under way on welfare schemes, and infrastructure projects, among others, the sources said.

The exercise of taking stock of different aspects of the government through such a conclave is expected to be held next week too, they said.

The Viksit Bharat exercise has been underway since 2021, with 10 sectoral groups of secretaries constituted to prepare

short-term and long-term roadmaps to achieve the goal.

Vast stakeholder consultation was also done for this exercise.

Since then, there have been eight presentations and discussions before the council of ministers on different aspects of Viksit Bharat@2047.

The ongoing ‘Chintan Shivr’ takes this process forward, the sources said.

It brings together the work being done by groups of secretaries, ministries and departments, Cabinet Secretariat and NITI Aayog, including reforms, ease of living, reduction of compliances and other governance priorities.

Mirabai ends Asiad jinx...

Continued from Page 1

The Tokyo Olympic silver medallist, who has built a decorated career at the international level, described the moment as one that made her “life complete”.

Shooting produced contrasting results. Double Olympic medallist Manu Bhaker, Suruchi Singh and Esha Singh failed to win medals in either the women’s 10m air pistol team or individual events. Bhaker was the only Indian to reach the individual final, where she finished fifth. She later spoke about the emotional toll following the death of her childhood coach Jaspal Rana in June.

India salvaged two bronze medals in skeet. Raiza Dhillon, Maheshwari Chauhan and Parinaaz Dhaliwal combined for 331 points to finish third in the women’s team event behind China and Kazakhstan. Raiza and Pari-

naaz reached the individual final but missed the podium.

In the men’s event, Anantjeet Singh Naruka, Mairaj Ahmad Khan and Bhavtegh Singh Gill secured bronze with 346 points. Naruka reached the individual final and finished fourth. India also secured a bronze through soft tennis player Jay Meena, who became the country’s first Asian Games medallist in the sport. Meena had failed to win a medal in the previous two editions.

The men’s badminton team, silver medallists at Hangzhou in 2023, lost 1-3 to China in the semifinals. Lakshya Sen went down 16-21, 18-21 to Shi Yu Qi, while Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty defeated world champions Liang Wei Keng and Wang Chang 21-11, 22-20.

Ayush Shetty and the second doubles pair of Hariharan Amsakarunan and MR Arjun lost their matches.

In table tennis, Diya

Chitale and Manush Shah advanced to the mixed doubles quarterfinals with a 3-0 win over Moosa Ahmed and Aishath Nazeem. They will face Hong Kong’s Doo Hoi Kim and Wong Chun Ting on Thursday, with a win assuring a medal. In squash, Abhay Singh, Veer Chotrani and Tanvi Khanna moved into the round of 16 with comfortable victories.

India also stayed unbeaten in women’s hockey, with Deepika Sehrawat scoring a record nine goals in a 20-1 win over Thailand. The men’s and women’s kabaddi teams also registered comprehensive group-stage victories over Bangladesh and Iran respectively. Roshibina Devi Naorem entered the women’s 60kg wushu final after beating Indonesia’s Thania Kusumaningtyas 2-0. She will face China’s Xiaoyu Zhang in the gold-medal bout.

From page 1

‘Impeach, arrest CEC’

Banerjee said INDIA bloc partners had discussed the matter and would meet soon. She also called for nationwide protests as long as Kumar remained CEC.

Shiv Sena (UBT) chief Uddhav Thackeray and AAP national convener Arvind Kejriwal demanded that CEC Gyanesh Kumar be jailed and immediately removed from his post.

“Impeach CEC to save democracy,” TMC (Mamata faction) MP Derek O’Brien said.

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge said that in April, 73 Opposition Rajya Sabha MPs had submitted a fresh Notice of Motion to the Secretary General seeking the removal of CEC Kumar. “The Monsoon Session of Parliament has not yet been prorogued. Will the Hon’ble Rajya Sabha Chairman now decide on that pending Notice?” Kharge said, adding that the country will demand answers from Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

Congress general secretary in-charge of communications Jairam Ramesh, however, alleged that CEC Kumar had functioned as a “hatchet man” for Union Home Minister Amit Shah, who, in turn, was the designated executor of the PM’s wishes.

Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah said the central government and Election Commission needed to take corrective steps to prevent people from losing faith in the electoral process. Thackeray demanded that CEC Gyanesh Kumar be jailed and that the recent elections in Maharashtra, West Bengal and Tamil Nadu be nullified and repolls held in these states using ballot papers.

“Gyanesh Kumar should be immediately sacked and jailed,” the former Maharashtra chief minister said, thanking the ECs for “exposing” Kumar.

Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav said in Lucknow that governments formed during a period when the Election Commission was not functioning impartially were “unconstitutional”, and that “interference” with the poll panel amounted to “trampling” democracy.

“This means that the governments which have been formed during this period are unconstitutional governments,” Yadav said. Senior Congress spokesperson Abhishek Singhvi said there was no doubt remaining that Gyanesh Kumar had no right to remain in office and must resign. He said this was a serious issue and an example of “double bulldozer sarkar”.

“An external bulldozer works against institutions and internal bulldozer is the CEC who has bulldozed his own organisation and his own colleagues and has hijacked the EC,” Singhvi said.

In a statement, the CPI(M) Politburo said the revelations raised serious questions not just about the process, but more

importantly about the integrity of the ECI itself.

CPI(M) MP John Brittas said this was no longer an Election Commission, but a “one-man autocracy” under CEC Kumar. Parliament must immediately start the process for the removal of the CEC, he said.

CPI general secretary D Raja said CEC Gyanesh Kumar must resign over the “electoral purge”. TMC’s Abhishek Banerjee demanded the removal of CEC Kumar and sought a court-monitored investigation into the functioning of the poll panel.

“The CEC must be removed immediately and a court-monitored investigation ordered,” he said. He alleged that “disenfranchising lakhs of voters to allegedly benefit one political party strikes at the very foundation of our democracy”, and said those responsible must be held accountable.

Kejriwal too demanded that the entire SIR exercise be cancelled and that CEC Kumar be immediately arrested, alleging that he was running the Election Commission on his own and making the SIR carried out across the country “illegal”.

“So today, we demand that the entire SIR process be cancelled, that all changes made under SIR be cancelled, and that the voter list from three years ago be restored,” the AAP chief said. Kumar should be arrested and a case of sedition registered against him, he added.

Addressing a press conference at the BJP headquarters here, party spokesperson Sambit Patra said, “The media reports saying that the election commissioners shared differing views in official deliberations is a reflection of pure democracy.”

“If there is no communication and exchange of views among the election commissioners who conduct polls, the opposition parties would allege ‘dictatorship’ and call them ‘yes men’ of the government,” he charged. Meanwhile, the Election Commission asserted that all its official orders, decisions and administrative directions carry full legal sanctions and that differing views and observations are a normal part of deliberation in any institution.

It said suggestions from the commissioners were aimed at improving electoral processes and maintained that the final decisions of the full commission, including those relating to the SIR, were unanimous. Neither Sandhu nor Joshi has publicly spoken about the objections attributed to them.

ECI

team in New Delhi. This raised concerns about the integrity of the electoral process, with key software functions being centrally controlled by Khanna’s division.

The two Election Commissioners raised red flags over the “gradual centralisation of the electoral roll database” and warned that ECINet was restricting the powers of officers on the ground who were responsible for preparing and finalising the

rolls. The Indian Express report said that Goa’s Electoral Registration Officer (ERO) found 97 voters eligible for inclusion in the final roll after hearing their cases and verifying the documents they had submitted. However, the software had no mechanism to record the ERO’s decision, leaving the 97 voters out of the final electoral roll in Goa. Though the number was small, the report noted that the ECI’s responsibility was to ensure that every eligible vote was counted.

On three occasions, the two ECs copied their notes to CEC Gyanesh Kumar. In effect, they were flagging what they viewed as violations of the law. Over 10 months, from November to August, the two Commissioners repeatedly raised their concerns in writing. In an unprecedented move, the two Commissioners also wrote separately to the Cabinet Secretary about the IT Division’s work and the integrity of the voter software.

The SIR process was most contested in West Bengal, which went to polls in April this year and saw the BJP oust the TMC after securing a historic victory.

Around 91 lakh voters were deleted from the electoral rolls in Bengal following the SIR exercise. Last week, the ECI told the Supreme Court that 38 lakh appeals were pending before tribunals. Of these, 22.21 lakh were filed by deleted voters.

Interestingly, another 16.10 lakh appeals were filed against voters whose names had been included by judicial officers and whose deletion was subsequently sought.

The Express investigation revealed that Sandhu flagged this issue, questioning why the ECI had appealed against voters whose names judicial officers had included. Sandhu recorded that neither he nor Joshi nor the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) of West Bengal had been informed about the basis or process for filing the appeals.

The objections raised by the two Election Commissioners related to the core of the ECI’s mandate: new voter registration; deletion and restoration of names from the rolls; filing appeals against orders restoring voters during the SIR process; and the custody and security of the entire electoral roll database.

All objections relating to these issues were copied to CEC Gyanesh Kumar. Sandhu alleged that the ECI acted against the written advice of the two Commissioners and described its actions as “unauthorised and illegal”.

The rift has raised concerns over the concentration of power in a centrally controlled electoral-roll system that, according to the objections, effectively cut EROs out of key decisions. The SIR also raised concerns about the next generation of voters after Form 6, the statutory form used by new voters to register, was changed without the approval of the two ECs.

The revised Form 6 required applicants to choose one of three statements: whether their

name appeared in the electoral roll during the last SIR held in the early 2000s; whether the name of a parent or grandparent appeared in that roll; or whether neither their name nor that of their parents appeared in it.

The Indian Express investigation revealed that the two ECs pointed out that Form 6 was a statutory form embedded in the rules and could not be changed without government approval. Sandhu wrote that the “unauthorised/illegal changes in Form-6 on the portal” had not been removed and that the original form had not been restored. He said the changes “must be removed immediately so that young and would-be first-time voters, who are otherwise eligible, can register themselves as voters as per law, without any harassment.”

TMC MPs

before the Speaker on June 18, alleging that the MPs had voluntarily given up TMC membership. Senior advocate Kalyan Banerjee, appearing for the petitioner, said notices were issued to the MPs on August 5. Their initial 14-day response period was extended till September 22, while another extension has now been sought.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta opposed judicially prescribing a time limit, saying the MPs must be given adequate opportunity to respond.

The Bench referred to the apex court’s earlier guidance in Keisham Meghachandra Singh on deciding disqualification petitions within a reasonable period, with three months indicated in ordinary circumstances.

The court declined to fix a rigid deadline but kept the plea pending to monitor progress. The matter will be heard after six weeks.

Justice Datta

Under the provision, the Selection Committee consists of the Prime Minister as chairperson, the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha and a Union Cabinet Minister nominated by the Prime Minister. The law removed the Chief Justice of India from the selection panel.

Justice Datta questioned the committee’s independence, saying the Prime Minister’s nominee could not be expected to “defy his own nominator”, especially when his membership depended on the PM’s nomination.

He also relied on Article 75(3) of the Constitution, which provides for collective responsibility of the Council of Ministers. Justice Datta said it was difficult to expect a minister bound by that principle to disagree with the Prime Minister on appointments to a sensitive constitutional office.

He therefore held that the Cabinet minister could not provide an independent counterweight, making the Leader of Opposition’s presence “largely ornamental”.

Justice Datta said the issue was not whether individuals

eventually appointed under the law would necessarily lack integrity or qualifications. Rather, the question was whether the appointment mechanism itself would generate public confidence in the independence of the Election Commission of India.

“If free and fair elections are to be ensured, it is axiomatic that the ECI must not only be an independent body but also be seen to act independently,” he said.

The petitioners had argued that even a competent appointment could face doubts if the process itself appeared tilted towards the executive. They compared the situation to an umpire in a cricket match being selected by one side, arguing that decisions could still be viewed with suspicion because of the manner in which the umpire was chosen.

Justice Datta said the petitioners’ contention that the 2023 Act gives the executive “overwhelming selection power” and thereby affects the appearance of independence required under Article 324 and the basic structure of the Constitution had prima facie substance.

He also compared the statutory panel with the temporary arrangement prescribed by the Supreme Court in March 2023 in Anoop Baranwal v. Union of India. In that judgment, a five-judge Constitution Bench had directed that appointments to the Election Commission be made on the advice of a committee comprising the Prime Minister, the Leader of Opposition and the CJI.

The 2023 law was enacted by Parliament in December, months after that judgment, and replaced the court-prescribed arrangement by excluding the CJI. The Supreme Court had earlier declined to stay appointments of election commissioners made under the new law.

Justice Sharma, however, took a different view from Justice Datta on whether the challenge should be referred to a Constitution Bench. He considered the question of whether Parliament could exclude a neutral selector from the appointment committee to be a substantial issue of constitutional interpretation that had not previously been settled by the court.

The disagreement between the judges therefore centred not only on the composition of the selection panel but also on whether existing constitutional jurisprudence was sufficient to decide the challenge or whether a larger bench was necessary.

Justice Datta said the existing constitutional principles concerning free and fair elections and the independence of the ECI provided a basis for examining the 2023 law. Justice Sharma’s view was that the constitutional question arising from Parliament’s decision to exclude the CJI warranted consideration by a larger bench.

Justice Datta also addressed the Centre’s argument that constitutional trust placed in the office of the Prime Minister meant decisions taken by the

Prime Minister should not be questioned. He discussed concerns relating to constitutional morality and institutional functioning, while also noting that false criminal cases can be used to malign public figures.

The judge made clear that his observations were prima facie and did not amount to a final ruling on the constitutional validity of the law.

The matter will now go before CJI Surya Kant for consideration of the constitution of a bench of appropriate strength. Any larger bench will have to consider the validity of Section 7 and the related provisions challenged before the court, including whether the appointment mechanism provides sufficient institutional independence and public confidence in the Election Commission.

Jaishankar

the Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026 into law last week. The legislation authorises tariffs of up to 100 per cent on countries purchasing Russian oil and gas, including India and China. New Delhi has said it will take all necessary steps to protect its economic interests and ensure energy security.

Rubio said India and the US were coordinating on key regional priorities and upcoming multilateral efforts.

US State Department spokesperson Thomas Pigott, however, said the sanctions legislation was still going through the legislative process and declined to comment on it until it was finalised. On Ukraine, he said Washington wanted a durable peace and urged countries supporting Russia to consider whether their actions were worsening the situation.

Pigott described India-US ties as “a very important relationship” and pointed to Rubio’s first meeting in January 2025 with the foreign ministers of the Quad countries.

Rubio visited India in May and invited Prime Minister Narendra Modi to the White House. In July, Rubio and Jaishankar met in Manila, discussing trade, tariffs, energy, defence, critical minerals and artificial intelligence, and the need to finalise an interim trade deal.

Indian national killed

Our heartfelt condolences to the bereaved family,” the Indian mission said in a post on X.

It is not yet clear who attacked the vessel.

The embassy said it was coordinating with the RPSL and was in touch with the family of the deceased.

AGENCIES

Monsoon spell

The last shorter spell was recorded in 2012, when the monsoon stayed for 80 days.

Despite the shorter duration, Delhi received above-normal rainfall. Safdarjung recorded 728.6 mm between June 1 and

September 23, against the normal 629.7 mm, an excess of 16 per cent. An IMD official said that no major rainfall record was broken, noting that the city had received more than 900 mm in each of the previous two years.

Rainfall was particularly heavy in August, when Safdarjung recorded 354.1 mm, 59 per cent above normal. On August 25, it received 99.1 mm in 24 hours, its highest August daily rainfall in two years.

September was considerably drier, with 74.7 mm recorded till September 23 and only three rainy days.

The monsoon also withdrew from most parts of Punjab, Haryana and Rajasthan, and some areas of Uttar Pradesh and Gujarat. Since 1961, Delhi’s earliest withdrawal was on September 3 in 1982, while the latest was October 17 in 2013.

Ayushman Bharat

More than 13 crore beneficiaries have availed treatment under the scheme, with hospitalisation and treatment worth over Rs 2 lakh crore provided through more than 39,000 empanelled public and private hospitals, he said.

Government data showed that 48.51 crore Ayushman cards had been issued as of September 21. As of August 31, AB-PMJAY had funded 13.25 crore hospital admissions worth Rs 2.03 lakh crore through more than 38,000 empanelled hospitals.

Nadda said the figures represented families receiving protection from medical expenses and patients being able to access treatment without the fear of financial hardship. “Behind every number is a story - a family protected from the burden of medical debt, a patient receiving timely treatment, a loved one relieved of pain, and a household able to face illness without the fear of financial hardship,” he said.

Launched on September 23, 2018, AB-PMJAY provides cashless hospitalisation cover of up to Rs 5 lakh per family annually for secondary and tertiary care. It forms the financial protection component of Ayushman Bharat, which also includes Ayushman Arogya Mandirs, the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and the Pradhan Mantri Ayushman Bharat Health Infrastructure Mission.

Banks to remain

The Reserve Bank of India has approved the operation of bank branches, offices, ATM-linked branches and currency chests on September 27.

The strike would coincide with the half-yearly closing of banks on September 30. Bank managements have urged unions to defer the strike, while customers have been advised to use UPI, internet and mobile banking, ATMs and BC Points and complete urgent transactions early.

MPOST



Chhattisgarh
Business Made
Easy



Shri Vishnu Deo Sai
Hon'ble Chief Minister, Chhattisgarh

Shri Narendra Modi
Hon'ble Prime Minister

Chhattisgarh BUILDING THE INDUSTRIES OF TOMORROW

Rapidly Diversifying into New-age Sectors; Grounding Investments and Creating Jobs

₹ 8.23 Lakh Crore
Investment Commitments Till Date

1.5 Lakh+ Jobs
Expected

50% Thrust
Sector Projects

Diversification in Action

- India's First AI Data center Park in Nava Raipur
- Central India's Largest Pharma Park
- State's First ₹18,000+ Cr Semiconductor Plant in Nava Raipur
- Manufacturing base of India's largest pet food brand



#CGBusinessEasy

f @ X in
Invest Chhattisgarh

"Chhattisgarh is no longer defined only by what it extracts from the ground, but by what it is building for the future, real projects, real jobs and a diversified, modern economy."
- Vishnu Deo Sai, Chief Minister, Chhattisgarh

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(Please use this QR Code to view the Red Herring Prospectus and the Abridged Prospectus)

A-ONE STEELS INDIA LIMITED

(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)

Our Company was incorporated as "A-One Steel and Alloys Private Limited", a private limited company under the Companies Act, 1956 through a certificate of incorporation dated April 9, 2012, issued by the Registrar of Companies, Karnataka at Bangalore. Subsequently, the name of our Company was changed to "A-One Steels India Private Limited" pursuant to a board resolution dated May 6, 2024, and shareholders' resolutions at the extraordinary general meeting held on May 6, 2024 and a fresh certificate of incorporation dated June 29, 2024 consequent to change of name was issued by the Central Processing Centre, Registrar of Companies, at Gurgaon. Our Company was then converted into a public limited company under the Companies Act, 2013 pursuant to a special resolution adopted by our Shareholders on August 30, 2024, consequent to which, the name of our Company was changed to "A-one Steels India Limited" and a fresh certificate of incorporation, consequent upon change of name, was issued to our Company by the Registrar of Companies, Central Processing Centre on December 23, 2024. For further details, see "**History and Certain Corporate Matters – Brief History of our Company**" beginning on page 406 of the Red Herring Prospectus ("RHP") filed with RoC.

Corporate Identity Number: U28999KA2012PLC063439
Registered Office: A One House, No. 326, CQAL Layout, Ward No. 08, Sahakarnagar, Bangalore – 560 092, Karnataka, India. Contact Person: Pooja Sara Nagaraja, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer; Telephone: 080-4564 6000; E-mail: legal@aonesteelgroup.com; Website: www.aonesteelgroup.com

PROMOTERS OF OUR COMPANY: SANDEEP KUMAR, SUNIL JALLAN AND KRISHAN KUMAR JALAN

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF A-ONE STEELS INDIA LIMITED ("OUR COMPANY" OR THE "COMPANY" OR THE "ISSUER COMPANY") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A PREMIUM OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("OFFER PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹40,500 LAKHS (THE "OFFER"). THE OFFER COMPRISES OF A FRESH ISSUE OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹35,500 LAKHS BY OUR COMPANY (THE "FRESH ISSUE") AND AN OFFER FOR SALE OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹5,000 LAKHS COMPRISING AN OFFER FOR SALE OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹2,000 LAKHS BY SANDEEP KUMAR, UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹2,000 LAKHS BY SUNIL JALLAN AND UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹1,000 LAKHS BY KRISHAN KUMAR JALAN (THE "PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS" AND COLLECTIVELY THE "SELLING SHAREHOLDERS", AND EACH INDIVIDUALLY, AS A "SELLING SHAREHOLDER" AND SUCH OFFER FOR SALE OF EQUITY SHARES BY THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS, THE "OFFER FOR SALE"). THIS OFFER INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹200.00 LAKHS (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL) FOR PURCHASE BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES (THE "EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION"). THE OFFER LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET OFFER". THE OFFER AND THE NET OFFER WOULD CONSTITUTE [●]% AND [●]%, RESPECTIVELY, OF OUR POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL.

DETAILS OF THE OFFER FOR SALE			
Name of Promoter Selling Shareholder	Type	Maximum Number of Equity Shares Offered / Amount	Weighted Average Cost of Acquisition per Equity Share of Face Value of ₹10 (in ₹)*
Sandeep Kumar	Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to [●] Equity Shares aggregating up to ₹2,000.00 lakhs	6.57
Sunil Jallan	Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to [●] Equity Shares aggregating up to ₹2,000.00 lakhs	8.04
Krishan Kumar Jalan	Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to [●] Equity Shares aggregating up to ₹1,000.00 lakhs	0.76

*As certified by Singhi & Co., Chartered Accountants, pursuant to their certificate dated September 11, 2026 vide UDIN: 26077508ALLOZF9199. For further details, kindly refer "**The Offer**" beginning on page 147 of the RHP.

PRICE BAND: ₹ 385 TO ₹ 405 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH.
THE FLOOR PRICE IS 38.5 TIMES OF THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 40.5 TIMES OF THE FACE THE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.
BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM QUANTITY OF 37 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 37 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH THEREAFTER.

THE PRICE TO EARNINGS RATIO ("P/E"), BASED ON DILUTED EPS FOR FISCAL 2026 FOR OUR COMPANY AT THE LOWER END OF PRICE BAND (I.E. FLOOR PRICE) IS 20.84 TIMES AND AT THE UPPER END OF PRICE BAND (I.E. CAP PRICE) IS 21.92 TIMES AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP P/E RATIO OF 45.20 TIMES FOR FISCAL 2026.
A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 38 PER EQUITY SHARE IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION.
WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NET WORTH FOR LAST THREE FISCAL IS 9.65%.

The details of the Fresh Issue, Offer for Sale, Total Offer Size and Post-Offer Market Capitalization of our Company, each at the Floor Price and Cap Price, are given below:

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹ 385 per Equity Share		At Cap Price of ₹ 405 per Equity Share	
	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each	Up to Amount (₹ in lakhs)	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to Amount (₹ in lakhs)
Fresh Issue	92,26,467	35,500.00	87,70,544	35,500.00
-Fresh Issue (Net of Employee Reservation Portion)	91,68,831	35,300.00	87,16,049	35,200.00
-Employee Reservation	57,636	200.00	54,495	200.00
Offer For Sale	12,98,701	5,000.00	12,34,567	5,000.00
Total Offer Size*	1,05,25,168	40,500.00	1,00,05,111	40,500.00
Post-Offer Market Capitalization of our Company	7,76,91,737	2,99,091.29	7,72,35,814	3,12,784.34

*The Total Offer Size includes the Employee Reservation Portion and a discount of ₹ 38 per Equity Share at Floor Price and Cap Price.

BID / OFFER PROGRAMME

BID / OFFER OPENS TODAY

BID / OFFER CLOSES ON: MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 28, 2026^{S*}

*Our Company may, in consultation with the BRLMs, consider closing the Bid/Offer Period for QIBs 1 (one) Working Day prior to the Bid/Offer Closing Date in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations.
*UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 pm on Bid/ Offer Closing Date.

Our company is a backward/vertically integrated steel manufacturer based in southern India with a diversified product portfolio comprising of Sponge Iron, MS billets, TMT Bars, HR Coils, CR Coils, GP Coils, HR (MS) Pipes, CR Pipes, GP Pipes, Ferro Alloys, Coal, Iron Ore, Scrap, Met Coke and Other by-products.

THE OFFER IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.
THE EQUITY SHARES OF THE COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE.
BSE LIMITED SHALL BE THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.

QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET OFFER, NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET OFFER
RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET OFFER, EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE ₹ 10 AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 200.00 LAKHS

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST ONLY RELY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE TERMS OF THE OFFER, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE OFFER AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THE PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT DATED SEPTEMBER 16, 2026 FOR THE OFFER ("PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT"), AND CORRIGENDUM TO THE PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT DATED SEPTEMBER 17, 2026 AND CORRIGENDUM TO THE PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT DATED SEPTEMBER 23, 2026 AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF THE COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED BY EITHER THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE OFFER ("BRLMs").

In accordance with the recommendation of committee of Independent Directors of our Company, pursuant to their resolution dated September 16, 2026, the above provided price band is justified based on quantitative factors/Key Performance Indicators ("KPI") disclosed in the "Basis for Offer Price" section on page 219 of the Red Herring Prospectus vis-a-vis the weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of primary and secondary transaction(s) as applicable, disclosed in the "Basis for Offer Price" on page 219 of the RHP and provided below in the advertisement.

RISK TO INVESTORS

(For details, refer to section titled "Risk Factors" beginning on page 31 of the Red Herring Prospectus)

- Volatility in financial performance:** Our financial performance has fluctuated during the last three Fiscals. Our PAT was ₹3,891.37 lakhs, ₹771.05 lakhs and ₹12,740.82 lakhs for Fiscal 2024, 2025 and 2026, respectively and our PAT margins was 1.01%, 0.22% and 3.06%, for Fiscal 2024, 2025 and 2026, respectively. Our EBITDA margins was 4.49%, 4.91% and 7.29%, for Fiscal 2024, 2025 and 2026, respectively. Our ROCE was 8.67%, 7.03% and 12.86%, for Fiscal 2024, 2025 and 2026, respectively. Accordingly, our profitability, margins and return ratios have fluctuated across periods, and the improvement in our financial performance in Fiscal 2026 may not be sustained or be indicative of our future financial performance.
- Execution risk relating to our proposed expansion and infrastructure projects:** We are currently undertaking certain expansion and infrastructure projects at our Koppal Facility, including a 10 MW waste heat recovery boiler ("WHRB") power plant, of which 6 MW has been partially operational as of the date of the Red Herring Prospectus, a proposed 6,00,000 MTPA iron ore beneficiation plant and a proposed railway siding. The WHRB power plant is expected to be fully commissioned during the second quarter of Fiscal 2027, the iron ore beneficiation plant is expected to be commissioned in phases during Fiscals 2027 and 2028, and the railway siding is expected to become operational in June 2027. These projects involve significant capital expenditure, construction and implementation risks and regulatory dependencies. Any delay, cost overrun, technical or operational difficulty, inability to obtain or maintain requisite approvals or failure to achieve the expected utilisation levels, cost efficiencies or other anticipated benefits could adversely affect our business, financial condition, cash flows and growth prospects.
- Related party transactions and potential conflicts of interest:** We have entered into, and may continue to enter into, transactions with our related parties in the ordinary course of business, including sale and purchase of goods, unsecured borrowings, lease-related transactions and personal guarantees. While such transactions have been undertaken on an arm's length basis and in compliance with applicable law, certain non-core related party transactions, including borrowings, rental income and interest expenses, have historically involved significant values. Further, as of July 15, 2026, our Promoters and certain members of the Promoter Group had provided unsecured loans amounting to ₹13,766.80 lakhs and personal guarantees aggregating to ₹6,28,584 lakhs in connection with certain borrowings of our Company and Subsidiaries. Related party transactions may involve actual or potential conflicts of interest, and there can be no assurance that such transactions, individually or in the aggregate, will always be in the best interests of our Company or our minority Shareholders or will not adversely affect our business, results of operations, cash flows and financial condition.
- High dependence on key products:** We rely heavily on revenue generated primarily from the sale of three key products. The table below sets out the revenues generated from sale of our key products, including as a percentage of our Revenue from Operations for the periods indicated therein:

Particulars	Fiscal 2026			Fiscal 2025			Fiscal 2024		
	Qty (MTPA)	Revenue (₹ in Lakhs)	% ¹	Qty (MTPA)	Revenue (₹ in Lakhs)	% ¹	Qty (MTPA)	Revenue (₹ in Lakhs)	% ¹
Pipes & Tubes*	1,75,990.12	90,029.38	21.70	1,54,975.58	80,532.22	22.74	1,26,996.05	72,545.68	18.92
TMT Bar	2,54,771.85	1,20,325.58	29.00	2,39,442.96	1,18,182.73	33.37	2,14,439.64	1,11,864.59	29.18
Sponge Iron	1,79,917.84	45,258.33	10.91	1,57,692.07	41,185.65	11.63	1,72,422.50	48,839.22	12.74
Aggregate	6,10,679.81	2,55,613.29	61.61	5,52,110.61	2,39,900.60	67.73	5,13,858.19	2,33,249.49	60.83

¹% of Revenue from Operations
*Pipes & Tubes include HR (MS) Pipes, CR Pipes, GP Pipes

Any material reduction in demand for, or sales of, these products could adversely affect our business, financial condition, results of operations and cash flows.

- High geographical concentration of revenue and manufacturing operations:** More than 50% of our Revenue from Operations has historically been derived from the State of Karnataka, which contributed 54.86%, 57.20% and 50.31% in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Further, five of our six manufacturing facilities are located in Karnataka. Accordingly, any adverse economic, regulatory, environmental, infrastructural or other developments in Karnataka may adversely affect demand for our products as well as our manufacturing operations, business, financial condition, results of operations and cash flows.

Set forth below is the revenue contribution from operations in Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra, Telangana and other states for the periods indicated:

State	Fiscal 2026		Fiscal 2025		Fiscal 2024	
	Revenue	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (%)	Revenue	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (%)	Revenue	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (%)
Karnataka	2,27,608.78	54.86	2,02,577.65	57.20	1,92,910.83	50.31
Andhra Pradesh	47,089.77	11.35	34,380.49	9.71	49,121.95	12.81
Tamil Nadu	29,897.20	7.21	23,458.28	6.82	27,763.39	7.24
Maharashtra	24,913.40	6.01	25,481.11	7.19	24,927.10	6.50
Telangana	18,212.68	4.39	20,369.84	5.75	23,487.22	6.13
Others*	67,134.91	16.18	47,910.72	13.53	65,210.76	17.01
Total	4,14,856.74	100.00	3,54,178.09	100.00	3,83,421.25	100.00

*Others include products supplied to states contributing less than 5% of the Revenue from Operations and exports in each of the preceding three Fiscals

Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra and Telangana collectively contributed ₹3,47,721.83 lakhs, ₹3,06,267.37 lakhs and ₹3,18,210.49 lakhs in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively, representing 83.82%, 86.47% and 82.99% of our Revenue from Operations, respectively. Accordingly, our financial performance remains significantly dependent on demand and prevailing market conditions in these states, particularly Karnataka.

- Dependence on key customers:** We depend on certain key customers for a significant portion of our Revenue from Operations. The table below sets out our Revenue from Operations from our largest customer, top five customers and top 10 customers, including as a percentage of our Revenue from Operations, for the periods indicated:

Particulars*	Fiscal 2026		Fiscal 2025		Fiscal 2024	
	Amount	% ¹	Amount	% ¹	Amount	% ¹
Largest customer	22,121.36	5.33	21,542.14	6.08	22,464.85	5.86
Top five customers	80,564.86	19.42	60,945.08	17.21	72,770.50	18.98
Top 10 customers	1,15,744.96	27.90	90,231.87	25.48	1,02,202.96	26.66

¹% of Revenue from Operations
*Based on their contribution to our Revenue from Operations in the respective Fiscals.

- Further, we served 1,715, 1,618 and 1,578 customers in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Any loss of, or significant reduction in business from, our key customers, or our inability to retain such customers on commercially acceptable terms, could adversely affect our revenue, results of operations, cash flows and financial condition.
- High dependence on suppliers:** Our purchases from our top 10 suppliers amounted to ₹1,60,875.97 lakhs, ₹1,47,618.48 lakhs and ₹1,30,696.02 lakhs in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively, representing 49.24%, 49.18% and 42.76% of our total purchases during such periods. Any adverse developments affecting one or more of our suppliers, including financial distress, logistical challenges, regulatory changes, production disruptions or a decision to allocate their available supplies to other customers, including our competitors, may result in delays in procurement, disruption in the availability of critical raw materials or fluctuations in raw material prices. Further, our suppliers are not contractually obligated to maintain long-term or exclusive supply arrangements with us.
 - Volatility in steel demand and prices of key raw material:** The steel industry is cyclical and steel prices are subject to fluctuations based on, among other factors, domestic and international demand and supply, availability and cost of raw materials, imports, transportation costs, trade measures and conditions in key end-use industries such as construction and infrastructure. Our cost of raw materials consumed amounted to ₹3,48,694.57 lakhs, ₹3,05,372.91 lakhs and ₹3,39,451.31 lakhs in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively, representing 84.05%, 86.22% and 88.53% of our Revenue from Operations. Further, our three largest manufactured product categories, namely TMT bars, pipes and tubes and sponge iron, collectively contributed ₹2,55,613.29 lakhs, ₹2,39,900.60 lakhs and ₹2,33,249.49 lakhs in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively, representing 61.61%, 67.73% and 60.83% of our Revenue from Operations. Any decline in steel prices or demand, particularly where not accompanied by a corresponding reduction in raw material and other input costs, may compress our margins and adversely affect our business, results of operations, cash flows and financial condition.
 - Dependence on performance of key end-use industries:** Our business is dependent on demand from the key industries in which our customers operate, including construction and infrastructure and other industrial sectors. Demand in such industries is subject to economic cyclicality and may be affected by, among other factors, changes in government policies, commodity prices, infrastructure spending, availability of substitute materials and general macroeconomic conditions. Further, our three largest manufactured product categories, namely TMT bars, pipes and tubes and sponge iron, together contributed 61.61%, 67.73% and 60.83% of our Revenue from Operations in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Accordingly, any sustained slowdown in the end-use industries consuming these products or reduction in demand from customers operating in such industries could adversely affect our sales, revenue, profitability, cash flows and financial condition.
 - Regulatory, statutory and environmental compliance risks:** We have been subject to past and ongoing proceedings and actions by regulatory and statutory authorities. In June 2019, SEBI imposed penalties of ₹7.00 lakhs and ₹9.00 lakhs on entities which now form part of our Company in relation to alleged manipulative trading activities in the stock options segment of BSE Limited; such penalties were paid and the matters stand closed. Further, between Fiscal 2021 and Fiscal 2025, the Registrar of Companies and/or the Regional Director levied penalties against our Company, certain Directors and Promoters for violations of provisions of the Companies Act, 2013, which have been paid and the relevant matters stand closed. We are also involved in ongoing proceedings before the Karnataka Electricity Regulatory Commission in relation to alleged non-compliance with Renewable Purchase Obligations for Fiscal 2018. Further, between 2022 and 2025, our Company received two notices in relation to the Hindupur Facility, ten notices in relation to Bellary Facility I, three notices in relation to the Gauribidanur Facility and eight notices in relation to the Chikantapur Facility in connection with alleged environmental non-compliances. We have submitted responses to such notices and, as of the date of the Red Herring Prospectus, no further action has been initiated against our Company pursuant to such notices. Separately, our Subsidiary, Vanya Steels Private Limited, was directed to close its operations pursuant to an order of the Pollution Control Board in relation to alleged environmental non-compliances. The Karnataka High Court has stayed such closure order and the matter is currently pending. Any adverse determination in existing or future regulatory, statutory or environmental proceedings may result in monetary penalties, additional compliance obligations, remedial measures, restrictions on or suspension of our operations, additional costs or reputational harm and could adversely affect our business, results of operations, cash flows and financial condition.
 - Deficiencies in audit trail functionality and record preservation:** Certain deficiencies were identified in relation to the enablement, operation and preservation of audit trail records in the accounting software used by our Company and certain of our Subsidiaries. In Fiscal 2026, while the audit trail feature operated throughout the year at the application level, the database-level audit trail was not enabled in respect of our Company and two Subsidiaries. Further, in Fiscal 2025, certain Subsidiaries had deficiencies relating to editability, delayed enablement and preservation of audit trail records, and in Fiscal 2024, the audit trail feature was not enabled throughout the year in respect of three units of our Company and one Subsidiary. While our Statutory Auditors did not identify any instance of tampering where the audit trail feature was enabled, any failure to maintain audit trail functionality and preserve records in accordance with applicable requirements may result in regulatory scrutiny, penalties, adverse audit observations and may adversely affect our financial reporting, internal control framework, reputation and investor perception.
 - Dependence on Promoters, Key Managerial Personnel and Senior Management:** We are dependent on our Promoters, Key Managerial Personnel and Senior Management for strategic direction, management of our operations and maintenance of key customer and supplier relationships. Further, our business is manpower intensive and our ability to attract and retain experienced and skilled personnel is important to our operations. As of June 30, 2026, we had 1,377 permanent employees, and our attrition rate was 36.00%, 35.40% and 29.35% in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Any loss of our Promoters, Key Managerial Personnel or Senior Management, or our inability to recruit, retain or train sufficient skilled personnel or manage employee attrition, could adversely affect our business, results of operations, cash flows and financial condition.
 - The Price/Earnings ratio based on diluted EPS for Fiscal 2026 for our Company at the upper end of the Price band is 21.92 times as compared to the average industry peer group PE ratio of 45.20 times.
 - Weighted Average Return on Net Worth for last three Fiscals is 9.65%.
 - The average cost of acquisition per Equity Shares by our Promoter Selling Shareholders as on date of the Red Herring Prospectus and the upper end of the price band per Equity Share is as follows:

Sr. No.	Name of the Promoter Selling Shareholder	Number of Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each held on a fully diluted basis	Average cost of acquisition per Equity Share* (₹)	Upper end of the price band (₹)
1.	Sandeep Kumar	2,24,66,430	6.57	405
2.	Sunil Jallan	2,07,37,640	8.04	405
3.	Krishan Kumar Jalan	1,53,76,200	0.76	405

*As certified by our Statutory Auditors vide certificate dated September 11, 2026 bearing UDIN 26077508ALLOZF9199

- The weighted average price at which the Equity Shares were acquired by our Promoters (also the selling shareholders) in the one year preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus is as follows:

...continued from previous page.

Name	Number of Equity Shares acquired	Face value per Equity Share (in ₹)	Weighted average price per Equity Share (in ₹)
Promoters			
Sandeep Kumar	Nil	10	Nil
Sunil Jallan	Nil	10	Nil
Krishan Kumar Jalan	Nil	10	Nil

Note: As certified by our Statutory Auditors vide certificate dated September 11, 2026 bearing UDIN 26077508ALLOZF9199

17. The weighted average cost of acquisition of all shares transacted in (i) 1 year; (ii) 18 months and (iii) 3 years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus is as follows:

Period	WACA (in ₹)	Cap Price is 'X' times the Weighted Average Cost of Acquisition	Range of acquisition price: lowest price – highest price (in ₹)
Last one (1) year preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus ⁴	-	-	-
Last eighteen (18) months preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus	-	-	-
Last three (3) years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus	44.55	9.09	Nil to 250

Note: As certified by our Statutory Auditors vide certificate dated September 11, 2026 bearing UDIN 26077508ALLOZF9199

⁴ There were no transactions in the last one year and 18 months

18. Details of price at which Equity Shares were acquired by our Promoters (also the selling shareholders), members of the Promoter Group and Shareholders with right to nominate directors or other rights in the last three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus:

Name of Shareholder	Date of acquisition	Number of Equity Shares acquired	Face Value (in ₹)	Acquisition price per Equity Share (in ₹) ⁵	Nature of Transaction
Promoters					
Sandeep Kumar*	March 11, 2024	1,64,048	100	Nil	Allotment of equity shares pursuant to the scheme of amalgamation
	April 25, 2024	1,60,47,450	10	Nil	Bonus Issue
Sunil Jallan*	March 11, 2024	1,50,124	100	Nil	Allotment of equity shares pursuant to the scheme of amalgamation
	April 25, 2024	1,48,12,600	10	Nil	Bonus Issue
Krishan Kumar Jalan*	March 11, 2024	59,550	100	Nil	Allotment of equity shares pursuant to the scheme of amalgamation
	April 25, 2024	1,09,83,000	10	Nil	Bonus Issue
Promoter Group					
Daya Jalan	July 13, 2024	1,34,000	10	250.00	Private Placement
Santosh	July 13, 2024	30,000	10	250.00	Private Placement
Quality Stone and Steels	July 13, 2024	40,000	10	250.00	Private Placement

* As certified by our Statutory Auditors vide certificate dated September 11, 2026 bearing UDIN 26077508ALLOZF9199

⁵ Also the Selling Shareholders

Note: As on the date of the Red Herring Prospectus, there are no Shareholders with right to nominate directors or other special rights.

19. The 2 BRLMs associated with the Offer have handled 12 public issues in the past three years preceding the date of RHP, out of which 4 public issues closed below offer price on listing date.

Name of BRLMs	Main Board Issue	SME Issue	Total Issues	Issues closed below issue price on listing date
PL Capital Markets Private Limited	3	-	3	1
Khambatta Securities Limited	1	8	9	3

Note: No common Issues were handled by BRLMs.

Investors are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Offer. For detail kindly refer "Risk Factors" beginning on page 31 of the RHP.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS

- The Company has not undertaken a pre-IPO placement from the date of the DRHP till date.
- The Promoter Selling Shareholders or members of the Promoter Group have not undertaken any transaction of Equity Shares aggregating up to 1% or more of the Paid-up Equity Share Capital of the Company from the date of the Draft Red Herring Prospectus till date.
- The aggregate Pre-offer and Post-offer shareholding of the Promoters, members of the Promoter Group and the additional top 10 Shareholders of the Company is set out below:

Sr. No.	Name of the Shareholders	Pre-Offser shareholding as on date of the Red Herring Prospectus		Post-Offser shareholding as on the date of Allotment ⁽ⁱ⁾			
		Number of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 held	Percentage of the Equity Share capital (in %)	At the lower end of the price band (₹ 385)		At the upper end of the price band (₹ 405)	
				Number of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 held	Percentage of the Equity Share capital (in %)	Number of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 held	Percentage of the Equity Share capital (in %)
Promoters							
1	Sandeep Kumar*	2,24,66,430	32.81	2,19,46,950	28.25	2,19,72,603	28.45
2	Sunil Jallan*	2,07,37,640	30.29	2,02,18,160	26.02	2,02,43,813	26.21
3	Krishan Kumar Jalan*	1,53,76,200	22.46	1,51,16,460	19.46	1,51,29,287	19.59
Promoter Group							
1	Daya Jalan	1,34,000	0.2	1,34,000	0.17	1,34,000	0.17
2	Santosh	30,000	0.04	30,000	0.04	30,000	0.04
3	Quality Stone and Steels	40,000	0.06	40,000	0.05	40,000	0.05
Additional top 10 shareholders (other than our Promoters and Promoter Group)							
1	Goodluck India	4,00,000	0.58	4,00,000	0.51	4,00,000	0.52
2	Gauravrajsingh Vijaysingh Rathore	3,00,000	0.44	3,00,000	0.39	3,00,000	0.39
3	Saroj Vijaysingh Rathore	2,00,000	0.29	2,00,000	0.26	2,00,000	0.26
4	Ankur Garg	2,00,000	0.29	2,00,000	0.26	2,00,000	0.26
5	Faaguni Kapoor	2,00,000	0.29	2,00,000	0.26	2,00,000	0.26
6	Seven Alpha Investors Private Limited	1,98,105	0.29	1,98,105	0.25	1,98,105	0.26
7	Neetu Bansal	1,70,000	0.25	1,70,000	0.22	1,70,000	0.22
8	Ashutosh	1,55,000	0.23	1,55,000	0.20	1,55,000	0.20
9	Sheela Stainless Private Limited	1,50,000	0.22	1,50,000	0.19	1,50,000	0.19
10	Saket Agarwal	1,39,500	0.2	1,39,500	0.18	1,39,500	0.18
Other public shareholder							
1	Others	75,68,395	11.05	1,80,93,562	23.29	1,75,73,506	22.75
	Total	6,84,65,270	100	7,76,91,737	100	7,72,35,814	100

¹⁾ Also, the Selling Shareholders

Note: Assuming full subscription in the Offer (fresh issue and offer for sale). The post-Offser shareholding details, as at allotment, will be based on the actual subscription and the final Offer Price and updated in the Prospectus, subject to finalization of the basis of allotment. Also, this table assumes there is no transfer of shares by these shareholders between the date of the advertisement and allotment (if any such transfers occur prior to the date of Prospectus, it will be updated in the shareholding pattern in the Prospectus).

²⁾ Based on the Offer price and subject to finalization of the basis of allotment.

BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE



The "Basis for Offer Price" beginning on page 219 of the RHP has been updated with the above. Please refer to the websites of the BRLMs: www.plindia.com and www.khambattasecurities.com respectively for the "Basis for Offer Price" updated with the above price band. You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of PL Capital Markets Private Limited.

INDICATIVE TIMELINE IN RESPECT OF THE OFFER IS SET OUT BELOW:

Bid / Offer Programme	
Event	Indicative Date
Anchor Investor Bid/ Offer Period Opens and Closes On	Wednesday, September 23, 2026
Bid/ Offer Opens On	Thursday, September 24, 2026
Bid/ Offer Closes On	Monday, September 28, 2026 ⁽¹⁾⁽²⁾
Finalization of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	On or about Tuesday, September 29, 2026
Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors) / Unblocking of funds from ASBA Account ³	On or about Wednesday, September 30, 2026
Credit of Equity Shares to dematerialised accounts of Allottees	On or about Wednesday, September 30, 2026
Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	On or about Thursday, October 1, 2026

⁽¹⁾ Our Company may, in consultation with the BRLMs, consider closing the Bid/Offer Period for QIBs one Working Day prior to the Bid/Offer Closing Date in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations.

⁽²⁾ UPI mandate end time and date shall be 5:00 p.m. on the Bid/Offer Closing Date.

⁽³⁾ In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) exceeding two Working Days for cancelled/ withdrawn/ deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked; (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall be liable for compensating the Bidder at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date of receipt of the investor grievance until the date on which the blocked amounts are unblocked. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking.

The Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the SEBI ICDR Master Circular which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of the Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable.

The processing fees for applications made by UPI Bidders using the UPI Mechanism may be released to the remitter banks (SCSBs) only after such banks provide a written confirmation on compliance with SEBI ICDR Master Circular.

Submission of Bids (Other than Bids from Anchor Investors):

Bid / Offer Period (except the Bid / Offer Closing Date)	
Submission and Revision in Bids	Only between 10.00 a.m. and 5.00 p.m. IST
Bid / Offer Closing Date*	
Submission Submission of Electronic Applications (Online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) For Retail Individual Bidders and Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Electronic Applications (Bank ASBA through Online channels like Internet Banking, Mobile Banking and Syndicate UPI ASBA applications where Bid Amount is up to ₹ 5.00 lakhs)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Electronic Applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual Applications)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 3.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Physical Applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 1.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Physical Applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual Applications of QIBs and NILs where Bid Amount is more than ₹ 5.00 lakhs)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 12.00 p.m. IST
Modification / Revision / Cancellation of Bids	
Upward Revision of Bids by QIBs and Non- Institutional Investors categories ⁴	Only between 10.00 a.m. on the Bid/Offer Opening Date and up to 4.00 p.m. IST on Bid/Offer Closing Date
Modification/Upward or downward revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RILs and Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion	Only between 10.00 a.m. on the Bid/Offer Opening Date and up to 5.00 p.m. IST on Bid/Offer Closing Date

* UPI mandate end time shall be 5:00 p.m. on the Bid/Offer Closing Date

⁴ QIBs and Non Institutional Bidders can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/ withdraw their bids.

On the Bid/Offer Closing Date, the Bids shall be uploaded until:

- 4.00 p.m. IST in case of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders, and
 - until 5.00 p.m. IST or such extended time as permitted by the Stock Exchanges, in case of Bids by RILs and Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion.
- On Bid/Offer Closing Date, extension of time may be granted by the Stock Exchanges only for uploading Bids received by RILs and Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion after taking into account the total number of Bids received and as reported by the Book Running Lead Managers to the Stock Exchanges.

ASBA*	Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application – Make use of it!!!	*Applications Supported by Blocked Amount (ASBA) is a better way of applying to Offers by simply blocking the fund in the bank account, investors can avail the same. For details, check section on ASBA below, Mandatory in Public Issues. No cheque will be accepted.
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UPI – Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non-Institutional Investors applying in public issues where the application amount is up to ₹ 5 Lakhs, applying through Registered Broker, Syndicate, CDPs & RTAs. UPI Bidders also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Bidders are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 issued by Central Board of Direct Taxes and the subsequent press releases, including press release dated June 25, 2021 read with press release dated September 17, 2021, and CBDT circular no. 7 of 2022 dated March 30, 2022, read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press release in this regard.

ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except Anchor Investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors; and (ii) Non-Institutional Investors applying in public issue where the application amount is up to ₹ 5 Lakhs in the Non-Institutional Portion. For details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in the Bid Cum Application Forms and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to the section "Offer Procedure" beginning on page 730 of the RHP. The process is also available on the

website of Association of Investment Bankers of India ("AIBI") and Stock Exchanges in the General Information Document. The Bid Cum Application Forms and the Abridged Prospectus can be downloaded from the websites of Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displaying on website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFp=yes&intmid=35 and <https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFp=yes&intmid=43>, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI Apps and Banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI Mechanism may apply through SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. HDFC Bank Limited and Axis Bank Limited have been appointed as Sponsor Bank for the Offer in accordance with the requirements of the SEBI Circular dated November 01, 2018, as amended. For Offer related queries, please contact the BRLM on its email ID as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll free number: 18001201740 and mail ID: ipo.upi@npci.org.in

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD PLATFORMS OF BSE AND NSE

In case of any revision to the Price Band, the Bid/Offer Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days following such revision of the Price Band, subject to the Bid/Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company may, in consultation with the BRLMs, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/Offer Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/Offer Period, if applicable, will be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and the terminals of the Syndicate Members and by intimation to SCSBs, other Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Bank(s), as applicable

This Offer is being made in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the SCRR read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations. The Offer is being made through the Book Building Process and is in compliance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, wherein in terms of Regulation 32(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, not more than 50% of the Net Offer shall be allocated on a proportionate basis to QIBs, provided that our Company, in consultation with the BRLMs, may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors at the Anchor Investor Allocation Price on a discretionary basis in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, of which 40% shall be reserved as follows: (i) 33.33% for domestic Mutual Funds; and (ii) 6.67% for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds at or above the Anchor Investor Offer Price. In case the aggregate demand from Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds is less than 6.67%, the remaining Equity Shares will be added to the portion allocated to domestic Mutual Funds, in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. In the event of under-subscription, or non-allotment in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the Net QIB Portion. Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis only to Mutual Funds, and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIBs (other than Anchor Investors), including Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price. Further, subject to availability of Equity Shares in the respective categories, not less than 15% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders out of which (a) one third of such portion shall be reserved for applicants with application size of more than ₹ 2,00,000 and up to ₹ 10,00,000; and (b) two third of such portion shall be reserved for applicants with application size of more than ₹ 10,00,000, provided that the unsubscribed portion in either of such sub-categories may be allocated to applicants in the other sub-category of Non-Institutional Bidders and not less than 35% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation to RIBs in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price.

Furthermore, up to (a) Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each, aggregating up to ₹ 200.00 lakhs shall be made available for allocation on a proportionate basis only to Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price, if any, net of Employee Discount. The Employee Reservation Portion shall not exceed 5% of our post-Offser paid-up equity share capital subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price, net of Employee Discount, if any. All Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are required to mandatorily utilize the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("ASBA") process by providing details of their respective ASBA Accounts and UPI ID (in case of UPI bidders using the UPI Mechanism (as defined hereinafter)), in which case the corresponding Bid Amounts will be blocked by the SCSBs or under the UPI Mechanism, as applicable to participate in the Offer. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Anchor Investor Portion of the Offer through ASBA process. For details, kindly refer "Offer Procedure" beginning on page 730 of the RHP.

Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) available in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active.

Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorised the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Offer, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Offer. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders/Applicants' sole risk.

Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar ID and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020, press release dated June 25, 2021 and September 17, 2021, CBDT Circular no. 7 of 2022 dated March 30, 2022 and March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

CONTENTS OF THE MEMORANDUM OF ASSOCIATION OF OUR COMPANY AS REGARDS ITS OBJECTS: For information on the main objects and other objects of our Company, kindly refer "History and Certain Corporate Matters" beginning on page 406 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Offer. For further details, kindly refer "Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection" beginning on page 794 of the RHP.

LIABILITY OF MEMBERS OF THE COMPANY: Limited by shares.

AMOUNT OF SHARE CAPITAL OF THE COMPANY AND CAPITAL STRUCTURE: As on date of RHP, the authorized share capital of the Company is ₹ 1,00,00,00,000 divided into 10,00,00,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up share capital of the Company before the Offer is ₹ 68,46,52,700 divided into 6,84,65,270 Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each.

Basal Steels and Power Private Limited and A-One Gold Pipes and Tubes Private Limited are proposed to be amalgamated with our Company pursuant to a Scheme of Amalgamation under Sections 230 and 232 of the Companies Act, 2013, approved by the respective Boards on March 14, 2026. Pursuant to the Scheme, upon it becoming effective, our Company will issue 6,24,213 Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each to the eligible shareholders of Basal Steels and Power Private Limited, based on the approved share exchange ratio of one Equity Share of our Company for every 413 equity shares of Basal Steels and Power Private Limited. Consequently, our paid-up equity share capital will increase from 6,84,65,270 Equity Shares to 6,90,89,483 Equity Shares. The Scheme is currently pending before the Jurisdictional National Company Law Tribunals and, upon becoming effective, the transferor companies will stand dissolved without winding up. For details of the Capital Structure, kindly refer "Capital Structure" beginning on page 186 of the RHP.

NAMES OF THE INITIAL SIGNATORIES TO THE MEMORANDUM OF ASSOCIATION OF THE COMPANY AND THE NUMBER OF EQUITY SHARES SUBSCRIBED BY THEM: The names of the initial signatories of the Memorandum of Association of the Company are as follows: Sunil Kumar Jallan - 900 Equity Shares, Sandeep Kumar - 100 Equity Shares aggregating to 1,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each. For details of the share capital history of the Company, kindly refer "Capital Structure" beginning on page 186 of the RHP.

LISTING: The Equity Shares offered through the RHP are proposed to be listed on BSE and NSE. Our Company has received in-principle approvals from BSE and NSE for listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to their letters each dated April 16, 2025. For the purposes of this Offer, BSE shall be the Designated Stock Exchange. A signed copy of the RHP has been filed with the RoC and the Prospectus shall be filed with the RoC in accordance with Section 26(4) and 32 of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the RHP up to the Bid/Offer Closing date, kindly refer "Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection" beginning on page 794 of the RHP.

DISCLAIMER CLAUSE OF SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA ("SEBI"): SEBI only gives its observations on the Offer Documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Offer or the specified securities stated in the Offer Document. The investors are advised to refer to page 698 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of SEBI.

DISCLAIMER CLAUSE OF BSE (THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 703 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of BSE.

DISCLAIMER CLAUSE OF NSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 704 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of NSE.

GENERAL RISKS: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in this Offer unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their investment. Investors are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in this Offer. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer including the risks involved. The Equity Shares issued in the Offer have neither been recommended nor approved by Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI"), nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the RHP. Specific attention of the investors is invited to the chapter titled "Risk Factors" beginning on page 31 of the RHP.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS	
 PL CAPITAL MARKETS PRIVATE LIMITED 3rd Floor, Sadhana House 570, PB. Marg, Worli Mumbai – 400 018, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 6632 2222; E-mail: aonesteelsipo@plindia.com Investor Grievance E-mail: grievance-mdbd@plindia.com Contact Person: Narendra Gamiini / Vansh Nishar Website: www.plindia.com SEBI Registration Number: INM000011237	 KHAMBATTA SECURITIES LIMITED 806, World Trade Tower, Tower B Sector-16, Noida – 201 301 Uttar Pradesh, India Tel.: +91 9953989693; 0120 4415469; E-mail: ipo@khambattasecurities.com Investor Grievance E-mail: mbcomplaints@khambattasecurities.com Contact Person: Chandan Mishra Website: www.khambattasecurities.com SEBI Registration Number: INM000011914

REGISTRAR TO THE OFFER	COMPANY SECRETARY AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER
 BIGSHARE SERVICES PRIVATE LIMITED Office No. S-62, 6th Floor, Pinnacle Business Park, Next to Ahura Centre, Mahakali Caves Road, Andheri East, Mumbai – 400093, Maharashtra, India Tel: +91 12 6263 8200; E-mail: ipo@bigshareonline.com Investor Grievance E-mail: investor@bigshareonline.com Contact Person: Vinayak Morbale Website: www.bigshareonline.com SEBI Registration Number: INR000001385	Pooja Sara Nagaraja A One House No. 326, CQAL Layout Ward No. 08, Sahakamagar Bangalore – 560 092, Karnataka, India Telephone: +91 80 4564 6000; E-mail: legal@aonesteelgroup.com Investor Grievances Bidders may contact the Company Secretary and Compliance Officer, the BRLMs or the Registrar to the Offer in case of any pre-offer or post-offer related grievances including non-receipt of Letters of Allotment, non-receipt of Allotment Advice, non-credit of allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-portfolio of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Offer related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

EDITORIAL

The Price of Survival

The Supreme Court’s sharp questioning over the pricing of essential cancer medicines has brought a deeply troubling problem back into focus: the distance between the price of a medicine and what a patient ultimately pays. The court was told of a cancer drug carrying a maximum retail price of ₹27,000 even though it was supplied to retailers for about ₹2,700. Whatever the eventual findings, a tenfold gap of this kind demands regulatory scrutiny. Cancer treatment is not an ordinary consumer purchase in which buyers can postpone spending, shop around or walk away. Patients and families make decisions under extraordinary emotional and financial pressure, often while navigating surgery, diagnostics, hospital bills and loss of income. In such circumstances, opaque pricing can turn illness into a financial catastrophe. India has an important system of price regulation through the Drugs (Prices Control) Order and the National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority, which fixes ceiling prices for scheduled formulations. Yet the controversy underlines a larger weakness: substantial parts of the pharmaceutical market remain outside direct ceiling-price regulation, leaving room for large differences between supply prices and printed MRPs.

The answer cannot be indiscriminate price controls across the pharmaceutical sector. Drug development, manufacturing, distribution, storage and pharmacovigilance carry legitimate costs, while companies require incentives to invest in new therapies. India also needs a competitive pharmaceutical industry capable of expanding access to innovative treatments. The regulatory challenge is therefore to distinguish legitimate costs and reasonable returns from excessive margins that bear little relationship to value added along the supply chain. That requires transparency. For essential and high-cost medicines, regulators should be able to examine the movement of a drug from manufacturer or importer to distributor, retailer, hospital and patient. Trade margins, discounts and institutional procurement prices should be visible enough to identify extraordinary mark-ups. Hospitals and pharmacies should also provide patients with clearer information about lower-cost equivalents wherever medically appropriate. Competition works only when consumers possess meaningful information; in healthcare, that imbalance is particularly severe because patients depend heavily on doctors, hospitals and pharmacies to guide their choices.

The larger issue is affordability. A medicine may exist, be approved and be widely available, yet remain effectively inaccessible if its price pushes a household towards debt or forces treatment to be abandoned. Cancer exposes this contradiction with particular cruelty because treatment can be prolonged and involve multiple drugs over several cycles. India therefore needs a pricing framework that protects innovation while recognising that essential medicines occupy a special category of public interest. The government should strengthen monitoring of unusually high margins, periodically review medicines covered by price controls, encourage quality generics and biosimilars, and ensure enforcement keeps pace with new therapies and market practices. Greater public procurement and negotiated purchasing can further reduce costs without undermining supply. The Supreme Court’s intervention should become an opportunity for systemic reform rather than another temporary controversy. In healthcare, transparency is not merely good market practice. When a patient’s survival may depend on purchasing a medicine immediately, fair pricing becomes a question of access, dignity and justice.

LETTER



letter2editor.mp@gmail.com.

Keep Buses Running

The DTC strike has disrupted an essential lifeline for lakhs of Delhi commuters, particularly workers, students, women and senior citizens. While employees’ grievances deserve fair consideration, prolonged disruption of public transport cannot continue. The government must urgently resolve the dispute while ensuring reliable bus services remain available across the city.

SHREYA MALHOTRA,
NEW DELHI

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

A Model for Inclusive Change

Vonisha’s integrated model brought education, skills and livelihoods together to create sustainable opportunities for underserved children and women

NEXUS OF GOOD



ANIL SWARUP

THE WRITER IS AN AUTHOR AND A FORMER CIVIL SERVANT

Vonisha Service Foundation, a Section 8 not-for-profit organisation, was established in April 2017 to work with underprivileged children and marginalised women. From the beginning, there was a belief that poverty and exclusion cannot be addressed through a single intervention. Education without health, skills without livelihood opportunities, or empowerment without dignity can only provide partial solutions. An integrated approach was adopted across Education, Skills, Health, Sports and Environment. A presentation was recently made by Vonisha about its activities at an event organised by the Bengaluru Chapter of Nexus of Good.

The approach was simple. Sustainable social impact begins by listening to people, understanding their circumstances and responding to their actual needs. The early work focused on children who had dropped out of school, particularly those living in vulnerable communities around Bengaluru. An attempt was made to help them bridge educational gaps and enrol in government schools or affordable English-medium schools, according to their parents’ aspirations.

Getting children into school was only the beginning. Many returned to the same environ-



The initiative kept changing as the communities it served revealed new needs

ment and dropped out again. The teachers went into the communities, found them and brought them back. During the first year, there were just three teachers who engaged with 50 out-of-school children. Another barrier was soon discovered. Parents wanted their older children to attend school, but at the same time, they wanted them to take care of their younger siblings. This led to the older children dropping out of school to look after their younger siblings. We responded by starting a day-care centre for the younger siblings. That simple intervention improved attendance and retention.

COVID-19 became another defining moment. The organisation stayed connected with the families. They were served and provided with dry ration support worth about ₹1,000 per family during the period of uncertainty. After the pandemic, something changed. Children who earlier had to be encouraged to attend began coming in large numbers. Their experience created trust. Demand grew. Additional space

WHAT BEGAN WITH OUT-OF-SCHOOL CHILDREN GRADUALLY EXPANDED INTO SKILLS, LIVELIHOODS AND COMMUNITY-LED SOLUTIONS

was rented. More teachers were recruited. What began as a small educational initiative grew into an engagement supporting around 250 children.

Across the education and livelihood initiatives, the numbers reflect this journey of growth. Close to 5,000 first-generation learners were mainstreamed, bringing them back into school and giving them a foothold in formal education. Livelihood skills were imparted to 500 women, an effort that, in turn, led

us to think more deeply about what sustainable livelihood really means for them and eventually shaped Project VISILITES.

The engagement with women followed a similar journey of learning and adaptation. During community surveys in peri-urban areas, interactions took place with migrant families. In many households, the man was the primary breadwinner, while women remained at home because of family responsibilities, though they wanted to contribute to the family income.

Free, structured four-month tailoring programmes were started across these communities. It was initially believed that training would naturally lead to employment. However, a six-month review revealed otherwise. Many women could not work every day because of responsibilities at home. Available employment did not fit their circumstances. Instead of treating the programme as successful because many women had been trained, the organisation was confronted with a more important

question: what kind of work will actually work for these women?

That question led to Project VISILITES – Vonisha Inclusive Skills & Leadership Initiative for Women through Training, Empowerment & Sustainability. Genuine market needs were identified. Working women, families and communities needed reliable tailoring and garment alteration services, while trained women were looking for flexible livelihood opportunities. An attempt was made to connect the two.

Skill Meets Need

VISILITES brings together trained women, a refurbished solar-powered mobile tailoring unit and an app-based order management system. Women receive a minimum guaranteed payment along with a work-linked variable component. The mobile unit can travel to corporate offices, residential communities, apartments and other locations where alteration orders are aggregated.

Customers can view services, place orders and make online payments. Feedback is collected to improve the service. VISILITES is more than a tailoring project. It makes women’s empowerment practical by connecting skills with market demand.

The work of the organisation extends beyond these initiatives. Through the Vonisha Skill Enhancement Project, English communication and life skills training are also provided. In Tamil Nadu, a Miyawaki forest has also been created on a government school campus at Vayapatti village in Theni district, linking community development with environmental responsibility.

At Vonisha, the aspiration is not merely to serve communities. It is to create opportunities that help people become more confident, skilled, independent and capable of shaping a better future for themselves and their families by bridging gaps and unlocking potential.

What has been attempted under Vonisha is a small beginning that has already travelled some distance. It is a wonderful model of Nexus of Good. This model can be replicated and scaled through public-private partnerships.

Views expressed are personal

World at an Inflection

Old certainties are fading as conflict, technology and inequality reshape the global order

GLOBAL CURRENTS



MITALI MADHUSMITA

THE WRITER IS A FORMER IRS OFFICER

It was the best of times, it was the worst of times, it was the age of wisdom, it was the age of foolishness, it was the epoch of belief, it was the epoch of incredulity, it was the season of light, it was the season of darkness, it was the spring of hope, it was the winter of despair.”

So wrote Charles Dickens in his epochal book, *A Tale of Two Cities*, in the year 1859 to describe the trials and tribulations of a set of characters against the backdrop of the French Revolution in the cities of London and Paris. Almost two centuries later, the above phrase succinctly sums up the situation in much of the world today: North America, South America, Europe, Asia, the Far East, China – where

ever you look, these contradictory positions seem to loom large. All the long-held beliefs in the traditional concepts of the rule of law, secularism, democracy, federalism, separation and consequential balance of powers, and multilateralism seem to have been turned on their heads. The effects of climate change, the rich-poor divide and fiscal indebtedness are visible. The mad hunt and colonisation for mineral resources in places like Africa and South America affect the global population sitting elsewhere, as has been flagged through independent research by prestigious institutions such as *The Lancet*, the NRDC, UN bodies (predominantly the IPCC), the Royal Society, etc. It is as if the world is in an existential crisis. Most affected of all are global citizens, especially those who are marginalised, displaced, poor or caught in a war zone. The old order, along with its goalposts, seems to be changing most rapidly. At the same time, the shape of the new order remains to be defined. Technological advancements in space exploration, artificial intelligence, medical sciences and so on are rapid. But all of this comes at a cost to humanity and a fragile ecosystem, which will potentially impact the future of the younger generations.

How did we reach this situation, and how do we break the impasse? Just as one cannot predict the future, no one has any ready answers. One thing is certain: we human beings have created this mess, and only we can pull ourselves out of it. In ancient times, feudal lords, kings, emper-



Humanity faces profound choices as established institutions weaken

A RAPIDLY CHANGING GLOBAL ORDER IS FORCING SOCIETIES TO RECONSIDER LEADERSHIP, PROGRESS, POWER AND PUBLIC VOICES

ors and their subordinate authorities were guided by a set of wise men and women, strategists, generals, chemists and religious leaders in their courts. Much depended on the ruler, of course; his or her balance, empathy and judgement were as important as military and strategic skills. Fast-forward to this day, when countries and their elected and self-declared leaders have many more tools at

their command – from satellites, the latest gadgetry and futuristic technology to the most potent tool by far, Artificial Intelligence. Yet, the most basic tool – that is, public opinion – is ignored. And it so happens that the guides to many of our leaders are predominantly oligarchs, and the driving factor behind most decisions is business and commercial interests. This phenomenon happened during the colonisation of much of what was then condescendingly termed the Third World, and it is happening yet again. We are standing at the cusp of a monstrous wave, one that can make or mar humanity. How we crest this wave will decide our future and will require all the ingenuity at our command.

In the past, we have seen countries and nations pull themselves back from the brink, though, sadly, many have not been able to recover from the abyss. At times, it was overwhelming public opinion or public voice, and at other times, saner counsel advanced by courts,

multilateral forums, etc., that finally prevailed in remedying the situation. In countries that eschew the democratic path, public movements can turn violent, leading to civil war and the loss of lives, property and national resources. Moreover, poor democratic practices in many other countries have led to the implementation of hasty decisions dictated by ego and commercial considerations rather than genuine public interest. There is no longer any elbow room for discussion, debate or thought followed by informed decision-making. Nations that practised authoritarian regimes have successfully rebuilt their economies. There is apparent progress and prosperity, but no one knows what lies below the surface. Others have tried, with varying degrees of success, to maintain economic progress – a difficult task in an era when geopolitical events and economies are interconnected.

Yet, the human being is, by nature, a curious, thinking person. Inevitably, when the situation gets tough and goes beyond tolerance, questions begin to surface. The obvious facts are noticed, and rhetoric is ignored. A good leader listens to public opinion and recalibrates strategy. However, when questions are not answered, it signifies a *Hobbesian* and narrow political outlook. Public perception is a strong commodity; akin to market sentiment, it can make or mar the political fortunes of a person or a political party. The uncertainty of the world awaits a decision either way.

Views expressed are personal

Transparency Shrouded in Secrecy?

The UN Security Council exerts enormous global authority, yet secret ballots, hidden holds and informal practices continue to keep crucial decisions from scrutiny

FAULTLINES



GAURI SHANKAR GUPTA

THE WRITER IS A FORMER INDIAN DIPLOMAT

Twice this summer, the 15 members of the Security Council marked ballot papers with the names of candidates for Secretary-General, and twice a teller drawn from their own number fed the papers into a shredder. At the second poll, on August 21, Carolyn Rodrigues Birkett of Guyana came out ahead, with eight encouragements against three discouragements, short of the nine a decision requires. We know this because it leaked, as these results always do. Officially, nothing occurred. In later rounds, the Council moves to coloured ballots so that a veto can be distinguished from an ordinary discouragement, which indicates the arrangement the rest of the time.

Two days earlier, at the annual debate the Council holds on its own working methods, the head of the Security Council Report, the independent body that keeps the institutional memory the Council does not keep, told members there was a case for asking whether official disclosure would produce a reliable public record. That an outside monitor must make that request, at a meeting convened to examine the Council's transparency, is the shortest description of the problem.

The habit extends past the succession. The chairmanships of the Council's subsidiary bodies have gone unallocated all year. These include the committee deciding terrorist listings. China and Russia maintain that the Iran sanctions expired



UN's most powerful body still conducts parts of its business behind closed doors

REFORM CAN BEGIN WITH PRACTICAL CHANGES THAT EXPOSE DECISIONS CURRENTLY PROTECTED BY PROCEDURE AND CONVENTION

in October 2025 and will not have that committee in the package. The Western permanent members insist the snapback held and refuse to set it aside. The chairmanships are negotiated as one package bargain, so all wait upon one. The elected ten appealed in May and wrote formally on July 30, and France has called the deadlock unacceptable. It is the longest such gap since these allocations began to be

recorded in 1979. The cost does not fall only on files that interest us. Sanctions committees are not working at full capacity, and the working group on children and armed conflict, having managed conclusions on one 2025 report and carrying seven more, is an accountability mechanism quietly going dark. The monitoring team's report on terrorism reached the Council in February through a

monthly president standing in for a chair that does not exist. No rule was broken, for the sufficient reason that there is no rule. Note 507, revised in December 2024, asks only that consultations on chairmanships be balanced, transparent and inclusive. On whether a state with an interest in a file ought to chair the committee handling it, there is silence. The single safeguard is an unwritten understanding that permanent members do not take the gavel, and since they approve the package anyway, they choose the chairs without the inconvenience of holding one.

The listings operate on the same principle, though here I part company with much of the commentary. A great deal has been written about which government blocked

which name, and that record is not in dispute. The more useful observation is that nobody can count them. The monthly list of holds circulates within the committee and is never published, so the only tally in existence is assembled from the briefings of governments that publicise their own defeats. We know our share, not the total, and nor does anyone outside that room. A procedure that cannot be counted cannot be argued about, which is much of its attraction to those who employ it. Money follows the same instinct. Article 19 removes a state's Assembly vote when arrears reach two years of assessment, but the test is a ratio, so it bites the small and spares the large. Six states lost their vote this session; the United States, which owes some 4.5 billion dollars, did not.

Then there is the pen. In 2011, at one of these same debates, Hardeep Singh Puri asked from our chair why drafting Council texts should be a monopoly of the permanent members. He is credited with introducing the word "penholder" into the Council's vocabulary, a measure of how informal the practice was and remains. It has no basis in the Charter and none in the rules of procedure, which, after eighty years, are still described as provisional. Fifteen years on, the arrangement has hardened. Roughly four elected members hold a pen at all, and China holds precisely one file, Afghanistan. The pen settles the wording and the calendar: who is consulted, when a meeting is convened, who speaks

first, and when the Council returns to a subject. The last is the most valuable power in the building and the least noticed.

Amendment offers no relief. Article 108 requires ratification by two-thirds of the membership, including all five permanent members, and a permanent member need never veto it; it declines to ratify, indefinitely and at no cost. Four amendments have been adopted, none since 1971. On July 29, the Assembly rolled the reform negotiations into an eighteenth year, India joining consensus while asking how long the world must wait.

We launched our campaign for the elected seat of 2028 and 2029 in July. It will be fought, as such campaigns are, on the proposition that the Council is unrepresentative, which is true and has convinced nobody who counts. There is a smaller proposition available, and it can be carried because the remedies are on the table already and none can be vetoed. Uncontested chairmanships should be settled separately from disputed ones, and chairs should serve two years, with vice-chairs providing continuity, so one quarrel cannot freeze the machinery. The member placing a hold should be named and the annual count published. The straw poll figures that leak anyway should be released by the Council. A body deciding on terrorist listings, on money and on its own leadership ought to be capable of saying who decided what, and when.

Views expressed are personal

Icons Congress Chose to Ignore

PM Modi's commemorative push has restored national icons and legacies long sidelined under Congress rule

FORGOTTEN LEGACIES



ANIRBAN GANGULY

THE WRITER IS MEMBER NEC, BJP & CHAIRMAN, DR SYAMA PRASAD MOOKERJEE RESEARCH FOUNDATION

While looking back at Prime Minister Modi's 12 years and his total of 25 years up until now, one dimension that is striking is his commitment to commemorating and upholding the legacies of our icons, thought leaders, social reformers and epoch-makers.

Modi's tribute to Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose through various historic initiatives, his tribute to Sardar Patel through the Statue of Unity, and the grand memorial to Dr Babasaheb Ambedkar have remained some of the finest tributes to these icons, correcting deliberate wrongs. Successive Congress governments ignored Patel's contribution and tarried over erecting a memorial to Babasaheb. It was a calculated move to try to obliterate them from our collective memory.

As Chief Minister of Gujarat, Modi's effort to successfully repatriate the ashes of the iconic revolutionary nationalist Shyamji Krishna Varma in 2003, 56 years after Independence and 73 years after Varma's death, was one of his finest moments.

Many of those whose ideals and vision of India Modi commemorated and disseminated were given short shrift by the Congress. I mean the Congress of the past, because the Congress of today is only a pale version of its past and is mostly identified with vulgarity of thought and subversive action.

Vande Mataram's centenary was not observed in 1975. Indira Gandhi and her Congress were busy imposing the Emergency, clamping down on human rights, snuffing out lives and hauling citizens, journalists, artists, students and political activists into prison. Among Indira's preoccupations was also her obsession with ensuring that Jaya Prakash Narayan's health deteriorated in detention.

Indira and her Congress did not have time to celebrate the centenary of Rishi Bankim's high vision of the Motherland as a free, strong and united entity. The cry "Vande Mataram" must have reminded Indira of the freedom movement, of the demand for a free country, and she could scarcely allow that to happen.



Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay



Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose



Rabindranath Tagore



Dr B R Ambedkar



Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel



Shyamji Krishna Varma

Each of these icons, marginalised by the Congress, stood firmly against anarchism

nary of Rishi Bankim's high vision of the Motherland as a free, strong and united entity. The cry "Vande Mataram" must have reminded Indira of the freedom movement, of the demand for a free country, and she could scarcely allow that to happen.

1975 was Sardar Patel's centenary year. Naturally, it was ignored. How could Indira, in the midst of the Emergency, commemorate and pay tribute to Sardar Patel? Moreover, like her father, Indira too harboured a deep antipathy towards Sardar Patel and his legacy. It was best buried and forgotten. No major commemoration or remembrance marked Patel's centenary. It fell to Modi to rectify that deliberate omission by erecting one of the greatest memorials to

CONGRESS' NEGLECT PUSHED TOWERING NATIONAL FIGURES TO THE MARGINS OF INDIA'S POST-INDEPENDENCE NARRATIVE

Patel – the Statue of Unity.

Because of the Congress-led UPA-I government's extreme calousness, Gurudev Rabindranath Tagore's Nobel Prize medal, stolen in November 2004, could never be

retrieved. One of the biggest blots on our national life, it showed the pathetic and insensitive side of the UPA and the Sonia Gandhi-led Congress, which otherwise never lost a chance to project itself as the custodian of the legacy of Indian icons. No serious efforts were made to retrieve the medal by the Congress and the Left and to erase our collective sense of shame. Years later, by ensuring the UNESCO heritage tag for Tagore's beloved Santiniketan, Narendra Modi offered a nation's gratitude.

The Congress, from Nehru onwards, displayed an intense antipathy towards Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose. The Congress's first family went out of its way to ensure that Netaji's legacy was never com-

memorated in free India. Unthinkable as it may appear now, veteran Forward Bloc leader and Member of Parliament, the late Samar Guha, in his *Netaji – Dead or Alive*, tells us how, during his visit to Singapore in 1946, where he met Mountbatten, Nehru "refused to attend the INA martyr memorial ceremony organised at Singapore" by the INA veterans. Mountbatten had got the INA Martyr Monument in Singapore demolished, and Nehru, after initially agreeing, had refused to attend the ceremony at the spot where the memorial once stood.

Guha records that after "his return from Singapore, Nehru never uttered a word about Netaji for over a decade even after he became Prime Minister of India." Till the fifties, Guha writes, All India Radio "was instructed not to cover any special talk on Netaji or broadcast any news about Netaji's birthday, exceeding a few minutes. All army barracks were prohibited from displaying any portrait of Netaji." This ban "continued for years even after the withdrawal of British power."

In 1959, when Guha requested Nehru to take the initiative in rebuilding the monument to Netaji, saying that Indians in Singapore wanted the Indian government "to take some initiative in this matter," Nehru's curt reply was that "this was a matter between the Indians in Singapore and the Singapore Government. If they agreed, we would not object, but we did not think it desirable to take any initiative ourselves."

Compare this hatred with Modi's reverence and gratitude to Netaji and his legacy.

Each of these icons whom the Congress revels in ignoring and marginalising was against anarchism. Their vision was that of a free, united and great India – attributes that the Congress of today neither accepts nor comprehends.

Views expressed are personal

Briefs

Meghalaya: 8 UDP MLAs join BJP

NEW DELHI: The BJP on Wednesday got a shot in the arm with eight MLAs of Meghalaya's United Democratic Party (UDP) joining it in the presence of senior leaders, including Union minister Kiren Rijiju, here at the party headquarters.

Lahkmen Rymbui, Pius Marwein, Kyrmen Shylla, Mayral-born Syiem, Matthew Kurbah, Ollan Singh Suin, Balajied Kupar Synrem and Synshar Kupar Roy joined the BJP here.

Bihar flood situation grim

PATNA: More than 50 lakh people were affected as 576 gram panchayats in 15 districts of Bihar were inundated by floodwaters, with rivers flowing in spate showing no signs of receding.

The authorities were running three community kitchens while 7,714 displaced people were sheltered in six relief camps, the Disaster Management Department said on Wednesday. According to it, around 50.49 lakh people have been affected by floods in 15 districts.

Rahul writes to MP CM

NEW DELHI: Former Congress president Rahul Gandhi has written to Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav, urging him to implement 27 per cent reservation for Other Backward Classes (OBC) in the state and clear the way for pending appointments under it.

In the letter, Gandhi said that during his 'Chhatron Ki Gun' event in Indore on Saturday, numerous students from MP raised several serious issues concerning education, employment and their future.

Manipur: Kuki women stage protests

IMPHAL: Hundreds of women on Wednesday staged protests in Kuki-dominated areas of Manipur demanding justice for children and civilians killed by suspected militants.

In Churachandpur district, the protesters gathered at the Wall of Remembrance at Tui-bong, holding placards that read 'Justice for Innocent Women', a district official said.

Ex-ED official enters Punjab politics

CHANDIGARH: Former ED deputy director Niranjan Singh on Wednesday joined the Akali Dal Waris Punjab De ahead of the Punjab assembly elections here.

Former deputy superintendent of police Balwinder Singh Sekhon also joined the party in the presence of MLA Manpreet Singh Ayali and Tarsem Singh, the father of jailed Khadoor Sahib MP Amritpal Singh.

SMRITI IRANI GETS HARYANA, CHHATTISGARH

BJP rejigs state machinery, deploys heavyweights for 2027

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, September 23

Following observance of BJP's organisational pattern, the party high command, on Wednesday, announced the new appointments in the position of state in-charges and co-in-charges for all states and Union Territories.

However, insiders call it common practice following the appointment of a new party president.

In anticipation of the crucial election year, the organisational set-up of the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) has been realigned to prepare for the upcoming election battles, with some of the states that include Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Punjab, Gujarat, Himachal Pradesh and Karnataka being some of those in which the Assembly elections have been scheduled in 2027.

Of the various organisational changes made by the BJP, one that is very notable is the appointment of Vinod Tawde as the Uttar Pradesh in-charge along with four co-in-charges who are Jagdish Patel, Medha Kulkarni, Pradeep Verma and Anant Ojha.

As Uttar Pradesh elects the largest number of MPs to the Lok Sabha, it will continue to be of great significance for the BJP's national politics and organisation.

The BJP has also put Smriti Irani in charge of



BJP leader Smriti Irani

ANI

KEY POINTS

- » However, insiders call it common practice following the appointment of a new party president
- » As Uttar Pradesh elects the largest number of MPs to the Lok Sabha, it will continue to be of great significance for the BJP's national politics and organisation

Haryana and Chhattisgarh. As far as Punjab is concerned, Satish Poonia has been made in-charge, which will be supported by Virendra Sachdeva, who is the former BJP president of Delhi, along with Alka Gurjar. These decisions have been made amid preparations by the BJP in view of the 2027 election cycle in these states.

In West Bengal, Lal Singh Arya, Rajendra Singh and Pinky Kushwaha will be assisting Sunil Bansal, whereas in Telangana, Abhay Patil and Rekha Sharma have been made co-in-charges.

The appointment of Baijayant Jay Panda as Maharashtra in-charge, along with Amit Malviya, Sadanand Shet Tanawade and Kamaljeet Sehrawat as co-in-

charges, marks yet another instance of combining leaders with diverse organisational and communication roles. Maharashtra continues to be an important state politically for the BJP and forms an essential part of its organisational network at the national level.

One such notable appointment has been that of Ram Madhav, who has been tasked with the responsibility of Tamil Nadu and Uttarakhand, as per reports of the appointments.

While he will receive assistance in Uttarakhand from Arvind Menon and Bansuri Swaraj, Nirmal Kumar Surana and DK Aruna have been appointed as co-in-charges of Tamil Nadu. This follows the BJP's strategy to extend its organisational reach in South India, where the establishment of a booth-level organisational structure is an important long-term goal.

The party has also reorganised itself in Kerala, appointing M Nagaraj as the state in-charge, along with M Venkatesan as co-in-charge.

The party has also appointed K Surendran as in-charge in Puducherry, while Anil Antony has been made in-charge of Nagaland and co-in-charge of Goa. Biplab Kumar Deb has been allotted Madhya Pradesh, Sanjay Bhatia Rajasthan, Gajendra Patel Jharkhand and former UP Minister Shrikant Sharma Himachal Pradesh.

Rare unity in Home panel meeting over Central Armed Police Force role in Bengal violence

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, September 23

In a rare event, the Standing Committee of Parliament on Home Affairs on Wednesday, deliberated on the demand for an urgent discussion, raised by a member of the Opposition Bloc - which has been one of the prime topics of debate on the Floor of the House - on the involvement of the Central Armed Police Forces (CAPF) in the alleged incidents of police excesses and violence in West Bengal.

With Mamata-led Trinamool Congress Rajya Sabha MP Derek O'Brien pushing for an early discussion on the issue, he wrote to committee chairperson Radha Mohan Das Agrawal, who is also an Upper House member of the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party - seeking an urgent discussion on the involvement of CAPF personnel in West Bengal in a three-page letter.

O'Brien, who is part of the 31-member Home Affairs Committee, read out the let-



ter at the meeting and made it clear that the subject could be taken up for consideration, as it concerned the CAPF, which falls within the purview of the Union government.

"Chairman read out a letter which he had got that day, asking for urgent discussion on the role of the Central Armed Police Forces (CAPF) in the reported atrocities and brutalities of police in West Bengal," O'Brien noted.

However, the other point to note was that members belonging to various political parties - Congress, NCP (Sharad Pawar), IUML and RJD, including BJP's Tarun

Gyanesh Kumar: From key govt assignments to SIR controversy

The EC has said differing views are a normal part of deliberations & that its final decisions were unanimous

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 23

When Gyanesh Kumar took charge as India's 26th chief election commissioner (CEC) in February 2025, his work on the abrogation of Article 370 of the Constitution and setting up the Ram temple trust featured prominently in accounts of his career.

Nineteen months later, he faces perhaps his sharpest challenge at the poll panel - objections from both his fellow election commissioners to decisions made during the contentious Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of voter lists.

According to an "Indian Express" investigation, election commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi objected on record at least 14 times over the last 10 months to decisions and



Congress party workers burn an effigy of CEC Gyanesh Kumar during a protest, in Patna

PTI

orders they said were issued without their knowledge. The objections included changes to the statutory voter registration Form 6 and centralised control over the electoral roll database.

The Election Commission (EC) has said differing views are a normal part of deliberations and that its final decisions, including those concerning the SIR, were unanimous. Nei-

ther Sandhu nor Joshi has publicly spoken about the objections attributed to them.

The disclosures have intensified a scrutiny of Kumar's tenure as the CEC. Opposition parties have accused the EC of excluding eligible voters during the SIR and favouring the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP), allegations the poll panel has rejected.

When differences within Election Commission tumbled out in open in past

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 23

The differences between the election commissioners over the ongoing SIR have brought to the fore various past cases where members of the poll authority had divergent views which came out in the open.

In 2009, then chief election commissioner (CEC) N Gopalaswami

sought the removal of fellow commissioner late Navin Chawla over alleged partisan conduct.

The government rejected the recommendation, and Chawla went on to become CEC.

An even sharper clash preceded this one. Between 1993 and 1995, then CEC late T N Seshan went to court to challenge the creation of a multi-member Commission,

leading to a legal battle with fellow commissioners M S Gill and G V G Krishnamurthy.

After his term as CEC ended, Gill joined the Congress and was made a Union minister.

During the 2019 Lok Sabha elections, then election commissioner Ashok Lavasa had given dissent notes on clean chits to top BJP leaders over alleged model code violations.

SC stays HC order asking Noida DM to compensate student

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 23

The Supreme Court on Wednesday stayed the operation of the Allahabad High Court order directing Gautam Buddh Nagar District Magistrate Medha Roopam to pay compensation of Rs 5 lakh from her salary for the detention of student Akriti Chaudhary under the NSA in connection with the Noida workers' protest in April.

A bench of Justices Satish Chandra Sharma and N Kotishwar Singh issued notice on Roopam's plea and stayed high court's direction quashing Chaudhary's detention.

The SC passed the interim orders on two separate pleas filed by Roopam and the Uttar Pradesh govt.

During the brief hearing, the bench heard Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the district magistrate (DM), and senior advocate Mukul Rohatgi for the state of UP, before it muted the audio of the video conference proceedings.

The bench also stayed the observations made in the high court order against the DM. "After hearing senior counsels for the parties, this court is of the opinion that till the matter is heard on merits, the operation of the impugned judgment, particularly, para Nos. 27 to 33 shall remain stayed," it ordered and posted the matter for further hearing on October 7. Senior advocate Collin Gonsalves appeared for Chaudhary on caveat.

On September 2, the high court quashed the detention of Akriti Chaudhary, a 25-year-old Delhi University history graduate, who was taken into custody under the National Security Act (NSA) in connection with the Noida workers' protest in April.

FOR MAKING A HI-TECH DRONE FOR INDIAN ARMY

Daily wager's son gets Rs 3.5 cr defense ministry fund

ASHWANI SHARMA
Shimla, September 23

Sarvesh Sharma, a student from Government Polytechnic College, Baru, in the Hamirpur district of Himachal Pradesh, has emerged as a young innovator.

Son of a daily wage worker, Sarvesh Sharma has received funding of Rs 3.50 from the Ministry of Defense to develop 'Rudra Edge T-1 (Spectra)' - a hi-tech drone for the Indian Army.

IIT Roorkee will incubate the project, aiming



Himachal Governor Kavinder Gupta with Sarvesh Sharma and his parents at Raj Bhawan, in Shimla

MPOST

for completion within 20 months.

Himachal Pradesh Governor Kavinder Gupta, who has invited Sarvesh Sharma to Raj Bhawan on Wednesday, felicitated Hamirpur boy for develop-

ing indigenous drone technology for the Indian Army while studying in the polytechnic college.

He was accompanied by his parents and Deputy Commissioner Hamirpur Gandharva Rathore.

HIGHLIGHTS

- » IIT Roorkee will incubate the project, aiming for completion within 20 months
- » Himachal Governor, who has invited Sarvesh Sharma to Raj Bhawan on Wednesday, felicitated Hamirpur boy for developing indigenous drone technology for Indian Army while studying

Sarvesh Sharma earlier had participated in a national-level 'Open Card-board Drone Competition', organised by IIT Jodhpur and the Konark Corps. Fifty teams from prestigious institutions across

the country took part in the event, presenting their innovative ideas.

The event also included discussions about the challenges the Army faces with border surveillance.

Sarvesh's team

secured the fourth prize, worth Rs 10 lakh, in the competition. Inspired by this experience, Sarvesh began working on a prototype to address the Army's challenge and was able to successfully develop a drone at a cost of Rs 87,000.

Subsequently, Sarvesh applied for a startup project under the Ministry of Defence's initiatives-Defence Innovation Organisation (DIO) and Innovations for Defence Excellence (iDEX)-and his proposal was approved on Monday.



CHESS

Indian men dump England

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
SAMARKAND, September 23

The Indian men's team came up with an inspired effort to beat England while the women crushed Germany in the seventh round of the 46th Chess Olympiad here on Wednesday.

On the top board, R Praggnanandhaa showed the way with a clinical victory over Nikita Vitugov, while on the fourth, world champion D Gukesh remained invincible as he won another game.

For Gukesh, the board number does not seem important. Having won the last two gold medals playing for India on the top board, the Indian ace is looking good for a third straight gold, even on board four.

The loss on board three for Nihal Sarin against Luke McShane did not matter much for the Indian team, although it seems Vidit Gujrathi has to come back into the scheme of things.

Any hopes the German women's team had were quashed in the first hour. Koneru Humpy may be a veteran, but her class shone through as she made short work of board one.

Public Notice

The general public is hereby informed that I, Karamjeet Singh S/o late Sh. Ranjeet Singh R/o House No. 64A, Sanjay Colony, NIT Faridabad, Haryana, declares that the document No. 970dated 17.08.1981, Sub-Registrar Office, Ballabgarh, document No. 7689 dated 11.10.1983, Sub-Registrar Office, Ballabgarh, Document No. 11025 dated 05.10.1989, Sub-Registrar Office, Faridabad & 3961 dated 04.12.1991 have been lost. I am owner of the said property by virtue of a Will, and there are no outstanding loans or encumbrances of any kind against this property.

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Tender Notice No. Dy. CEE-PRYJPU2627T06/D105/2026 Date : 22.09.2026
E-TENDER NOTICE
PCEE/Construction for Electrical Project Unit acting for and on behalf of the President of India invites following E-Tender, the detail of the tender is as under:-
T. No. : PRYJPU2627T06 **Advised value : Rs. 18,82,02,971.27**
Description of work : Supply, Erection, Testing and Commissioning for Providing Additional Sectioning Arrangement in connection with Modification to Increase Speed to 160/200 kmph in CNB-DDU Section over Prayagraj Division of North Central Railway.
Bid Security : Rs. 37.64,100.00 **Period of Completion :** 12 Months
Bidding system : Two Packet System
Tender Closing Date & Time : 14.10.2026 & 15:00 Hrs
Tender Opening Date & Time : 14.10.2026 & 15:30 Hrs
Note :- 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website www.irops.gov.in 21 days prior to the date of opening of the tender. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. 3. In case of any difficulty helpline available on the website of IREPS may be approached. **2162/26 (PH)**
North central railways **@CPRONCR** **www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in**

Chhattisgarh InfoTech Promotion Society (CHiPS)
2nd Floor SDC Building , Raipur, Chhattisgarh 492001
Phone : 0771-4014158 Fax : 0771-4066205 E-mail : ceochips@nic.in
TENDER NOTICE
System Tender No. 199947 /ICEO/CHIPS/e-Sign/2026 RAIPUR, DATED 21/09/2026
Chhattisgarh infotech Promotion Society invites online proposal from eligible bidders for 2nd call of RFP for "Selection of e-Sign Service Provider for Implementation of e-Sign Services in the e-District Project". The Information cum Tender document can be downloaded from website <http://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> & <http://chips.gov.in>
The CEO, CHIPS reserve the full right to change the terms & conditions, select/reject any application without assigning any reason thereof.
Samvad-49143/2 **CEO, CHIPS**

PUNJAB STATE CONTAINER & WAREHOUSING CORPORATION LIMITED
A GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB UNDERTAKING / CIN- U63023CH1995SGC016299
PLOT 2, SECTOR 2, DRONAGIRI NODE, TALUKA URAN, NAVI MUMBAI - 400 707
REGISTERED OFFICE: SCO 127-128/1, SECTOR 17-C, CHANDIGARH 160 017
Tel.: 022-27243174, 0172-5197882 | www.pswc.in
Email:punjabconware@yahoo.com, conware.cfs@punjab.gov.in
E-TENDER NOTICE (3RD CALL)
Reference No. CONWARE/CFs/CCTVs Surveillance System/2026-27/4
Punjab State Container and Warehousing Corporation Ltd. (CONWARE) re-invites e-tenders by way of single stage, two cover system for 'Enhancement of Storage Capacity of CCTVs Surveillance System' at its Container Freight Station (CFS), Plot No. 2, Sector 2, Dronagiri Node, Taluka Uran, Nhava Sheva, District Raigad, Maharashtra.
Closing Date and Time: **Upto 1100 Hours on 12.10.2026**
For details log onto: <http://eproc.punjab.gov.in>
Note: Any corrigendum to the e-Tender Notice shall be published on the above website only.
PR-Advt. No :- 1004/12/2026-27/15517

NORTHERN RAILWAY
NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION
Senior Divisional Commercial Manager/Freight, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, in terms of Railway Board letter no. 2022/CTC/FM/ 10/04 dated 13.06.2022, and Railway Board's letter no. 2024/RS(G)/779/7 (E3471089) dated 13.08.2024, invites bids through e-Auction (www.irops.gov.in) for leasing of parcel space of SLR compartments and VPs (on round trip basis) for a period of three years as per detail and schedule given below :-

S. No.	Date & time of e-Auction	Assets to be auctioned
1	28.09.2026 at 10:30 am	12265(F1), 12596(F1), 12918(F1), 14014(F1), 14056(R1), 14164(F1), 14341(F1), 14679(F1), 14681(F1, R1), 15035(F1, F2, R1), 19404(F1, R1), 22428(F1), 22950(F1).
2	30.09.2026 at 10:30 am	12212(R1), 12394(F1), 12457(F1, F2, R1), 12963(F1), 14303(F1, F2, R1), 15134(F1), 18428(F1), 20473(F1), 22429(F1), 22438(F1, R1), 22472(F1), 22542(F1,R1).
3	05.10.2026 at 10:30 am	12060(F1) (Sun, Mon), 12060(F1) (Tue, Wed, Thu, Fri, Sat), 12436(F1), 14331(F1, F2, R1), 14507(F1, F2, R1), 14731(F1,R1), 15058(F1), 22410(F1), 22418(R1), 22421(F1, F2, R1), 22454(F1, F2, R1).

Important notes: 1. For more information, requirement and various aspects regarding these e-Auctions, interested bidders are advised to visit https://www.irops.gov.in/html/helpdesk/learning_centre.html. (e-Auction leasing section). 2. Railway Administration reserves the full and absolute rights to short terminate these contracts at any point of time and/or for taking any decision regarding the discontinuation/continuation of these contracts with modified/ additional terms and conditions depending upon the continuation/discontinuation of these trains or commencement of new train services.
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE **3305/26**

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Tender Notice
Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer, Northern Railway, Trainset Depot, Shakurbasti for and on behalf of President of India invites GeM (<https://gem.gov.in>) for the under noted work.
Tender No. GEM/2026/B/067552
Name of work Provision for Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract of Roof Mounted package AC Unit (RMPU) system of SPICs of Trainset Depot Shakurbasti for a period of Thirty Six Months (Manpower + Materials)

Approx. Cost	₹ 58,42,588.00 including GST
Earnest money	₹ 1,16,900.00
Completion period of the work	36 Months
Date and time for opening of tender	14.10.2026 at 15:00

Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen Above tender is available on Gem site i.e (<https://gem.gov.in>) w.e.f. 22.09.26
No: 25.8,1023.TSD.SSB Date : 22.09.2026 **3303/2026**
Serving Customers With A Smile

Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
(Regd. Office: PSEB, Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate Identity Number:U40109PB20105GC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in
Mobile No. 96461-55525
E-Tender Enquiry No.7865/P-3/EMP-13438 **Dated:22.09.2026**
Dy.Chief Engineer/ Headquarter (Procurement Cell-3) GGSSTP, Roopnagar invites E-Tender ID No. 2026 Power/175909 for Procurement of spares for Heat exchangers for PA fan Hydraulic Coupling Oil system of 210 NW units .
For detailed NIT & Tender Specification please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from 23.09.2026 15:00 PM onwards.
Note: - Corrigendum & addendum, if any will be published online at <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>
RTP-91/26 **PR-Advt. No :- 1079/12/2026-27/15510**

ICICI Bank
Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No.23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005
PUBLIC NOTICE
Builder Cancellation
This is to bring to your notice that Pankaj Kumar Singh/ Kajal Singh (borrower/s) has availed Home loan facility vide facility agreement number LBDEL00003159480 located at Flat No-1101, 11th Floor The Presidio Tower-A, Lcazar Village Atmadpur Sector-31, Faridabad, Haryana. The borrower/s has failed to pay the contractual amount to the builder as per the terms and conditions of the agreement. The Bank had informed the same to the borrower through letter dated September 22, 2026, informing that Ozone Gsp Infretech, has cancelled the allotment of the above mentioned property. You are therefore requested to resolve this matter with the builder within 7 days from the date of this publication. Please take further notice that post cancellation of the allotment of the said property ICICI Bank shall not be bound and/or responsible for any other allotment done by the builder.
Dated: September 24, 2026 **For ICICI Bank Limited**
Place : Delhi/NCR **Sd-**

Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli
E-Advised Tender Notice No. 35 ET/2026 Dated: 18.09.2026

S. N.	Tender No.	Short Description	Qty.	Due Date
01	07261773	Drilling insert for boring in Bolster pin Brackets Hole Solid cutter for machining of Bolster "L" Type metal staplers	140 Nos 32Nos	09.10.2026
02	05261335	Milling insert for Milling in Bolster pin Brackets surface	1400 Nos	16.10.2026

Corrigendum

01	Tender Notice No. 30 ET/2026 Dated-25.08.2026	Tender No. 03261070	Due date may be read as 07/10/2026 Instead of 22/09/2026	Pre-Bid Conference date & time 25.09.2026 AM:11:30
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Website Address: www.irops.gov.in & www.mcf.indianrailways.gov.in Dy.CMM/Electrical
E-Advised Tender Notice No. 36 ET/2026 Dated: 22.09.2026

S. N.	Tender No.	Short Description	Qty.	Due Date
01	05261212A	110V, 120AH VRLASMF Battery Set With 19 Monoblock (6V EACH)	379 Set	12.10.2026
02	05261354	Valve Regulated Lead Acid Batteries 120AH Capacity	201Set	20.10.2026
03	03261727	Entrance Hand Rail Complete	9980Nos	23.10.2026
04	04261312	SET of Doorway Partition for Memu TC 3 PHASE Coaches Set of Doorway Partition for MEMU/DMC/ 3PH coaches,	603 Set 201 Set	28.10.2026
05	03261620	Design, Supply and Installation of Partition Frames, Interior Doors, NONAC Area Panelling and Linen Room Arrangement for LWACCN/PP2 Coaches	72 Set	23.10.2026
06	15265289	Design, Development, Supply, installation, commissioning and proving out of universal Shell Jig for manufacturing of MEMU & Vande Bharat coaches	2 Nos.	16.10.2026
07	07261900	Extra High Purity Nitrogen GAS TO BE Supplied In Packs of 16 Cylinders.	117569 CUM	05.11.2026
08	15265290	Supply, Installation and Commissioning and Proving out of High Rise Platform for Vande Bharat Train set	5 Nos	14.10.2026
09	07261925	Chopped Strand Mat	48990Kgs	22.10.2026
10	03261393A	Supply of one set of Nosecone coupler Cover for Train Set	51 Set	27.10.2026

Website Address: www.irops.gov.in & www.mcf.indianrailways.gov.in Dy.CMM/Electrical
Open tender based on Single packet system Tender Notice No.- MCF-RBL-SPRINKLER-110-01 Dt. 19.09.2026 is invited by Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer/Safety & Training, MCF/RBL through IREPS portal www.irops.gov.in for and on behalf of president of India for the following work:-
Description of work : "Supply, Installation and commissioning of automatic water sprinkler, smoke detector & beam detector in Furnishing store-I, Furnishing store-II, General Store, PDC and New shell store-II and Hiring of multipurpose Fire Tender in factory area for 03 years (36 months) as per scope of work at Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli. **Approx. Value (₹) :** ₹ 7,11,90,979.70, **Cost of Tender document (₹) :** Nil, **EMD :** ₹ 14,23,800.00, **Quantity - As per schedule of rate, Completion period of work-** 36 months, **Date & time of closing of Tender-** 12.10.2026 up to 15.00 hrs., Detailed Tender Notice, Eligibility criteria, Terms & conditions are available at IREPS website: www.irops.gov.in in tender document.
Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer/Safety & Training
E-Tender Notice No. 07/2026-27 (Open) of DyCE/II/MCF/RBL
Deputy Chief Engineer-II/ Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli for and on behalf of President of India, invites "E-Tenders" for following works;
SN :1. Name of work: Construction of 01 Nos of Borewell in east colony for filling tanks. (Balance work estimate), **Tender No.:** 12-2026-27-RT, **Approx cost:** ₹91,79,643.51, **Date of Opening of Tender:** 22.10.2026, **Completion Period:** 12 Months, **● Tenderer/s** shall be able to submit their original/revised bids up to closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed for this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored **●** For detail, please log on Indian Railways IREPS website www.irops.gov.in. **Dy. Chief Engineer/II**
SERVICE CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
SEE SECTION 84 BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURKSHA SANHITA
Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Furkan S/o Md. Navi R/o E-53, Gali No. 04, Janta Colony, Welcome, Delhi**, have committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence under **FIR No. 543/2021 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act.**, has been registered at **PS: Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Furkan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Furkan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Furkan** of under **FIR No. 543/2021 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act.**, Registered at **PS: Welcome, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.10.2026**.
By Order
DP/12873/NE/2026 (Court Notice) **Ms. Deepakshi Rana JMFC-03 (North East), Room No. 14 Karkardooma Courts, Delhi**

GOVERNMENT OF HIMACHAL PRADESH
JAL SHAKTI DEPARTMENT
" Notice Inviting e-Tender"
The Executive Engineer JSV Division Jaisinghpur invites tenders on behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh from approved eligible contractors for the following work (S) through e- tendering process:-

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost	Earnest money	Time limit	Cost of form
1	Operation and maintenance for multi village schemes LWSS Andrana Bandhian LWSS Alampur LWSS Harasi Sanghole LWSS Tikkar Ghumarni, LWSS Upper Lambagaon, GWS Harot Karangahat, LWSS Uttarpur under Jal Jeevan Mission in Block Lambagaon under Jal Shakti Sub Division Lambagaon in Tehsil Jaisinghpur Distt. Kangra H.P. SH operation and maintenance for 3 years	3,40,67,472/-	4,15,680/-	36Months	7000/-
2	Operation and Maintenance of LWSS to Chadihar Khas and multi Villages of Baijpath Lambagaon & Panchrukhi Blocks Baijpath and Jaisinghpur Constituency in District Kangra H.P. (SH- operation and maintenance for 3 years)	3,12,17,284	387180/-	36Months	7000/-

Last date of filling / uploading the tender through e- tendering: - 08.10.2026 upto 5.00 PM. The tender forms and other detailed conditions can be obtained from the website. <http://hptenders.gov.in>.
Executive Engineer, JSV Division, Jaisinghpur
Ro.No 3602/2026-2027

ICICI Bank
Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005
The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.
Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Harish Kumar/ Nisha/ LBFD00006647586/ TBFD00006457016	Unit No. 605, Tower B1 Floor No 6, Vashisth Heights, Village Baselwa, Sector-87, Faridabad, Haryana- 121002/ September 21, 2026	April 28, 2026 Rs. 18,25,753.00/-	Faridabad
2.	Sudershan Surya Kiran Arora (Through Its Legal Heir/ Sameer Shaurya Arora/ LBFD00002429922	H No. 4276, 2nd Floor With Roof Rights, Part of Rectangle No 363, Killa No 02 Min of Village Nowada Koh, Tehsil and Dist Faridabad, Indraprastha Extension, Situated At Ownership No. 11, T.P. Scheme No. 3 (Part-1) Sec-49, Faridabad, Haryana- 121002/ September 21, 2026	May 27, 2026 Rs. 42,34,903.00/-	Faridabad

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.
Date: September 24, 2026
Place: Faridabad
Sincerely Authorised Officer, For ICICI Bank Ltd.

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY
Open Tender Notice No.: **NER-BSBOSnT-OT-55-2026**
"Open Tenders through Online (E-Tendering) are invited by Divisional Railway Manager (Signal & Telecomm) /Varanasi/ N. E. Railway for and behalf of the President of India for the following works: **Tender Notice No and Description of Work:** NER-BSBOSnT-OT-55-2026: Name of work: Signalling work in connection with various engineering work in the jurisdiction of ADSTE/MAU of Varanasi division. **Details, Approx. Value:** Rs. 21383345.10/-, **Earnest Money:** Rs. 427700.00/-, **Cost of Tender Form:** Rs. 00.00/-, **Completion period:** 12 Months, **Tender Closing date & Time:** 19.10.2026 up to 15.00 Hrs. 1. Tender Online will be submitted up to 15:00 Hrs on date 19.10.2026. 2. For full details and submission of bid kindly visit the Official website of Indian railways i.e. www.irops.gov.in
Divl. Rly. Manager (S&T) Varanasi
CPRO/Sig-123
Do Not Smoke Bidi/Cigarette in train

BEFORE DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL-II, DELHI.
4th Floor Jeevan Tara Building, Parliament Street New Delhi-110001.
Notice under section 19(4) of the Recovery of Debts Due to Bank and Financial Institutions Act 1993 read with rule 12 & 13 of the Debts Recovery Tribunal (Procedure Rule) 1993) in the matter of **OA NO 302/2026 DATE : 17.08.2026 INDIANBANK ...APPLICANT**
VERSUS
BLOOM'S STYLE THROUGH ITS PROP HEMLATA VEDI ...RESPONDENT
To,
DEFENDANT
M/s Bloom's Style
Through Its Prop Hemlata Vedi
6225-26 1st Floor Street No -6 Dev Nagar Karol Bagh New Delhi
Also At 16/186 Bapa Nagar Street No 5 Karol Bagh Central Delhi -05
Whereas the above named applicant (s) has / have instituted a case for recovery of **Rs. 50,80,708.53/- (RUPEE FIFTY LAKH EIGHTY THOUSAND SEVEN HUNDRED EIGHT AND FIFTY THREE PAISE ONLY)** against you and where as it has been shown to the satisfaction of the Tribunal that it is not possible to serve you in the ordinary way therefore, this notice is given by advertisement directing you to make appearance in the Tribunal on **15.12.2026 At 11.00 A.M.**
Take notice that in default of your appearance on the day before the mentioned, the case will be heard and determined in your absence.
All the matters will be taken up through video conferencing or physical and for that purpose:-
(i) All the Advocates/Litigants shall download the "Cisco Webex" application/ software:
(ii) "Meeting ID" and Password for the date of hearing qua cases to be taken by Hon'ble Presiding Officer/ Registrar shall be displayed in the daily cause list itself at DRT Official Portal i.e. drt.gov.in
(iii) In any exigency qua that the Advocate/ Litigants can contact the concerned official at **Ph. No. 23748478**.
Given under my hand and seal of the Tribunal this the 17th day of Aug., 2026
SEAL **By order of the Tribunal**
Suraj Parkash
Section Officer DRT-II, Delhi

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT, (E/M) CIRCLE, BILASPUR (C.G.)
e-Procurement Tender Notice
Portal : <http://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> (Online)
Form B (Item Rate) online from

NIT No. **Name of Work** **Probable Amount of Contract**
67/G/E-Tendering/2026 1st Call System Tender No. 19992 **Providing SITC Of Sound/Mic, Mixing/Recording System etc. Works For The Setup Of ART Studio At Raigarh, Dist. Raigarh (C.G.)** **99.98**
Date of Online Bid Submission will be 07.10.2026.
The Tender documents can be downloaded from the web-portal <http://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> only those contractors/bidders, interested in bidding shall pay the tender document cost online.
Superintending Engineer P.W.D. (E/M) Circle Bilaspur (C.G.)
G 262703459/3

ICICI Bank
Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited, Pushpamangalam Estate, NH Bye Pass Road, Edappally, Cochin - 682024
PUBLIC NOTICE-TENDER CUM E-AUCTION FOR SALE OF SECURED ASSET
[See proviso to Rule 8(6)]
Notice for sale of immovable asset(s)
E-Auction Sale Notice for the sale of immovable asset(s) under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8 (6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
This notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged/ charged to the Secured Creditor, the Physical Possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of ICICI Bank Limited will be sold on 'As is where is', 'As is what is' and 'Whatever there is' as per the brief particulars given hereunder;

Sr. No.	Name of Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrowers/ Guarantors/ Loan Account No.	Details of the Secured asset(s) with known encumbrances, if any	Amount Outstanding	Reserve Price Earnest Money Deposit	Date and Time of Property Inspection	Date & Time of E-Auction
(A)	(B)	(C)	(D)	(E)	(F)	(G)
1.	Mrs. Chhay Panchmukhi (Borrower) Mr. Ankitt (Deceased) Through it's Legal Heirs (Co-Borrower) Loan Account No. LBCC000005187982	Vacant Land with Land area 1453.1 Sq. Ft Sq. ft. in 1.35 Ares (3.33 Cents) in Re Sy No. 22/13, 22/14, 22/15 in Vazhokola Village, Kanyanur Taluk, Ernakulam District, Pin- 682030. Bounded on The North: 400-Meter-Wide private Road South: Balance Property of Vendors East: Balance Property of Vendors West: Balance Property of Vendors	Rs. 42,32,615/- (As on September 17, 2026.	Rs. 32,00,000/-	October 12, 2026. 11:00 AM to 02:00 PM	October 19, 2026. 10:30 AM to 11:30 PM

**The online auction will take place on the website (URL Link-<https://BidDeal.in>) of e-auction agency Value Trust Capital Services Private Limited. The Mortgagees/ Noticees are given a last chance to pay the total dues with further interest by October 17, 2026, before 05:00 P.M., else the secured asset(s) will be sold as per schedule. The prospective bidder(s) must submit the Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) Demand Draft (DD) (Refer Column E) at ICICI Bank, Pushpamangalam Estate, NH Bye pass road, Edappally, Cochin - 682024 Branch on or before October 17, 2026, before 05:00 P.M. Thereafter, they have to submit their offer through the website mentioned above on or before October 17, 2026, before 05:00 P.M. along with the scanned image of the Bank acknowledged DD towards proof of payment of EMD. In case the prospective bidder(s) is/ are unable to submit his/ her/ their offer through the website, then the signed copy of tender documents may be submitted at ICICI Bank, Pushpamangalam Estate, NH Bye pass road, Edappally, Cochin- 682024 Branch on or before October 17, 2026, before 05:00 P.M. Earnest Money Deposit DD/PO should be from a Nationalised/ Scheduled Bank in favour of 'ICICI Bank Limited' payable at Cochin.
For any further clarifications in terms of inspection, Terms and Conditions of the E-Auction or submission of tender, contact ICICI Bank Employee No. 9552553281/29501439.
The Authorised Officer reserves the right to reject any or all the bids without furnishing any further reasons. For detailed Terms and Conditions of the sale, please visit www.icicibank.com/n4p4s
Date : September 24, 2026
Place: Gurgaon
Authorized Officer ICICI Bank Limited**

‘UNWARRANTED AND FACTUALLY INCORRECT’

India hits back at OIC Contact Group over Kashmir remarks

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 23

India on Wednesday categorically rejected the “unwarranted and factually incorrect” references to India in the joint communique of an OIC Contact Group on Jammu and Kashmir, and said the OIC has no locus standi to pronounce on matters that are strictly internal to India.

The entire Union territories of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh are “integral and inalienable part of India”, and “no amount of repetition of politically motivated propaganda can change this reality”, the Ministry of External Affairs said.

Pakistan’s foreign ministry in a post on X on Wednesday said Deputy Prime Minister and Foreign Minister Mohammad Ishaq Dar addressed the ministerial meeting of the OIC (Organisation of Islamic Cooperation) Contact Group on Jammu and Kashmir on the sidelines of the 81st session of the UN General Assembly in New York.

Dar urged OIC member states to maintain a “unified position” on Jammu and Kashmir at the United Nations and other international fora.

He reiterated Pakistan’s commitment to a “just and peaceful settlement of the dispute



Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) official spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal during the media briefing

CLOSER LOOK

- » The references made to Jammu and Kashmir, drew a sharp response from New Delhi
- » MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal in a post on X shared India’s statement on references to it in the joint communique of the OIC Contact Group on Jammu & Kashmir
- » ‘Repeated endorsement of such motivated narratives only raises serious questions on the credibility of OIC’

in accordance with the relevant UN Security Council resolutions and the wishes of the Kashmiri people”, the post said.

The references made to Jammu and Kashmir, drew a sharp response from New Delhi.

“India categorically rejects the unwarranted and factually incorrect ref-

erences to India in the Joint Communique of the so-called OIC Contact Group on Jammu & Kashmir. The OIC has no locus standi to pronounce on matters that are strictly internal to India,” the MEA said in a statement.

MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal in a post on X shared India’s state-

ment on references to it in the joint communique of the OIC Contact Group on Jammu & Kashmir.

In the statement, the MEA also said, “Repeated endorsement of such motivated narratives only raises serious questions on the credibility of OIC.”

“Instead of offering a platform to Pakistan to peddle its fabricated and motivated propaganda, OIC will be better advised to counsel Pakistan, which has a well-documented record of supporting and sponsoring terrorism, to look inwards and address the continuing threat of terrorism emanating from territories under its control,” it said.

IIT Bombay sets up panel to probe student’s suicide, Doolla sent on leave

VBA’s Sujat Ambedkar leads protest at IIT Bombay over student death

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, September 23

IIT Bombay on Wednesday set up a 10-member high-level committee to probe the circumstances surrounding the alleged suicide of B Tech student Sahil Wakode, an official said.

Faculty member Suryanarayan Doolla, named in the FIR in the case, which alleges abetment to suicide on grounds of caste discrimination, has been sent on leave to facilitate an impartial probe into the case, sources said.

Police appealed to the public and media to refrain from speculation, spreading misinformation or drawing premature conclusions in connection with Sahil’s death.

MNS president Raj Thackeray said caste is a “favourite topic” for those driven

POLICE APPEALED TO THE PUBLIC AND MEDIA TO REFRAIN FROM SPECULATION, SPREADING MISINFORMATION OR DRAWING PREMATURE CONCLUSIONS IN CONNECTION WITH SAHIL’S DEATH

by power politics and students should not get entangled in it, after allegations of caste-based discrimination linked to the suicide of an IIT Bombay student.

The Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) demanded a thorough investigation into the case and stressed that action should be taken against whoever is found responsible after the probe.

The probe panel, constituted by the board of Indian Institute of Technology Bombay on Wednesday, was also likely to question Doolla, an official said.

The Mumbai Police Crime Branch is already conducting a probe into the death of Sahil, who was found hanging in his hostel room on the evening of September 18, hours after being caught while allegedly using a mobile phone to access ChatGPT during a mid-semester examination.

Mumbai Police, in a statement, assured that the investigation was being conducted “diligently and impartially, exploring all possible angles.”

“Mumbai Police appeals to individuals and the public to refrain from speculation, spreading misinformation, or drawing premature conclu-

sions. Media is requested to follow information transmitted through official channels only,” the statement said.

Wakode’s parents have claimed that he had told them about the caste-based slurs he faced. They demanded the immediate arrest of IIT Bombay Director Shirish Kedare and Doolla, who has been removed as the dean of Administrative Affairs following protests by students and political activists.

Meanwhile, tension prevailed for some time outside IIT Bombay at Powai here on Wednesday after Vanchit Bahujan Aghadi (VBA) leader Sujat Ambedkar led a protest and tried to enter the campus with other activists blaming the institute’s administration for B Tech student Sahil Wakode’s death.

CDSCO warns against indiscriminate use of painkillers and antibiotics

AAISHA SABIR
New Delhi, September 23

The Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO) has warned against the indiscriminate use of painkillers and antibiotics, flagging the risk of chronic kidney disease and antimicrobial resistance.

In a circular issued on September 21, the drug regulator has directed the public, doctors, phar-

macists and hospitals to ensure these medicines are used only when clinically indicated, in the appropriate dose and duration, and under the supervision of a registered medical practitioner.

The circular, issued by the New Drugs Division and signed by Drugs Controller General (India) Rajeev Singh Raghuvanshi, notes that non-steroidal anti-inflammatory drugs (NSAIDs) and anti-

biotics must be sold and distributed only on the prescription of a registered medical practitioner or specialist.

Most NSAIDs fall under Schedule H of the Drugs Rules, 1945, while most antibiotics are covered under Schedule HI, which mandates specific warning labels stating that the preparation is dangerous to take except in accordance with medical advice.

Haryana: Hooda begins tour of villages in his constituency

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 23



Former Chief Minister and Leader of the Opposition, Bhupinder Singh Hooda has begun touring the villages of his Assembly constituency, Garhi Sampla-Kiloi.

On his arrival in the villages, he received a warm welcome from the people. During village meetings held in different villages, Hooda consulted the people regarding his future political course.

Addressing the villagers present at the meetings, he said, “You are my real strength. If you give me permission, I want to begin an all-out struggle against the BJP across the state.”

The people raised both their hands and announced their wholehearted support.

The villagers said, “You should go across the entire state and do not stop until the BJP is removed from power.”

Hooda expressed his gratitude for the support and enthusiasm of the people and said that the Congress is now leaving behind the disappointment arising from its defeat in 2024 and beginning a new battle.

Briefs

J&K: 3 mines defused near LoC

JAMMU: Three landmines were detected and subsequently defused at two forward villages near the Line of Control (LoC) in Poonch district of J&K on Wednesday, officials said. An army patrolling party observed two rusted mines at Phagwara Gali in Mendhar sector and immediately summoned the bomb disposal squad.

Jharkhand: 6 drown in two villages

MEDININAGAR: Six people, including four minors, drowned in two separate incidents in Jharkhand’s Palamu district on Wednesday during the ceremonial immersion of tree branches worshipped at the tribal festival Karam, police said. Five of the deaths were reported in Bokaya village and the other in Nani Jharlia hamlet.

MHA gears up for Special Campaign 6

NEW DELHI: The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) is all set to participate in Special Campaign 6 being organised by the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG) with a focus on cleanliness, reducing pendency and improving record management to create more efficient workplaces.

Rantej Singh Powar joins AAP, CM Mann welcomes Akali leader

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 23

Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Wednesday welcomed Rantej Singh Powar, great-grandson of Akali stalwart Giani Shankar Singh and grandson of Sardar Bir Singh, into the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), saying his joining will further strengthen the party’s organisational network in the Doaba region.

Welcoming Powar into the party fold, CM Mann said his entry into public life reflects the growing participation of people from different sections of society in Punjab’s political journey.

On this, Mann stated, “Rantej Singh Powar’s joining the Aam Aadmi Party reflects the growing faith of people from different sections of society in the policies and governance of the state govern-

ment. I hope that he will work with dedication for the welfare of the people and play an active role in further strengthening the party at the grassroots level.”

He said that Powar’s decision to enter public life marks the beginning of a new chapter in his journey of public service, as he carries forward the legacy and values of service inherited from his family.

“Punjab needs young, energetic and committed people who are willing to enter politics with the sole objective of serving the people. The political landscape of the state is witnessing a change as people committed to public service are increasingly coming forward to contribute to Punjab’s development,” said the Chief Minister.

NFR: Rail cum road bridge to add Assam transport infra

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Maligaon, September 23



Northeast Frontier Railway (NFR) is undertaking the Second Saraighat Rail-cum-Road Bridge Project including doubling of the Railway track between Agthori and Kamakhya stations, which is set to become a major addition to Assam’s transportation infrastructure.

The project will strengthen rail and road connectivity across the Brahmaputra, augment transportation capacity for Guwahati and support the wider connectivity requirements of the Northeastern region.

Wangchuk leads ‘padyatra’ in Leh

Ahead of the first anniversary of September 24 violence

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Leh, September 23

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Four people were killed in the violence
- » The padyatra, however, saw limited participation from local people of Ladakh

Climate activist Sonam Wangchuk led a symbolic padyatra in Leh on Wednesday to mark the first anniversary of the September 24, 2025 violence during protests seeking statehood and Sixth Schedule safeguards for Ladakh, in which four people were killed.

The march -- organised ahead of Thursday’s Shaheed Diwas, and joined by representatives of the Leh Apex Body (LAB) -- was shortened because of

changing weather conditions. Activists are likely to reach the Shaheed Memorial Park in Leh at 7 pm today.

The padyatra, however, saw limited participation from local people of Ladakh. The organisers said they deliberately refrained from a large-

scale appeal outside the region, as several people in Ladakh wanted locals to lead the commemorative programme.

Wangchuk, who is part of the LAB and engaged in dialogue with the Centre along with the Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA), said

the march was held to remember those who lost their lives and demanded justice for those killed and injured during last year’s protests.

“We organised the padyatra today and will observe Shaheed Diwas tomorrow in memory of those who were killed in the indiscriminate firing on September 24 last year. The day will be observed as Shaheed Diwas, with people expected to offer prayers at temples, mosques, churches and other religious places,” Wangchuk told reporters.

ED attaches 37 kg gold in Guwahati smuggling case

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, September 23

The Directorate of Enforcement (ED), Guwahati Zonal Office-I has provisionally attached 37.064 kg of gold worth over Rs 54 crore in connection with a money laundering investigation into the affairs of Akshay Parshuram Bansode and other unidentified persons.

The attached gold comprises of 29 big sized gold bars and 50 small sized gold pieces along with around 13 grams of silver coloured metal flakes.

BEYOND TREATMENT COST India woos global patients with coordinated care

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 23

India’s growing medical value travel sector is drawing international patients beyond cost advantages, with an Australian couple undertaking a Rs 45-lakh, multi-specialty treatment journey involving cosmetic and dental procedures.

Joshua Finlay and Tegan Durham, who had earlier travelled to Turkey for plastic surgery, chose India this year for an extensive treatment plan spanning August 31 to October 11. Their procedures include abdominoplasty, thigh lifts, breast

revision surgery, brachioplasty, liposuction and dental treatment across multiple healthcare providers.

Around Rs 40 lakh of their total expenditure, estimated at nearly AUD 66,000 including treatment, travel, accommodation and coordination, went towards medical procedures. The complexity of managing multiple procedures led the couple to use CureMeAbroad, a medical travel and patient-navigation platform that helped them compare treatment options, connect with specialists and coordinate consultations and on-ground requirements.

News at a glance

Indian national killed in attack on vessel: Oman Embassy

DUBAI: An Indian national was killed in an attack on merchant vessel MV Cape Dao while it was transiting towards India, the Indian Embassy in Oman said on Wednesday.

The embassy said it was closely monitoring the attack and was in coordination with Omani authorities regarding the safety of all crew members on board, including 19 Indian nationals. The embassy said it was coordinating with the RPSL and was in touch with the family of the deceased.

ICC convicts Central African militia leader of torture

THE HAGUE: International Criminal Court judges convicted rebel commander Mahamat Said Abdel Kani on Wednesday of crimes against humanity, for abusing and torturing prisoners at a detention facility in the Central African Republic.

Said remained expressionless for most of the hourlong hearing as presiding Judge Miatta Maria Samba described the inhumane conditions detainees endured at the prison in the capital, Bangui.

Bangladesh set to procure 11 more Boeing aircraft from US

DHAKA: Bangladesh is set to sign an agreement with Boeing to procure 11 additional aircraft, officials of state-run Biman Bangladesh Airlines said on Wednesday.

The agreement is scheduled to be signed in New York on Thursday, coinciding with Prime Minister Tarique Rahman's visit to the US to attend the annual UN General Assembly session. The 11 aircraft will be procured in addition to 14 aircraft under an earlier \$3.7 billion agreement.



Visitors view an immersive digital art exhibition featuring 360-degree projections of works in Dortmund on Wednesday

AP/PTI

IRAN’S PREZ DELIVERS WARTIME ADDRESS AT UN

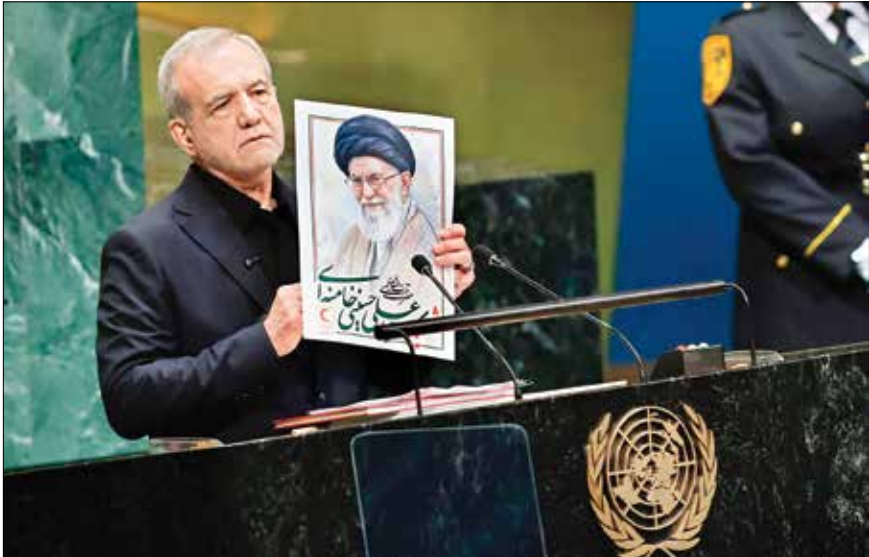
‘We’ve been victims of terrorism’

ASSOCIATED PRESS
United Nations, September 23

Iran’s president said Wednesday that his people have been “victims of terrorism” by the United States, delivering a rare wartime speech at the UN General Assembly a day after President Donald Trump said he could “annihilate” the Islamic Republic. In a defiant speech, President Masoud Pezeshkian held up large photos of the late Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei and the more than 150 schoolchildren killed on the first days of the war.

“We have only defended ourselves. We are not terrorists,” Pezeshkian said at the General Assembly. “Our innocent people have been the targets of cowardly attacks and aggressions imposed upon our country. And we defended ourselves with utmost strength. America and Israel attacked us.”

He added about the United States: “Yes, they did hit us, but we did not bend the knee.” Toward the end of his speech, Pezeshkian called out Trump by



Iran’s President Masoud Pezeshkian holds an image of late Iranian Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei during the 81st session of United Nations General Assembly at United Nations headquarters on Wednesday

AP/PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Pezeshkian addressed world leaders a day after Trump used the same stage for his speech
- » ‘We have only defended ourselves. We are not terrorists’

name. “It must be understood by Mr Trump and those who seek to bully us that we are ready for dialogue and diplomacy

and negotiations without accepting the language of force,” he said. He also said one thing that was measurably false: “We did not hit

civilian populations.” Mariners and migrant workers in the region have been among the civilians killed in Iran’s attacks since the war began.

Pezeshkian addressed world leaders a day after Trump used the same stage to suggest he may “annihilate” the Islamic Republic if a deal isn’t reached soon to end the nearly seven-month war.

Trump’s Board of Peace to unveil \$2.45 bn Gaza recovery plan

ASSOCIATED PRESS
New York, September 23

The US-backed Board of Peace is proposing a six-month, \$2.45 billion plan to begin reconstruction and governance in Gaza as President Donald Trump’s ceasefire plan struggles to stay afloat.

At a meeting of the group’s board in New York on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly on Wednesday, the governors unveiled a 66-project blueprint to get things started while acknowledging enormous hurdles that must still be overcome. The projects include ambitious infrastructure, education and health initiatives that are designed to support Trump’s 20-point plan to end the Israel-Hamas war.

“The need is immense,” the board said, noting that full reconstruction from the physical damage across Gaza will cost roughly \$35.2 bil-



US President Donald Trump

THE PROJECTS INCLUDE AMBITIOUS INFRASTRUCTURE, EDUCATION AND HEALTH INITIATIVES THAT ARE DESIGNED TO SUPPORT TRUMP’S 20-POINT PLAN TO END ISRAEL-HAMAS WAR

lion over the medium term and another \$71.4 billion in the next 10 years.

Pak appoints ex-army general as first head of Makkah alliance

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Islamabad, September 23

A former Pakistan Army general has been appointed as the first secretary-general of the trilateral Makkah alliance involving Pakistan, Turkiye and Saudi Arabia, the Foreign Office (FO) announced on Wednesday.

The trilateral defence agreement, inked last month, establishes a framework for collective deterrence and stipulates that an armed attack against any one of them would be regarded as an attack against all.

“The government of Pakistan is pleased to announce the appointment of Lt Gen Nauman Mahmood, Hilal-i-Imtiaz (Military), (retired), as the first secretary general pursuant to the Makkah Joint Defence

Agreement,” the FO said. It said that the secretary general will lead the general secretariat of the alliance being established in Riyadh.

Mahmood, who belonged to the Baloch Regiment, previously commanded a key Pakistan Army corps in the country’s restive northwest and served as president of the National Defence University, according to the military.

His appointment comes amid an ongoing escalation involving Saudi Arabia and Yemen’s Houthis, who carried out attacks on Saudi territory in recent days and established control over the strategic Bab el-Mandeb Strait in the Red Sea.

Pakistan, Saudi Arabia and Turkiye signed the agreement on August 7.

Russia pounds Kyiv with drones

Two people were killed, and 23 were wounded in Ukraine’s capital

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Kyiv, September 23

Russia hammered Ukraine’s capital, Kyiv, with drones in daylight attacks on Wednesday, as Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy prepared for meetings with world leaders at the UN General Assembly.

Two people were killed,

and 23 were wounded in Kyiv, and clouds of black smoke floated above the city following the latest in what have been daily Russian attacks that torment Ukrainian civilians. The drones set off fires and damaged buildings in Kyiv and elsewhere in Ukraine overnight, authorities said.

Zelenskyy was in New

York for the annual UN gathering as part of his diplomatic effort to shore up and recruit further international support for his country’s gruelling 4½-year fight against Russia’s invasion.

He was due to address the General Assembly later Wednesday and was also to meet with European leaders and NATO Secre-

tary-General Mark Rutte.

Zelenskyy met on Tuesday with US President Donald Trump, who has shown impatience with the lack of progress in talks aimed at ending the war and the escalating aerial attacks by both sides this year. Russian President Vladimir Putin is not scheduled to attend the UN gathering this year.

Xi leaves for Washington for summit with Trump

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Beijing, September 23

Chinese President Xi Jinping on Wednesday left for Washington to hold a rare second summit with his US counterpart Donald Trump

in less than six months to discuss a broad range of bilateral and international issues.

Xi is accompanied by his wife Peng Liyuan, Cai Qi, a member of the Standing Committee of the Political

Bureau of the Communist Party of China Central Committee and director of the General Office of the Central Committee, and Foreign Minister Wang Yi, a member of the Political Bureau of the Central Com-

mittee, the foreign ministry said. Trump had invited Xi and Peng to visit the White House during his visit to China in May this year.

They are expected to arrive at Joint Base Andrews just outside Washington.

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the newspapers, social media platforms & website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates
(As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: **MAMATAALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS**

*Name of the Election: **BYE-ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY FOR THE STATE OF WEST BENGAL 2026**

Name of State/UT: **WEST BENGAL**

(1) **Name of the Constituency – 70- RejinagarAssembly Constituency**
Name of the candidate – Rabiul Alam Chowdhury

Sl.no.		
1.	Criminal antecedents	
i)	a.	Nature of the offences
		Offences alleged under: Sections 323/324/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860
	b.	Case no.
		Beldanga PoliceCaseNo.301/2009, Dated11/08/2009, GR No-2253/2009
	c.	Name of the Court
		Learned J.M. 2ndCourt, Berhampore, Murshidabad
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)
		Yes
	e.	Date of conviction, if any
		Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any
		Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given
		Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)	
	The candidate is a long-standing social worker.He has substantial experience in addressing constituency-level developmental and public welfare issues. His sustained grassroots engagement, legislative experience, familiarity with Rejinagar’s needs, and demonstrated commitment to public service are the principal considerations for his selection.	
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)	
	Same as above.	

(2) **Name of the Constituency –70- Rejinagar Assembly Constituency**
Name of the Candidate – Rabiul Alam Chowdhury

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation

Derek O’Brien
National Joint Secretary,
Mamata All India Trinamool Congress

‘DETERIORATION IN INVENTORY POSITION’

Coal stocks ‘critically low’ at 74 thermal power plants: CEA data

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 23

Coal inventories at India’s thermal power plants declined 24 per cent to 22.9 million tonnes (mt) as of September 19 from 29 mt on August 31, reducing the average fuel cover to just seven days and leaving stocks at only 39 per cent of the normative requirement, according to Central Electricity Authority (CEA) data.

Of the 190 thermal power plants monitored by the CEA, 74 are currently facing critically low coal stocks, up from 51 in August, indicating a deterioration in the inventory position.

Coal stocks had already fallen sharply in August, declining about 42 per cent from 50 mt recorded during the same month last year. The decline came as coal-based power generation increased nearly 13 per cent amid a rise in electricity demand. Average coal cover fell to nine days in August from 17 days a year earlier, marking the lowest



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

level since November 2023. “The last time inventory levels were at a similar level was in October 2023, when stocks fell to around 7.5 days of cover amid an El Niño-driven increase in power demand. An even tighter inventory position was recorded in September 2021, when stocks fell to around 4 days due to supply-chain disruptions,” said Sehul Bhatt, director, Crisil Intelligence.

After remaining rel-

atively stable in July and August, electricity demand rose above 255 gigawatt (GW) during the first week of September and touched around 267 GW on some days. The all-time peak demand of 270 GW was recorded in May this year.

The CEA classifies coal stocks at thermal power plants as critical when they are 25 per cent below the required inventory level or when the available stock can support power genera-

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Coal inventories at thermal power plants declined 24% to 22.9 mt as of Sept 19 from 29 mt on Aug 31
- » This has reduced the average fuel cover to just seven days and left stocks at only 39% of the normative requirement
- » The last time inventory levels were at a similar level was in October 2023, when stocks fell to around 7.5 days of cover amid an El Niño-driven increase in power demand

tion for less than three days. According to Crisil, the decline in coal inventories could be a temporary logistical issue rather than an indication of structural supply constraints. Daily all-India thermal power generation remained between 4,058 million units (MU) and 4,190 MU during the past week, according to CEA data.

Earlier this month, the Ministry of Coal said corrective measures were being

implemented to address the situation at thermal plants with critically low inventories. Rake loading for the power sector increased to 444 rakes from 370 rakes within a week in early September.

State-owned Coal India Ltd currently has around 76 mt of coal at its pitheads, suggesting that coal availability at the production end remains adequate.

The increase in the number of plants falling below normative stock levels during August and September is also considered seasonally plausible, as monsoon rainfall can affect coal production, loading, quality and railway movement. The CEA’s revised stocking norms take these seasonal factors into account.

The prescribed stock requirement for September is 12 days for pithead plants and 20 days for non-pithead plants, the lowest levels prescribed during the year. The requirement rises after the monsoon, reaching 17 days for pithead plants and 26 days for non-pithead plants in February and March.

OMCs face Rs 530-cr daily loss as crude oil prices surge: ICRA

Under-recoveries on domestic LPG stand at about ‘Rs 300 per cylinder’, ICRA estimates

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 23

State-run oil marketing companies are facing mounting losses on petrol and diesel sales as a surge in crude prices outpaces unchanged domestic fuel prices, rating agency ICRA said.

Indian Oil Corporation (IOC), Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL) and Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd (HPCL) are losing Rs 8 a litre on petrol, and Rs 9 on diesel, while under-recoveries on domestic liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) stood at about Rs 300 per cylinder, ICRA said.

“At these levels, the daily loss to the OMCs is estimated at Rs 530 crore,” ICRA said.

Crude oil prices have risen sharply in recent weeks amid escalating geopolitical tensions and supply disruptions in West Asia. The surge was driven by renewed US-Iran conflict, the shutdown of Saudi Arabia’s East-West pipeline and heightened Houthi activities in the Red Sea.



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

The price of the basket of crude oil India imports rose to USD 117.4 per barrel as on September 21, 2026, from the 2025-26 average of around USD 66 a barrel.

“The escalation of the West Asian conflict and disruptions to key oil supply routes have led to a spike in crude prices,” Prashant Vasisht, senior vice president and co-group head of corporate sector ratings at ICRA, said in the report.

The pressure on fuel marketers comes even as refining margins remain relatively strong. Singapore gross refining margins have stayed above USD 10 a barrel since the start of the West Asia crisis, supported by refinery outages, supply disruptions and inventory drawdowns, ICRA said.

The higher crude and product prices are never-

theless expected to weigh on OMC profitability and cash flow, while increasing their short-term borrowing needs to fund working capital, ICRA said.

The impact on earnings in the 2026-27 financial year will depend on crude prices, product cracks, domestic retail price revisions and government support for LPG under-recoveries, it said.

LPG is another growing source of pressure. The cumulative negative LPG buffer reached Rs 61,940 crore as of June 30, after international LPG prices rose following supply disruptions in West Asia.

ICRA estimated the loss on each domestic cylinder at about Rs 500 in the first quarter of 2026-27 and around Rs 300 in September.

Export levies introduced on diesel and aviation turbine fuel in March and subsequently extended to petrol have also remained elevated. The Special Additional Excise Duty on diesel stood at Rs 20 a litre and on ATF at Rs 15 a litre from September 16, ICRA said.

FM AT BRICS TAX HEADS MEET

‘BRICS should work together on transfer pricing’

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 23

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Wednesday urged BRICS nations to share their experiences on treaty interpretation and multilateral negotiations in international taxation, saying global transfer pricing disputes “disproportionately” burden developing countries.

India has proposed to set up two new working groups, International Taxation and Transfer Pricing and Revenue Statistics, at a time when international tax rules are being renegotiated, Sitharaman said, addressing the BRICS heads of tax authori-



Union Minister for Finance and Corporate Affairs Nirmala Sitharaman addresses the BRICS Tax Heads Meeting, at Sushma Swaraj Bhawan, in New Delhi

ties meeting here.

“The rules of international taxation are being renegotiated. There are several multilateral tax issues, including the UN Frame-

work Convention on International Tax Cooperation, under active negotiation. The decisions made in these processes over the next few years will shape

cross-border taxation for a generation. “BRICS economies, as large developing economies, as countries that have built significant domestic tax capacity from a low base, have a perspective on those negotiations that is essential to their fairness and their durability,” Sitharaman said.

Transfer pricing refers to the pricing of goods and services that are exchanged between related companies. International transfer pricing disputes arise mainly because countries seek to ensure that MNCs are subject to tax on an appropriate share of the profits attrib-

utable to their respective jurisdictions.

Accordingly, differences in the allocation of taxable income among countries can give rise to disputes between taxpayers and tax authorities, as well as between tax authorities in different jurisdictions.

“Transfer pricing disputes cost developing-country administrations disproportionately. Revenue frameworks that don’t fit our fiscal realities distort how we are seen and how we see ourselves,” Sitharaman said, adding that the BRICS working groups will work based on common experience from all the member countries.

Irdai proposes to ban ‘dark patterns’ on insurance sites

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 23

Regulator Irdai on Wednesday proposed prohibiting ‘dark patterns’ on insurance websites, including practices that require customers to provide personal details to access product features and pricing information.

As part of wide-ranging reforms aimed at making insurance distribution more transparent and customer-centric, Irdai has issued a consultation paper on ‘Recalibrating Economics of Insurance Distribution’, setting out a comprehensive framework of reforms covering insurance distribution, its structure, expenses, commissions, market conduct, transparency and leveraging digital infrastructure.

Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (Irdai) proposes to replace the existing complex and fragmented architecture with three broad categories of distribution entities: Insurance Distribution Entities (IDEs), Insurance Distribution Persons (IDPs) and Market Infrastructure Institutions (MIIs).

The Expense of Management (EoM) framework is proposed to be recalibrated through lower limits with a phased glide path, the paper said.

Pre-budget meetings to begin on Oct 12: Fin Min

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 23

The Finance ministry will begin a month-long series of pre-budget meetings from October 12 as part of the preparations for Union Budget 2027-28.

“Pre-budget discussions to finalise RE (Revised Estimate) 2026-27 and BE (Budget Estimate) 2027-28 in respect of the Grants/appropriations will commence with effect from 12.10.2026 under the Chairmanship of Secretary (Expenditure),” a notice by the Budget Division of the ministry said.

The notice dated September 23, 2026, cir-

culated to all ministries and departments, has a schedule of meetings with the Department of Expenditure.

The schedule has been prepared taking into account various exigencies, and is being circulated well in advance.

Hence, ministries and departments should ensure that the necessary details required should be submitted by October 6, 2026, the notice said.

These meetings will continue till November 13 as per the schedule.

The Budget Estimates for 2027-28 will be provisionally finalised after completion of pre-budget meetings.

‘Aastha Gurukul offers hope to conflict-hit children’

MPOST BUREAU
Dantewada, September 23



(LWE). The school gives priority to children orphaned due to such violence, those whose parents were involved in the insurgency and students from affected areas of Dantewada and the wider Bastar region.

Principal Ravindra Panigrahi said official documents, including police

certification of LWE-affected areas and FIR records concerning deaths of family members, are considered under the special admission criteria.

The school also provides counselling by experts to students affected by violence. IAS officers and other accomplished individu-

als interact with students through special lectures, Panigrahi said.

Following the CBSE curriculum, the school uses smart-screen systems for technology-based teaching. Its campus has separate residential facilities for boys and girls and an auditorium with a capacity of over 1,000 students.

Launched in 2013, the school receives infrastructure and operational support through NMDC’s CSR funding, with annual operational expenditure around Rs 3.5 crore. Administration remains with the state government.

PSPCL CMD discusses employees’ issues

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Patiala, September 23

Punjab State Power Corporation Limited (PSPCL) CMD Gurkirat Kirpal Singh on Wednesday held a meeting with representatives of around 37 employee organisations to discuss their demands, problems and pending issues.

The meeting, attended by directors and senior officers, was Singh’s first interaction with employee organisations since assuming charge and was held in a cordial atmosphere. Employee representatives sought early resolution of promotion-related demands and raised other



pending matters. Singh said differences of opinion between employees and management were natural but emphasised resolving issues through dialogue before they lead to protests or agitation.

He assured that demands falling within the corporation’s jurisdiction would be addressed at the earliest,

while matters requiring government intervention would be brought to its attention.

Singh directed officials to take necessary steps on promotion-related and other pending issues. Employee leaders assured the management of their cooperation and welcomed continued dialogue to resolve grievances.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



LIC Eastern Zone Zonal Manager Ashutosh Kumar hands over a cheque of Rs 1 crore to the Chief Minister’s Relief Fund under the LIC Golden Jubilee Foundation to Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma for flood victims of upper Assam

‘Financial sector must fund next generation of enterprises’

It must move beyond financing near-term growth, says PM’s Principal Secy PK Mishra

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, September 23

The financial sector must move beyond financing near-term growth and focus on funding the next generation of Indian enterprises, Principal Secretary to the Prime Minister PK Mishra said on Wednesday.

“The task before the financial sector is larger than financing next year’s growth. It is to finance the next generation of Indian enterprise,” Mishra said at the 13th SBI Banking and Economics Conclave 2026

here.

He said the financial system must increasingly move from “accommodating growth to enabling growth” as India seeks to become a leading global economy.

A much larger and sophisticated economy cannot be financed by banks alone, he said, stressing the need for deeper corporate bond and equity markets, larger institutional investors and infrastructure funds.

Mishra also called for a shift in the way credit is assessed, from collateral to

KEY POINTS

- » He said the financial system must increasingly move from ‘accommodating growth to enabling growth’
- » Mishra also called for a shift in the way credit is assessed, from collateral to cash flows

cash flows.

“There is another transformation that I believe the financial sector must now undertake. It is the movement from collateral to cash flow,” he said.

Stressing on the use of new technologies to expand credit, Mishra said that technology can help lenders assess businesses through goods and services tax (GST) returns, bank statements, payment flows, account aggregator data and digital lending infrastructure.

“This is not an argument for lower standards of credit appraisal. It is an argument for better information and better credit appraisal,” Mishra said.

He said lenders should increasingly assess busi-

nesses based on their earnings and future potential rather than primarily on assets already owned by promoters.

“If India is to move from manufacturing to design and innovation, our capital markets, our venture ecosystem and our banks must be equally willing to finance ideas and not merely factories,” he added.

Mishra said India’s financial system will need to mobilise large amounts of capital for infrastructure, manufacturing, urbanisation, energy transition and

innovation, with different forms of capital required for different needs.

“Assets with long gestation period require capital of long tenure. Innovation requires risk capital. High growth enterprises require equity. Infrastructure requires patient capital, and cities will require new financial structures,” he said.

He also said India needs to strengthen domestic manufacturing and reduce vulnerabilities arising from global supply-chain disruptions.

News at a glance

RAI survey: Retail sector logs 10% growth in Aug

MUMBAI: India's retail sector maintained a steady trajectory in August, recording a 10 per cent year-on-year pan-India growth, according to a business survey by the Retail Association of India. Building on July's strong recovery, stable consumer demand across key re-gions and categories indicates strong industry preparation for the upcoming festive peak, it said.

For August this year, regional sales growth remained consistent across the country at 10 per cent, led by an 11 per cent growth in West India.

RBI absorbs Rs 75,026 crore via overnight VRRR auction

MUMBAI: The RBI on Wednesday absorbed Rs 75,026 crore from the banking system through an overnight variable rate reverse repo (VRRR) auction amid surplus liquidity. Against a notified amount of Rs 75,000 crore, the RBI received bids worth Rs 87,993 crore and accepted Rs 75,026 crore. The bids were accepted at a cut-off and weighted average rate of 5.24 per cent.

The RBI has been conducting VRRR auctions since last month to absorb excess liquidity and align overnight money market rates with the repo rate.

Amazon Retail losses widen to Rs 1,158.3 crore in FY26

NEW DELHI: E-commerce firm Amazon Retail, which manages Amazon Now and Amazon Fresh, saw its losses widen to Rs 1,158.3 crore in the financial year ended March 2026, according to a regulatory filing shared by market intelligence firm Tofler. The company had posted a net loss of Rs 394.2 crore in the fiscal year ended March 2025.

The loss was mainly due to the increase in cost of goods by 64 per cent to 2,887.9 crore -- accounting for almost 94 per cent of the company's revenue, and a reduction in operating margin to 37.1 per cent in FY26 from 18.6 per cent in FY25.

Rupee falls 11 paise to close at 95.73 against US dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee fell 11 paise to close at 95.73 against the US dollar on Wednesday, weighed down by the broad strength of the American currency and a slight recovery in crude oil prices from lower levels.

At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 95.58 against the US dollar, then gained ground and touched an intraday high of 95.57 in intraday trade. The domestic unit saw an intraday low of 95.76 and ended the trading session on Wednesday at 95.73 against the dollar.

GLOBAL AGENCIES SEE RBI RATE HIKE ON INFLATION FEARS

S&P, Fitch, ADB, OECD raise India's FY 2026-27 GDP growth projections

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 23

Global agencies S&P, Fitch, Asian Development Bank (ADB) and OECD on Wednesday raised India's FY27 GDP growth projection to around 7 per cent, boosted by robust June quarter economic activity and resilient domestic demand despite conflict in West Asia.

Additionally, S&P and Fitch said inflationary pressures will push the Reserve Bank to hike policy interest rates by at least 25 basis points in the current year.

Paris-based Organisation for Economic Cooperation and Development (OECD) upped GDP growth forecast by 80 basis points to 7.1 per cent -- the highest growth rate so far projected by any international agency for FY'27.

ADB, while raising the growth forecast to 7 per cent, from 6.6 per cent estimated in July, said the Indian economy has benefited from lower-than-expected supply disruptions and sustained capital inflows, which helped cushion the impact of the conflict in the Middle East.

S&P upgraded India's GDP growth forecast for the current fiscal year to 7



per cent, from 6.6 per cent previously, while Fitch Ratings said growth in India remains "very strong" with "very robust" dynamism despite the oil price shock, hiking GDP growth estimates to 6.9 per cent, from 6.4 per cent earlier.

Last week, US-based Moody's Ratings raised GDP growth forecast for the fiscal year to 7 per cent -- the fastest among all G20 economies.

S&P Global Ratings
S&P hiked India's GDP growth forecast for the current fiscal year to 7 per cent, from 6.6 per cent previously, citing robust economic activity and forecast that the RBI could hike interest rates by 25 basis points in FY27.

The Indian economy grew higher than expected at 7.8 per cent in the June quarter, driven by robust industrial activ-

ity, healthy consumption, strong goods exports, and accelerating government investment. But a slower pace of expansion in both manufacturing and services and below-normal monsoon rains is likely to moderate growth over the remaining part of the fiscal year ending March 31, 2027.

Growth is expected to ease in the second half of the fiscal year as the tailwinds from Goods and Services Tax (GST) rationalisation and income tax cuts diminish, it added.

Fitch Ratings
Fitch Ratings raised India's GDP growth forecast for the fiscal to 6.9 per cent, from 6.4 per cent, citing strong economic growth in the June quarter and overall economic resilience.

The 7.8 per cent growth rate in the June quarter

CLOSER LOOK

» OECD's GDP growth projection of 7.1 per cent for FY27 is the highest among other international agencies

» Last week, US-based Moody's Ratings raised GDP growth forecast for the fiscal year to 7 per cent -- the fastest among all G20 economies

indicates that the Indian economy has shown resilience in the face of the shock from the US-Iran war, despite the strong terms-of-trade deterioration seen in the first half of 2026, Fitch said.

India's economic momentum is likely to moderate over the remaining fiscal year, prompting the RBI to increase interest rates by 0.25 per cent in its October monetary policy meeting, Fitch said, adding inflation to touch 5.5 per cent in December this year.

OECD
The Paris-based body raised India's GDP growth projection for current fiscal by 80 basis points to 7.1 per cent citing resilient domestic demand and government policies that cushioned households and firms from the impact of higher energy prices.

'BikeWo to scale fleet to 10K vehicles'

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 23

BikeWo Green Tech Ltd is targeting about 10,000 vehicles in its operating fleet during 2026-27, funded by a preferential issue through warrants of over Rs 76 crore, the company has said.

Hiten Pal Saklani, Chief Executive Officer, BikeWo Green Tech Ltd, said it has around 2,500 riders/vehicles under deployment.

"We plan to scale towards 10,000 vehicles during FY27, backed primarily by growing institutional demand for EV logistics," he said.

The expansion marks a shift from electric vehicle sales and distribution into EV asset ownership and leasing, fleet deployment, specialised mobility applications, operating partnerships, lifecycle support, and technology-enabled logistics.

"The multi-brand EV retail model is losing momentum, while demand for EV logistics and institutional fleet solutions is growing significantly. BikeWo is therefore moving towards fleet ownership, leasing and operations, creating greater scope to scale and build a more recurring revenue base," Saklani said.

Subhash Chandra challenges NCLT's asset restraint order

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 23

Subhash Chandra has moved the appellate tribunal, NCLAT, against the order of a five-member bench of the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT), which restrained him from alienating his assets during the pendency of the matter.

Chandra has challenged an order passed by a five-member NCLT bench, formed to decide his personal insolvency, on September 1, which stayed

THE NCLAT BENCH HAS LISTED THE MATTER FOR THE NEXT HEARING ON SEPT 29

the order passed by the third tie-breaker judge, who voted for Rs 6.5 crore repayment against total liabilities of around Rs 22,000 crore.

The appeal came up for hearing before a three-member bench, which asked his counsel to serve the copies to creditors and

implead them as parties.

The bench, which includes NCLAT officiating Chairperson Justice Yogesh Khanna, has directed that the matter be listed for the next hearing on September 29.

During the proceedings, counsel representing the creditors told the NCLAT that advance copies of the appeal have not been served on them or they have not been made parties despite having participated in the proceedings before the NCLT.

Stock mkts rebound amid easing oil prices

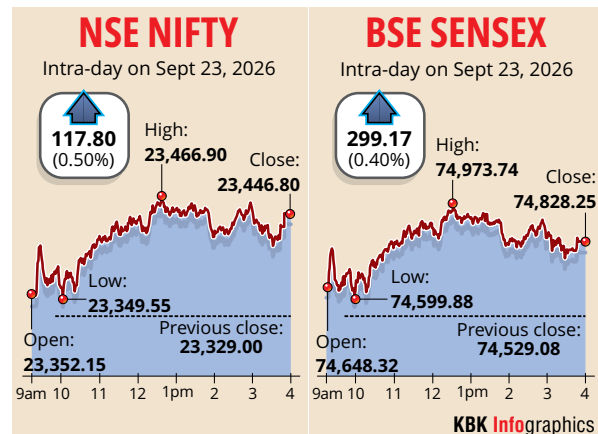
OUR CORRESPONDENT

Mumbai, September 23

Benchmark stock index Sensex rebounded by nearly 300 points and the broader Nifty settled near the 24,450 level on Wednesday as below USD 100 per barrel crude oil prices and positive India growth forecast by rating agencies boosted buying in metal, financial and FMCG shares.

The 30-share BSE Sensex climbed 299.17 points, or 0.40 per cent, to settle at 74,828.25. During the day, it jumped 444.66 points, or 0.59 per cent, to 74,973.74.

The 50-share NSE Nifty



was up 117.80 points, or 0.50 per cent, to end at 23,446.80.

Among the 30 Sensex

firms, Tata Steel, Bajaj Finance, ITC, UltraTech Cement, Power Grid and Larsen & Toubro were the

major winners. HCLTech, Infosys, Tata Consultancy Services, Titan and Mahindra & Mahindra were among the laggards.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, edged up 0.35 per cent to USD 99.60 per barrel. The BSE Small-Cap Select index rallied 0.85 per cent and MidCap Select index was up 0.79 per cent.

Among the BSE sectoral indices, Metal surged 2.37 per cent, Commodities 1.64 per cent, MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt 1.49 per cent, MidSmall Private Banks 1.47 per cent, FMCG 1.30 per cent, PSU Bank 1.18 per cent and Realty 1.11 per cent.

India Rich List: Gautam Adani reclaims top spot from Mukesh Ambani

Gautam Adani's wealth rises 13% to Rs 9.23L crore, while Mukesh Ambani's falls 10% to Rs 8.63L crore: Hurun

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 23

Gautam Adani and family reclaimed the top spot on India's rich list, overtaking Mukesh Ambani, as the country's billionaire population hit a record 391, according to the M3M Hurun India Rich List.

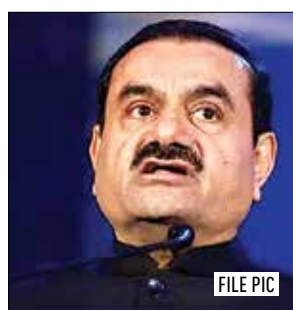
Adani's wealth rose 13 per cent to Rs 9.23 lakh crore (USD 96 billion), while Ambani's fell 10 per cent to Rs 8.63 lakh crore, leaving a gap of Rs 59,400 crore between the two.

Lakshmi Niwas Mittal

and family jumped to third place, with wealth nearly doubling to Rs 3.39 lakh crore, boosted by higher European steel prices and trade protection.

Vaccine maker Serum Institute's Cyrus Poonawalla and family were ranked fourth, followed by HCL's Roshni Nadar Malhotra, Kumar Mangalam Birla, Sun Pharmaceutical's Dilip Shanghvi and Wipro's Azim Premji.

Anil Agarwal and family climbed to ninth with Rs 2.08 lakh crore, while Samir Mehta and family entered



the top 10 at 10th after a 52 per cent increase in wealth following the completion of the JB Chemicals merger.

"Charted together over a decade, the ten richest Indians cross and re-cross one

KEY POINTS

» Lakshmi Niwas Mittal and family jumped to third place, with wealth nearly doubling to Rs 3.39 lakh crore

» Vaccine maker Serum Institute's Cyrus Poonawalla and family were ranked fourth

» They were followed by HCL's Roshni Nadar Malhotra, Kumar Mangalam Birla, Sun Pharmaceutical's Dilip Shanghvi and Wipro's Azim Premji

another repeatedly. The most closely fought contest is at the top: Gautam Adani and family overtook Mukesh Ambani and family in 2022, fell behind again in 2023, retook the lead in

2024, lost it in 2025, and have now reclaimed it - five changes of position in five years," Hurun said.

Adani's line is also the most volatile on the chart, peaking at Rs 11.62 lakh

crore in 2024, then falling to Rs 8.15 lakh crore before recovering to Rs 9.23 lakh crore. Mukesh Ambani's line rose from Rs 2.58 lakh crore in 2017 to Rs 10.15 lakh crore in 2024 but has since given up ground in two successive years to Rs 8.63 lakh crore.

"The chase pack is where the weaving is densest. All eight of the remaining top ten sat between Rs 17,300 crore and Rs 2.58 lakh crore in 2017 and are now bunched between Rs 1.89 lakh crore and Rs 3.39 lakh crore, having traded

places many times over. LN Mittal & family began the decade ahead of the group, slipped behind between 2020 and 2022, and have surged clear to third at Rs 3.39 lakh crore.

"Anil Agarwal and family and Samir Mehta and family started at the bottom of the field and have climbed to ninth and tenth, multiplying their wealth by 12.0 and 7.6 times, respectively. Azim Premji and family show the sharpest single reversal in the group, dropping in 2022 before a strong three-year recovery to eighth," it said.

ASIAN GAMES

Skeet shooting: Indian men, women bag bronze medals

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nagoya, September 23

Skeet shooting came to India's rescue at the Asian Games shooting range on Wednesday, producing two bronze medals on a day when consistency had eluded the country's pistol markswomen.

The Indian men's and women's skeet teams both climbed onto the podium, lifting some of the gloom around a shooting campaign that has promised much but has been patchy since the opening day.

There was also plenty of individual drama, with Anantjeet Singh Naruka in the men's event and Raiza Dhillon in the women's event coming tantalisingly close to medals before finishing fourth. For the women, the team bronze was particularly significant. Parinaaz Dhaliwal, Raiza and Maheshwari Chauhan combined for 331 out of 375 to win India's first-ever skeet medal at the Asian Games.

China dominated the team competition with 357, a Games record, while Kazakhstan finished on 336 to win silver.

The Indian trio had little room for error after three days of qualification, with each shooter completing five series of 25 shots. Parinaaz and Raiza both finished on 111, while Maheshwari contributed 109 to take India's aggregate to 331. Raiza and Parinaaz then carried India's individual hopes into the



From left, India's Raiza Dhillon, Maheshwari Chauhan and Parinaaz Dhaliwal during the 20th Asian Games, in Nagoya on Wednesday

PTI



From left, India's Mairaj Ahmad Khan, Anantjeet Singh Naruka and Anantjeet Singh Naruka during the 20th Asian Games on Wednesday

PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- » China dominated the team competition with 357, a Games record, while Kazakhstan finished on 336 to win silver
- » The Indian trio had little room for error after 3 days of qualification, with each shooter completing five series of 25 shots

eight-shooter final.

Raiza, the more experienced of the two and an Olympian, remained in

medal contention deep into the final but faltered at the crucial stage, finishing fourth with 23. Parinaaz

was unable to reproduce her qualification form and was the first shooter eliminated, eventually finishing eighth. China's Jiang Yiting took gold after producing a superb final to equal the world record with 35.

If the women created history, the Indian men ensured the day ended with another bronze.

Naruka, veteran Mairaj Ahmad Khan and Bhavtegh Singh Gill combined for 346 to finish third. Qatar took gold with 353, while Kuwait claimed silver with 348. For Naruka, however, the team medal offered only partial consolation after another agonising near-miss in the individual event.

The 28-year-old Olympian had looked every inch a medal contender during the opening two days. He shot with remarkable consistency on Monday and Tuesday, posting 96 out of 100 to sit joint top of the qualification standings alongside three others.

The final qualification round was less assured. Naruka slipped to 23 out of 25, but his aggregate of 119 was still enough to send him into the eight-man final and keep his individual medal hopes alive.

He was composed again when it mattered, but the quality of the competition left him with little margin for error. Qatar's Rashid Saleh Al-Athba, one of Asia's most accomplished skeet shooters with multiple World Cup medals and Asian championship success

Roshibina enters Asiad wushu final

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nagoya, September 23

Indian wushu player Roshibina Devi Naorem will fight for gold in the Asian Games after defeating Indonesia's Thania Kusumaningtyas in the semifinals of the women's 60kg category here on Wednesday.

Roshibina prevailed 2-0 in the contest at the Aichi Prefectural Martial Arts Hall here. She will face China's Xiaoyu Zhang in the summit clash.

Roshibina had won a silver as well as a bronze medal in the previous two editions of the competition. She was a late inclusion in the squad after original choice Divyanshi Choudhary had to be withdrawn due to injury.

Jay Meena wins India's first ever soft tennis bronze medal at Asian Games

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nagoya, September 23

Jay Meena secured India's first ever soft tennis medal at the Asian Games, fetching a bronze after losing to Japan's Takuya Kurosaka in the men's singles semifinals here on Wednesday.

Playing in his third Asian Games, the 26-year-old Jay produced a spirited fightback after falling three games behind but could not sustain the momentum, losing 2-4 (3-5, 1-4, 1-4, 4-1, 6-4, 1-4) to Kurosaka in the 45-minute clash.

"You know what? It's an Olympic medal for me," said Jay, who claimed mixed doubles bronze at the World Championship and a men's sin-



gles bronze at the 2024 Asian Championships in Mungyeong, South Korea.

He was striving for an Asian Games medal for the last two editions and narrowly missed out on a bronze after losing to his opponent from hosts China in Hangzhou 2023.

"I know what it takes to win a medal at this stage. Only a player, a coach

and their team know how much struggle, how much pain we go through. It's really, really hard. It's so stressful. You have to be mentally strong enough to handle a situation like this," he said.

Jay, who hails from Madhya Pradesh's Dewas and is a 2022 National Games gold-medallist, struggled to find his rhythm early on as Kurosaka established an advantage, winning the first two games 5-3 and 4-1.

The Japanese player then moved further ahead by taking the third game 4-1, leaving Jay with little margin for error.

With his medal assured but a place in the final at stake, Jay mounted a strong fightback.

Deepika's record strikes hand India commanding 20-1 win over Thailand

Hockey: India will next play hosts Japan on Friday

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Kakamigahara, Sept 23

In-form drag-flicker Deepika Sehrawat continued her impressive run, scoring a record nine goals in a single match as India thrashed Thailand 20-1 to register their third consecutive victory in Pool B of the women's hockey competition at the Asian Games here on Wednesday.

Deepika (2nd, 8th, 9th, 24th, 33rd, 36th, 39th, 51st and 57th minutes) was unstoppable from penalty corners, converting all her nine attempts to script the



record haul, while Navneet Kaur (4th, 29th, 35th and 51st) also ran riot in the one-sided contest.

Rutuja Dadaso Pisal (10th, 11th and 47th) com-

pleted a hat-trick, while Neha Goyal (19th), Lalremiam (26th), Sakshi Rana (29th) and skipper Salima Tete (45th) joined the scoring as India piled on the goals. Thailand's consolation goal was scored from a penalty corner variation by Supansa Samanso (57th).

India will next play hosts Japan on Friday.

India are leading Pool B standings with three wins from as many matches ahead of Japan. The top teams from each pool will qualify for the semifinals of the 12-team competition.

India toyed with the Thai defence from the onset with Deepika at the forefront with her penalty corner conversions.

The Indians, who finished a historic fifth at the recent FIH World Cup in the Netherlands and Belgium, continued from where they left in the first two matches.

FILM

OF STARS, STORIES AND NATIONAL HONOURS

From Mammootty and Anant Nag to Yami Gautam, Dhanush and Kartik Aaryan, the 72nd National Film Awards honoured talent across generations

OUR CORRESPONDENT

From power couple Yami Gautam and Aditya Dhar twinning in black as they collected National Awards for 'Article 370' to Kartik Aaryan seeking blessings at Mumbai's iconic Lalbaugcha Raja a day after winning his first National Award for 'Chandu Champion', the 72nd National Film Awards ceremony had several memorable moments. Hosted for the first time at Gujarat's Ekta Nagar in Narmada district, the ceremony saw President Droupadi Murmu confer the National Film Awards at the Statue of Unity on Tuesday.

A day after winning his first National Award for 'Chandu Champion', Kartik visited Lalbaugcha Raja in Mumbai on Wednesday to seek Ganapati's blessings. The actor touched the idol's feet with his National Award in hand. Sharing a picture from the visit, he wrote, "My Sukh-karta dukh-harta. Blessed beyond words. Thank you, bappa!!"

Meanwhile, Yami, who won 'Best Actress in a Leading Role' for 'Article 370' and her husband Aditya Dhar, who received the 'Best Film' award as producer of the film, twinned in black for the occasion. Yami, dressed in a black saree with a golden zari border, told the media, "This is the biggest validation an artist can receive. I don't think I will ever be able to express



Randeep Hooda, Yami Gautam and Aditya Dhar at the National Award ceremony



Anjan Dutt attends the National Award ceremony



Dhanush, Sanjay Mishra and Mammootty

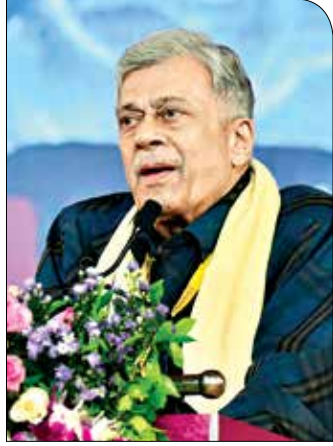
how I'm feeling right now. I'm still trying to soak it in."

Legendary Kannada actor Anant Nag was honoured with the Dadasaheb Phalke Award, the country's highest honour in the field of cinema. Over a career spanning five decades, Nag has featured in more than 300 films. The 72nd National Film Awards, celebrating

the finest of Indian cinema in 2024, also saw Malayalam superstar Mammootty win his fourth National Film Award for 'Best Actor' for his performance in 'Bramayugam'. The veteran actor received a standing ovation at the ceremony. With the win, Mammootty has equalled Amitabh Bachchan's record



Kartik Aryan and Yami Gautam with their National Awards



Legendary Kannada actor Anant Nag was honoured with the Dadasaheb Phalke Award

for the most National Film Awards in the 'Best Actor' category.

Rajkumar Periasamy received the 'Best Director' award for 'Amaran', while Sanjay Mishra ('Bhakshak'), Sachana Namidass ('Maharaja') and Ropashree Varkady ('Mithya') were honoured in the 'Best Supporting Actor' categories.

Arun Matheswaran's 'Captain Miller' won the award for 'Best Film Promoting National, Social and Environmental Values'. Randeep Hooda received the National Film Award for 'Best Debut Film of a Director' for 'Swatantrya Veer Savarkar', while Nag Ashwin's 'Kalki 2898 AD' was named 'Best Popular Film Providing Wholesome Entertainment'.

Dhanush had another

moment of recognition as he received his second honour of the night, the National Film Award for 'Best Tamil Feature Film' for his directorial 'Raayan'.

Bengal, too, had several reasons to celebrate. Kolkata-born Vijay Ganguly, brother of actor Rupali Ganguly, won the 'Best Choreography' award for the blockbuster 'Stree 2'. Riddhiman Banerjee, Tapomoy Deb and Gitashree Chakraborty jointly won the 'Best Child Artist' award for their performances in Sourav Palodhi's 'Onko Ki Kothin'. Filmmaker Anjan Dutta, who marked the centenary of legendary filmmaker Mrinal Sen through 'Chaalchitra Ekhon', was honoured with the award for 'Best Bengali Film'. His son, Neel Dutt, who produced the film, accepted the honour alongside him.

MALAYALAM SUPERSTAR MAMMOOTTY WON HIS FOURTH NATIONAL FILM AWARD FOR 'BEST ACTOR' FOR HIS PERFORMANCE IN 'BRAMAYUGAM'. WITH THE WIN, MAMMOOTTY HAS EQUALLED AMITABH BACHCHAN'S RECORD FOR THE MOST NATIONAL FILM AWARDS IN THE 'BEST ACTOR' CATEGORY

STUDY ABROAD

AUSTRALIA TIGHTENS MIGRATION RULES FOR INTN’L STUDENTS

India among top sources of migrant arrivals as Australia announces sweeping changes to student visas

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Australia is tightening its migration rules, with international students and graduate visa holders set to lose the option of bringing family members into the country, Home Affairs Minister Tony Burke announced on September 17.

The move, which could have a direct bearing on Indian students and families, is part of a wider overhaul aimed at curbing migration and stopping what the government describes as “visa-hopping”. The reforms also include tighter rules for students switching visas, a new processing order for some skilled visas, a ballot system for extending working holiday visas and a ban on visitors extending their stay. Burke did not announce when the new rules would take effect.

India is likely to be closely affected by the changes. Indians were among the top five migrant-arrival groups in Australia in 2024-25, including international students, while the Indian community is the country’s second-largest migrant population, accounting for 3.4 per cent of Australia’s total population. Under the new family rule, international students and graduate visa holders will no longer be able to attach family members to their visas. Those already in Australia will be exempt, with Burke saying the government would not “break up” families already in the country. Students from Pacific and ASEAN nations will also be exempt, as will those enrolled in certain courses, including PhDs.



INDIANS WERE AMONG THE TOP FIVE MIGRANT-ARRIVAL GROUPS IN AUSTRALIA IN 2024-25, INCLUDING INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS, WHILE THE INDIAN COMMUNITY IS THE COUNTRY’S SECOND-LARGEST MIGRANT POPULATION, ACCOUNTING FOR 3.4 PER CENT OF AUSTRALIA’S TOTAL POPULATION

The changes are part of a broader attempt to bring net overseas migration (NOM) down to 245,000 this financial year and 225,000 in 2027-28. Official figures released on the day of Burke’s announcement put NOM at 292,100.

Burke identified two key problems behind the reforms. The first was Australia’s “demand-driven programme”, under which employers could recruit workers they needed and educational institutions could enrol international students, with the expectation that housing and infrastructure would adjust accordingly.

“That pure demand-driven

approach to major parts of the immigration system is not what Australians want,” Burke said, adding that the government needed greater control over the system. The second issue was “visa-hopping”, people moving repeatedly from one visa category to another to remain in Australia. Burke, however, said not every visa transition was a problem. A student who trains in a skills-shortage area, moves to a graduate visa, secures sponsored employment and eventually qualifies for permanent residency represents “the system working at its absolute best”, he said.

The government is instead targeting cases where people who

do not qualify for permanent residency keep shifting between visas and using appeals processes to extend their stay.

Students will also face tighter restrictions on changing courses or institutions. They will generally be allowed to move only upwards on the qualification ladder, such as progressing from a bachelor’s degree to a Master’s. Repeatedly moving between institutions or qualifications, particularly where the government believes the primary objective is migration rather than education, will no longer be allowed.

At the same time, Burke warned against excessive cuts to international education, which

GOING GLOBAL

- » Australia is one of the preferred destinations of Indian students for pursuing higher studies especially in the area of vocational education
- » India is among Western Australia’s largest market for international students
- » In 2025 around 11,954 Indian international students were studying in Western Australia and approx. 1,118 Indian students studying in Northern Territory
- » While Australia granted 1,02,696 student visas to Indian applicants in 2022-23, the number dropped to 50,516 in 2023-24
- » In 2025-26, Australia 33,827 visas have been granted

he described as “an incredibly important export”. Jobs ranging from teaching to cleaning in Australian cities, he said, depend on the sector. “Drastic cuts, wherever you make them, hurt the economy in every part,” he said.

Burke also rejected the argument that immigration itself was responsible for Australia’s housing shortage. While saying that “the housing shortage we have is not caused by immigration”, he said migration policy must nevertheless be “part of the solution for the housing crisis”.

The reforms, therefore, seek to reduce migration without abandoning international education but with tighter controls on the routes through which students and temporary visa holders can bring families and extend their stay in Australia.



13 KYRGYZ MEDICAL VARSITIES FAIL STATE ACCREDITATION, CONCERN FOR INDIANS



Universities in Kyrgyzstan accredited for 1 year only

- » Kyrgyz National University named after J. Balasagyn
- » Jalal-Abad State University named after B. Osmonov
- » Kyrgyz-Uzbek International University named after B. Sydykov
- » Issyk-Kul State University named after K. Tynystanov
- » Jalal-Abad International University
- » University of South Asia (USA), Tokmok
- » International European University (IEU)

OUR CORRESPONDENT

If you are an Indian student pursuing medicine in Kyrgyzstan, there is reason to worry. Several medical universities in the country have failed to secure state accreditation, while some institutions have reportedly received accreditation for only one year despite offering five-year medical courses. The Ministry of Health of Kyrgyzstan released the results of its review, with 13 medical institutions failing to meet the prescribed

NEARLY 25,000 INDIAN STUDENTS ARE CURRENTLY ENROLLED IN MEDICAL UNIVERSITIES ACROSS CENTRAL ASIA, PRIMARILY IN KYRGYZSTAN, KAZAKHSTAN, UZBEKISTAN AND TAJIKISTAN

standards and consequently not receiving state accreditation.

The institutions that failed to secure state accreditation are Avicenna International Medical University, ADAM University, Royal Metropolitan University (RMU), Altamimi International University, Ala-Too International University, International Medical University (IMU), Kyrgyz Medical and Dental Institute, Salymbekov University, Eurasian International University, Bishkek International Medical Institute (BIMI), International University of Medicine and Science, Central Asian International Medical University (CAIMU) and Osh International Medical University (OIMU).

State accreditation is a crucial requirement for medical institutions. Universities that do not obtain it are not permitted to admit students or issue state-standard education documents. Failure to meet mandatory accreditation requirements can also result in the suspension of an institution’s educational licence.

The accreditation exercise was undertaken to assess the quality and standards of medical education across Kyrgyzstan. The review examined several key parameters, including faculty and staffing, availability of clinical facilities, material and technical resources, educational programmes, organisation of the teaching-learning process and the overall quality of specialist training.

Kyrgyzstan has emerged as a popular destination for international students seeking medical education abroad, particularly among Indian students. For Indian students already enrolled in Kyrgyzstan or planning to pursue an MBBS there, the developments serve as a reminder to carefully check the accreditation status of their institution and understand whether its programme and qualification meet the applicable requirements for medical education and practice in India.

Trending COURSES

MTech in Construction Engineering & Project Management from IIT Kanpur

OUR CORRESPONDENT

The MTech (Online) programme in Construction Engineering and Project Management will cover the end-to-end lifecycle of infrastructure and building projects. The programme is designed to equip working professionals with advanced technical and managerial competencies required for planning, execution, monitoring, and delivery of large-scale projects. The courses will be organized around two broad pillars: (i) Construction Engineering and (ii) Project Management, ensuring a strong technical foundation alongside managerial and leadership capabilities.

ELIGIBILITY

Bachelor’s degree in Civil Engineering, Architecture, Construction Engineering (Candidates with a bachelor’s degree in other disciplines but with strong relevant construction experience may also be considered). Minimum CPI 5.5 or 55% marks in the qualifying degree is required. The candidates should have over 5 years of relevant experience in the construction industry (Till the commencement of the class) or should be qualified in the Graduate Aptitude Test in Engineering (GATE) exam or should have qualified in the IIT Kanpur’s online proctored entrance test. The eligible candidates will be called for an online interview. The candidates who qualify in the department-specific online interview will be offered admission to the programme.

IIT Madras inaugurates construction robotics lab

To support research & development of construction robotics

OUR CORRESPONDENT

IIT Madras inaugurated a Rs 3.30-crore state-of-the-art robotics laboratory in the campus recently. The laboratory aims to accelerate research, innovation and industry applications in robotics and automation for the construction and infrastructure sectors. It is being established with CSR support from Bechtel India Private Limited, a global engineering, construction, procurement and project management company.

Emphasising the critical role of the industry in supporting cutting-edge research in academia, Prof Ashwin



Mahalingam, Dean (Alumni and Corporate Relations, IIT Madras), said, “Industry-academia partnerships play a pivotal role in advancing research and

innovation, especially in niche domains such as robotics and automation in construction. This partnership will enable IIT Madras to address industry-relevant challenges in construction robotics and automation, while creating opportunities to test, demonstrate, and take promising technologies closer to deployment.”

The collaboration will support research and development in construction robotics, automation and advanced construction technologies. It will provide opportunities for real-world project exploration, testing and technology demonstrations.

With an aim to strengthen protection against vaccine-preventable diseases across adulthood, the Government of Goa launched India’s first dedicated Life-course Immunisation Policy 2026–2036. Titled “Goa Policy for Life-course Immunization 2026–2036”, the policy and its operational guidelines were developed by the Directorate of Health Services, Goa, in collaboration with Goa Institute of Management (GIM) and Goa Medical College, drawing on consultations with experts at the state and national levels.

BLACKBOARD

Convocation

IIT Roorkee concluded its convocation 2026 recently with the conferment of degrees upon postgraduate and doctoral students, celebrating advanced learning, research, innovation and academic excellence. The second day of the two-day convocation saw 1,424 students receive their degrees, comprising 903 postgraduate degrees, 518 PhD/PhD Dual Degrees and 3 MS by Research degrees.

Marking the beginning of its 20th Anniversary celebrations, the Rajiv Gandhi School of Intellectual Property Law (RGSoIPL), the IIT Kharagpur, inaugurated the IIT Kharagpur Law School Annual Lecture Series with a compelling discourse on the future of law in the age of Artificial Intelligence. Justice Dinesh Maheshwari, Former Judge, Supreme Court of India and Chairperson, Law Commission of India, delivered the inaugural lecture on “Technology, Transparency, and Trust: From Algorithms to Accountability – Law, Ethics and Human Values in the Age of Artificial Intelligence.”

AROUND THE WORLD

- » In 20 years, nearly 171 IIT students committed suicides
- » Irish Higher Education Institutions to launch education in Ireland Fairs in New Delhi
- » BITS Pilani startup hub, Bengaluru invites applications for its first demo day
- » Indira Gandhi Delhi Technical University for Women (IGDTUW) and CyberPeace announced the CyberPeace Keepers and Cyber First Responders initiative

BUZZER ROUND

Q) When was the last time India hosted the Asian Games?

Send us your replies to careersmp22@gmail.com. We shall publish the names of the first 3 correct entries in next week’s edition

Answer to our Sep 17 edition question: 1950

Correct answers were sent by: Rupak Maitra, Sayantan Gupta, Nilanjana Bhattacharya

NEWS & VIEWS

IIT Guwahati concluded the tw0-day regional capacity building workshop on positive mental health, resilience and wellbeing. The workshop focused on translating a shared understanding of mental health and wellbeing policies into practical institutional action.

A Nagaland University study has highlighted the need for location-specific agricultural extension strategies to promote adoption of sustainable farming practices among pineapple growers in the state. The findings identify the importance of strengthening farmers’ access to technical information, extension services and institutional support while integrating sustainability into existing horticultural development programmes.